THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

Revision Notes

English Grammar Workbook · Part 2

Classes 9 and 10 — Complete Board-Level Grammar with Exercises and Answer Key · CBSE / RBSE

HOW TO USE THESE NOTES

Each chapter follows the textbook's own order of sections, so you can read straight through. Bold words are keywords you must be able to define. Tables compare and classify; shaded boxes hold definitions, formulas and key facts. The navy Key Takeaways box at the end of every chapter is your last-two-minutes revision.

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2	Tenses: Advanced Usage and Board Traps	
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CHAPTER 01 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 1

Determiners: Advanced Usage

Determiners are the most frequently tested 'small words' in editing, omission and gap-filling. At board level the questions are no longer about 'a or an' — they test article repetition, the fine shades of few / a few / quite a few, pre-determiner order, distributives and the use of the article with proper and abstract nouns. This chapter deals only with those advanced points.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 4): a/an by sound, the basic uses of *the*, zero article with names/meals/games, demonstratives, possessives, much/many/some/any, little–a little–the little, few–a few–the few, each/every/either/neither, cardinals and ordinals. These are assumed here.

1.1 Articles with Proper and Abstract Nouns

Situation	Rule	Examples
Proper noun used as a common noun (a type or a member of a family)	a/an or the; can be plural	He is *a* Newton. (a genius) · *The* Gandhis of Porbandar · There are two *Ramans* in my class.
Proper noun with an adjective or a phrase that describes it	the	*The* great Akbar · *the* India of my dreams · *the* Delhi of the Mughals (but plain *Delhi*)
Unknown person introduced with a title	a / an	*A* Mr Sharma called you. (a person I do not know)
Abstract / material noun made particular by an *of*-phrase or clause	the	*The* honesty of the boy impressed us. (but *Honesty* is the best policy.) · *The* gold *of Rajasthan* · *The* water *in this well* is salty.
Titles with a name (no article); title alone (the)	zero / the	Prime Minister Modi, President Murmu, Dr Rao · *The* Prime Minister addressed the nation.
Appositive (phrase that renames the noun)	a / the	Mr Rao, *a* lawyer, came. · Rana Pratap, *the* hero of Haldighati, never bowed.
Names of languages vs 'the … language'	zero / the	She speaks *Hindi*. · *The* Hindi language has a rich literature.

1.2 Repeating or Omitting the Article (a Favourite Board Trap)

When two nouns or adjectives are joined by *and*, the presence or absence of the second article decides whether **one** or **two** persons/things are meant.

One person/thing (article not repeated)	Two persons/things (article repeated)
He is *a* poet and novelist. (one man)	He is *a* poet and *a* novelist. (could be two men)
***The* secretary and treasurer has resigned. (one person)**	*The* secretary and *the* treasurer have resigned. (two persons)
I saw *a* red and white flag. (one flag, two colours)	I saw *a* red and *a* white flag. (two flags)
***The* black and white cat is mine. (one cat)**	*The* black and *the* white cats are mine. (two cats)

- **One of the, each of the, many a** need the right noun: *one of **the** best* **students** (plural); *many a **boy*** (singular).
- **'A' with quantity words:** *a few, a little, a good many, a great deal of, a number of, a lot of*; **no 'a'** in *many, much, several, plenty of, lots of*. *Many a time, quite a few* (= many), *not a few* (= many), *only a few* (= very few), *a good few* (= quite many).

1.3 Generic Reference: Three Ways to Speak of a Whole Class

Pattern	Feel	Example
a/an + singular	any typical member	*A tiger* is a carnivore.
the + singular	the species, as a type (formal, scientific)	*The tiger* is in danger. · *The computer* has changed life.
plural / uncountable, no article	the most natural, general statement	*Tigers* are in danger. · *Honey* is sweet.

IMPORTANT

The + adjective is used for a **class of people** and takes a **plural verb**: *The rich are not always happy.* For a **single abstract quality**, it takes a **singular verb**: *The beautiful is always pleasing.* Never use *the* + *adjective* + singular countable noun to mean a class: ~~the poor man will always suffer~~ (a particular man) ≠ *the poor will always suffer*.

1.4 The Article in Idioms and Fixed Phrases (Zero Article vs 'the')

Zero article	With 'the'
at night, by day, at noon, at dawn, by night	in *the* morning/afternoon/evening, at *the* moment, at *the* same time, in *the* end
by bus/train/air/sea/road, on foot, on horseback	in *the* car, on *the* bus, in *the* air (the sky), by *the* sea (beside), on *the* road (surface)
in bed, at home, at sea (on a voyage), in town, at table, at work	in *the* bed (a particular bed), *the* sea (water/shore), in *the* town (a specific town)
play cricket / chess / football; study physics	play *the* sitar / piano / violin (instruments)
go to school / college / hospital / prison / church (purpose)	go to *the* school / hospital (to meet/see something)
on TV, on radio (programme)	on *the* radio / listen to *the* radio (the set), in *the* newspaper
go home, next week, last year, in (the) summer (both)	*the* next day, *the* last time, *the* day before yesterday, in *the* 1990s, in *the* past/future

1.5 Quantifiers: Finer Points

Expression	Sense	Example
quite a few / not a few / a good many	a fairly large number (positive)	*Quite a few* students were absent.
only a few / very few / few	hardly any (negative)	*Only a few* people understood him.
not a little / quite a little	a good deal	He was *not a little* surprised.
no fewer than / no less than	as many / as much as (surprisingly large)	*No fewer than* fifty students failed. · He donated *no less than* Rs 5 lakh.
fewer (countable) / less (uncountable); less than with a measure, sum or time	number vs amount	*fewer* mistakes; *less* water; *less than* ten kilos / an hour / Rs 500 (measure treated as one amount).
most / most of the / almost all	most = majority (general); **most of the** = of a known set	*Most* people like music. · *Most of the* people I met were kind. · *Almost all* people… (not ~~almost people~~)

Expression	Sense	Example
none / no / not any	none stands alone, *no* takes a noun	*No* boy came. · *None* of them came. · I have*n't* **any** pen = I have **no** pen.
any	any one you like (positive); after *if / hardly / without*	*Any* child can do this. · Take *any* book. · *If* there is *any* doubt…
little / few as adverbs and in inversion	hardly	*Little* did he know… · He *scarcely/hardly ever* comes.
another + number	more of the same	Wait *another* five minutes. · *Another* two weeks
every + ordinal / few / other	at intervals	*every other* day, *every third* day, *every few* minutes

1.6 All, Both, Half, Whole: Position and Pattern

- **Pre-determiner order:** *all / both / half / double / twice* + **the / my / these** + number + adjective + noun: *all the three boys, both my sisters, half the cake, double the price, twice the distance*.
- **+ of with a pronoun:** *all of us, both of them, half of it, some of them, many of you*. A pronoun needs *of*: ~~both them~~, ~~some us~~.
- **All vs whole:** *all the class = the whole class* (whole follows the article: ~~the all class~~, ~~all class~~). *Whole* with singular count nouns, *all* with plural or uncountable.
- **Both…and** is for two only; for three or more use *all*: ~~both of the three~~ → *all the three*.
- **Half:** *half an hour* / *an hour and a half* / *half the time*, never ~~a half hour~~ (informal only).
- **What / such / quite / rather + a(n):** *What a beautiful day! Such a pity! Quite a nice idea. Rather an easy paper.* Plural/uncountable: *What beautiful flowers! Such people!*
- **Such vs so:** *such a big house = so big a house*; *so* needs an adjective (~~so a big house~~).

1.7 Distributives and Reciprocals

Word	Pattern and trap	Correct form
each / every	**singular** verb and singular pronoun; *every* has no *of*	*Each* of the girls **has** her pen. · *Every* girl **has** her pen. ~~Every of the girls~~
either / neither	for **two** only; with 'of' + plural noun/pronoun	*Either* of the two **is** fine. · *Neither* of them **was** present. For more than two: *any / none*
each other / one another	reciprocal; *each other* for two, *one another* for more (modern usage mixes)	They hate *each other*. · The students helped *one another*.
another / other / the other / others / the others	*another* + singular; *other* + plural; *the other* = remaining one of **two**; *others* stands alone	Have *another* mango. · Show me *other* designs. · One is a pen; *the other* is a pencil.
the other day / other than / every other	idioms	I met him *the other day* (recently). · No one *other than* you knew.

1.8 Possessives and Demonstratives at Advanced Level

- **Double possessive** (*of* + possessive): *a friend of mine, this book of yours, a poem of Tagore's* (not ~~a my friend~~, ~~this your book~~).
- **Own** after a possessive: *my own house*, not ~~an own house~~; *of one's own*.
- **Possessive before a gerund:** *I dislike **his** coming late. / She insisted on **my** staying.* (Object form is acceptable informally; use possessive in board answers.)
- **Parts of the body / clothes:** use *his / her* with a possessive, but use *the* after a preposition when the person is the object: *He hit **me on the** head. / She caught him **by the** arm.* (but *He hurt **his** leg.*)
- **Its / it's, whose / who's, their / there / they're** — apostrophe errors are routinely planted in editing items.

- **Demonstrative + of**: *this is one of those problems that…* (plural noun); *those who work hard…* (those = people).
- **This kind / sort / type of** takes a singular noun; *these kinds of* takes a plural: *This kind of mango is sweet. / These kinds of mangoes are sweet.*
- **What vs which:** *what* = open choice (*What colour do you like?*), *which* = limited choice (*Which of these two colours do you like?*). *Whichever / whatever* = any one at all.

1.9 Board-level Error Patterns

Wrong	Right	Why
He is a poet and a novelist and he has retired. (one man)	He is *a* poet and novelist …	article not repeated for one person
She is wearing a red and a white sari. (one sari)	…a red and white sari.	one sari
I met a Mr Rao yesterday, my old teacher.	I met *Mr* Rao yesterday, my old teacher.	'a Mr' only for an unknown person
The Delhi has many monuments.	Delhi has many monuments.	no article with a plain city name
The rich man should help the poor man.	The rich should help the poor.	class of people
Both the three boys were selected.	*All the three* boys were selected.	both = two
Half a hour is enough.	*Half an hour* is enough.	'an' by sound; 'half' as noun
Almost people like music.	*Most* people like music.	almost + adjective/pronoun, not noun
There were less students than last year.	…*fewer* students…	countable
Both of them is right.	Both of them *are* right.	both takes a plural verb
Every one of the girls have won.	Every one of the girls *has* won.	distributive singular
The all students came.	*All the* students came.	pre-determiner before the
He is an own boss.	He is *his own* boss.	own follows a possessive
It was such a nice weather.	It was *such nice weather* / *so nice a day*.	weather is uncountable; no 'a'

REMEMBER

Editing routine (25 seconds per line): (1) circle every noun; (2) ask *one or two?* when two nouns are joined by *and*; (3) check **a/an/the/zero** against rule 1.1–1.4; (4) check quantifier vs countable/uncountable; (5) check *every/each/either/neither* verbs; (6) check *both/all/half* order; (7) check apostrophe words (*its, whose, their*).

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- One article = one person/thing; repeat the article for two. *A poet and novelist* (one) vs *a poet and a novelist* (two).
- Proper noun with a describing phrase takes *the*; unknown 'a Mr Sharma'; plain city/country name takes none.
- The + adjective = a class of people, plural verb; abstract/material noun with of-phrase takes *the*.
- quite a few / not a few = many; only a few = hardly any; no fewer than / no less than express surprise at a large number.
- Pre-determiner order: all/both/half + the/my/these + number + adjective + noun; a pronoun after all/both/some needs *of*.
- *Each, every, either, neither* are singular; *both* is plural and means two; *half an hour* not *a half hour*.
- Double possessive: *a friend of mine*; possessive before gerund: *his coming*; *own* needs a possessive.

CHAPTER 02 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 2

Tenses: Advanced Usage and Board Traps

In board editing, gap-filling and reported-speech tasks the tense is rarely chosen by form alone: it is fixed by a time word (ago, since, by, already), by another verb in the sentence (sequence of tenses) or by the kind of text (news report, narration, instructions). This chapter covers the special uses, the contrasts and the clause-level rules that decide those answers.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 8): formation of all 12 tenses in four sentence types, basic uses, key words, *since/for*, the future-time forms and the verb 'eat' model. These are assumed here.

2.1 Present Tenses: Special Uses

Tense	Special / exam use	Example
Simple Present	**Timetable / scheduled future** (train, match, programme)	The train *leaves* at 6 p.m. · What time *does* the match *begin*?
	Historical present (vivid narration), **headlines**, **commentary**, **stage directions**	Shivaji *enters* the fort and *attacks*… · PM *LEAVES* FOR PARIS
	Reporting verbs of information (*I hear, gather, am told, understand*)	I *hear* that the school will reopen on Monday.
	Time/condition clause for the future	I will call you when he *arrives*. · If it *rains*, we shall stay.
Present Continuous	**Fixed arrangement in the near future**	We *are leaving* for Agra tomorrow.
	Habit that annoys (with *always, constantly, forever*)	He *is always losing* his keys.
	Temporary situation vs permanent	I *am staying* with a cousin. / I *live* in Jaipur.
	***is being* + adjective** = behaving that way for now	He *is being* rude today. (He is not rude by nature.)
Present Perfect	**Experience / first time**: *It is the first time … has/have + V3*	This is the first time I *have flown*. · It is the third time he *has failed*.
	Result visible now; **unfinished period** (today, this week, this year)	I *have lost* my pen (I do not have it). · She *has written* three letters this morning.
Present Perfect Continuous	**Duration up to now (activity may still go on)**; recently ended activity with visible result	She *has been teaching* for ten years. · Your eyes are red; you *have been crying*.

▸ Stative verbs rarely take the continuous

Verbs of *state, feeling, thinking, possession and senses* (**know, believe, understand, remember, forget, like, love, hate, prefer, want, need, wish, belong, own, owe, seem, appear, consist, contain, depend, resemble, hear, see, smell, taste**) are normally used in the simple tense, even with *since/for*: ~~I am knowing him since 2010~~ → *I have known him since 2010.* They take the continuous only when the meaning is *active*.

Stative meaning (simple)	Active meaning (continuous)
I *see* what you mean. (understand)	I *am seeing* the doctor at five. (meeting)
He *has* a car. (possession)	He *is having* lunch. (eating)
It *smells/tastes* good.	She *is smelling/tasting* the soup.

Stative meaning (simple)	Active meaning (continuous)
I *think* he is right. (opinion)	I *am thinking* about my future. (process)
He *is* tall.	He *is being* silly.

2.2 Present Perfect vs Simple Past (the Commonest Board Error)

Present Perfect — connection with now	Simple Past — finished time, stated or understood
already, yet, just, ever, never, so far, till now, lately, recently, of late, how long, this week/month/year, since + point, for + period	yesterday, ago, last week, in 1999, once, then, at that time, when (question), the other day, a moment ago
I have just seen him.	*I saw him a moment ago.*
***Have you finished?* (now relevant)**	*When did you finish?* (~~When have you finished?~~)
***She has lived here since 2015.* (still lives)**	*She lived here in 2015.* (not now)
It is ten years since he left. = He left ten years ago. = He has been away for ten years.	—

IMPORTANT

Do **not** use the present perfect with a **definite past time**: ~~I have seen him yesterday~~ → *I saw him yesterday.* Do **not** use the simple past with *since + point* when the action continues: ~~I knew him since 2010~~ → *I have known him since 2010.* In a *since* sentence, the main verb is in the **perfect**, the *since* clause in the **simple past**: *He has not written since he **left**.*

2.3 Past Tenses: Order of Events and Special Forms

Pattern	Use	Example
Past Perfect + Simple Past	the earlier of two past actions	The patient *had died* before the doctor *came*. · When I *reached*, the train *had left*.
after + Past Perfect / before + Simple Past	only the earlier action takes had	*After* he *had finished*, he left. · He left *before* I *arrived* (or *had arrived*).
No sooner had … than / Hardly (Scarcely) had … when	one action instantly followed another; **inversion** with *had*, simple past in the second clause	*No sooner had* he *reached* than it *began* to rain. · *Hardly had* she *sat when* the phone *rang*.
It was the first time … + Past Perfect	experience in a past frame	It was the first time he *had seen* snow.
Past Continuous + Simple Past	an action in progress interrupted (**when**) or two parallel past actions (**while**)	I *was reading* when the light *went out*. · While she *cooked*, he *was watching* TV.
used to / would	past habit / (would = repeated action, not states)	We *used to live* in Kota. · Every summer we *would visit* our grandparents.
Past Perfect Continuous	duration before a past moment	She *had been waiting* for two hours when he came.
was going to / was about to / was to	**future in the past** (plan not carried out)	I *was going to call* you but forgot. · The train *was about to leave*.

NOTE

The past perfect is **not necessary** when the sequence is clear from *after / before / as soon as*: *As soon as he **saw** me, he ran.* Use it when the order would be unclear, or in **reported speech** (*He said that he **had finished***).

2.4 Sequence of Tenses (Tense Agreement)

If the **main verb is in the past tense**, the verb in the *subordinate clause* is also in a past form, matching the shift made in reported speech.

Main clause	Subordinate clause (changes to…)	Example
Past	Simple Present → Simple Past	He *said* that he *was* ill.
Past	Present Perfect → Past Perfect	I *knew* that she *had left*.
Past	Simple Past → Past Perfect (if earlier)	He *told* me he *had passed*.
Past	will / can / may → would / could / might	She *thought* he *would* come.
Present / Future	any tense as meaning requires	He *says* that he *was* ill. · I *shall tell* him that you *called*.

▸ Exceptions: no change of tense (the 'timeless' clauses)

- **Universal truth / scientific fact / proverb:** *The teacher **said** that the earth **moves** round the sun. · Our teacher **told** us that honesty **is** the best policy.*
- **Habitual action still true:** *He **said** that he **gets** up at five.*
- **Comparison with *than* / *as*:** *He **loved** her more than he **loves** his own life. · She **was** taller than I **am**.*
- **Clause of purpose:** *He **worked** hard that he **might** succeed.* (could / would / might)
- **A condition still true now:** *I **thought** the shop **closes** at nine.* (but the shift is safer in exam answers unless a fact is clearly timeless)

2.5 Tenses in Time and Condition Clauses

Rule	Wrong	Right
No *will/shall* after *when, before, after, until, as soon as, by the time, if, unless, once, while* in a clause about the future	~~I will call when he will come.~~	I will call when he *comes*.
Present perfect for a completed action in the future clause	~~I will go after I will finish.~~	I will go after I *have finished*.
***will* is correct in a noun clause (after *know, ask, wonder, doubt, don't know*)**	~~I don't know when he comes tomorrow.~~ (if future is meant)	I don't know when he *will come*.
***if you will = if you are willing* (polite request)**	—	*If you will wait*, I shall call the manager.
By the time + simple present → future perfect in the main clause	~~By the time you come, I will leave.~~	By the time you *come*, I *shall have left*.
***not … until / till* with future or past**	~~He will not come until you will call him.~~	He will not come until you *call* him.

2.6 Future Forms Compared

Form	Use	Example
will / shall	instant decision, promise, prediction, offer; (*shall* with I/we in offers and questions)	I'll help you. · Shall I open the window?
be going to	intention already decided, or prediction from present evidence	I am going to start a business. · Look at those clouds — it *is going to* rain.
Present continuous	fixed personal arrangement	I *am meeting* him at 4.
Simple present	timetable, calendar	The school *reopens* on 5 July.

Form	Use	Example
be about to	immediate future	The train *is about to* start.
be to	official plan, command, destiny	The PM *is to visit* Japan next week. · You *are to report* at nine.
Future Perfect	completed *by* a future time	By June I *shall have finished* the course.
Future Continuous	in progress at a future time; polite enquiry	At this time tomorrow I *shall be flying*. · *Will you be using* the car tonight?

IMPORTANT

Shall/will for determination. Normal: *I/we* ***shall***; *you/he/she/it/they* ***will***. To express **determination, promise or threat** the forms are reversed: *I* ***will*** *win.* (determination) · *You* ***shall*** *have it.* (promise) · *He* ***shall*** *pay for this.* (threat).

2.7 Other Tense-based Structures Tested in Boards

Structure	Rule	Example
It is (high) time + Simple Past	present/future situation, **past form**, no *to* when a subject is present	It is *time* you *went* to bed. · It is high time we *started*.
would rather + subject + past	preference about another person (unreal present)	I would rather you *stayed* here.
as if / as though + past	unreal comparison (*were* for all persons)	He talks *as if* he *were* the boss.
wish / if only + past / past perfect	regret about present / past	I wish I *knew* the answer. · If only I *had listened*.
It is + period + since + Simple Past	time elapsed	It is *five years since* he *left*.
This is the first time + Present Perfect	experience	This is the first time I *have seen* the sea.
Hope / suppose / imagine + present for future	after *hope* the future is often present	I *hope* he *comes* tomorrow. (also: will come)

2.8 Tense Selection in Passages (Editing / Gap-filling)

Type of passage	Dominant tense(s)	Clues
Story / narrative	Simple Past; Past Continuous for background; Past Perfect for earlier events	once upon a time, one day, suddenly, when, had already
News report	Simple Past for events; Present Perfect for the headline fact; present for headlines	yesterday, on Monday, has been arrested, officials said
Description of a process / procedure	Simple Present (often passive)	first, then, after that, is added, is boiled
Biography	Simple Past + Present Perfect for achievements still relevant	was born, has won, has written
Letter / report of a recent event	Present Perfect for news; Simple Past for the event itself	I am writing to say that…, last week we organised

REMEMBER

Passage method: (1) Read the whole passage and fix its **time frame**. (2) Underline the **time words** and the **verb in the nearest clause**. (3) Check *since/for/ago/yet/already/just/by/before*. (4) Check subject–verb agreement *after* fixing the tense.

2.9 Error Patterns and Corrections

Wrong	Right	Rule
He is living here since 1990.	He *has been living* here since 1990.	*since* → perfect continuous
I am knowing him well.	I *know* him well.	stative verb
She has gone to Delhi last week.	She *went* to Delhi last week.	definite past time
When have you come?	When *did* you come?	question with *when*
I will tell him when he will come.	…when he *comes*.	no future in time clause
If it will rain, we will stay.	If it *rains*, we shall stay.	no future in if-clause
He said that the earth *moved* round the sun.	…the earth *moves*…	universal truth
The train had left before I will reach.	…before I *reached*.	sequence of tenses
I have been to Mumbai in 2019.	I *went* to Mumbai in 2019.	definite time
It is time we should start.	It is time we *started*.	time + past
I wish I would be a pilot.	I wish I *were* a pilot.	wish + past
No sooner he came than it rained.	No sooner *had* he come…	inversion with *had*
Hardly he had left when it rained.	Hardly *had* he left when…	inversion with *had*
She was knowing the answer.	She *knew* the answer.	stative verb
By next year he will complete his degree.	By next year he *will have completed* his degree.	*by* → future perfect

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Present perfect = link with now (already/yet/just/ever/since/for); simple past = finished time (yesterday/ago/last/in 1999/when).
- Stative verbs (know, like, want, belong, seem…) do not take the continuous form.
- After since: perfect/perfect continuous in the main clause, simple past in the *since* clause; 'It is five years since he left'.
- Past perfect shows the earlier of two past actions; *no sooner had … than* and *hardly had … when* invert with *had*.
- Past main clause → past subordinate clause; exceptions: universal truths, habits, comparisons, purpose clauses.
- No will/shall in time and if-clauses (use the present); will is fine in noun clauses.
- It is (high) time / would rather / wish / as if take a **past** form with present meaning.
- By + future time → future perfect; narrative → past; news → past + present perfect; process → present passive.

CHAPTER 03 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 3

Subject-Verb Agreement: Advanced Cases

Agreement errors in board papers are almost never simple 'he go' mistakes. They hide in a long subject, a compound subject, an of-phrase, a relative clause, an inverted sentence or a word that looks plural but is singular. This chapter trains you to find the real subject in those structures and to settle doubtful cases by rule.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 9): the basic rule, *and* = plural, *each/every/either/neither* = singular, *as well as / with / along with*, *or / nor* proximity, common collective nouns, singular-looking plurals (news, mathematics), *a number of / the number of*, fractions, titles, amounts, *there is/are*. These 20 rules are assumed here.

3.1 Two Principles that Settle Doubtful Cases

Principle	Meaning	Example
Concord (grammatical)	The verb agrees with the **head noun of the subject** (the main word), not the noun nearest to the verb	*The cost of the repairs **is** high. · A bouquet of roses **was** presented.*
Proximity	Where subjects are joined by *or, nor, either…or, neither…nor, not only…but also*, the verb agrees with the **nearer** subject	*Neither the teacher nor the students **were** present. · Neither the students nor the teacher **was** present.*
Notional agreement	Verb follows the **idea** (unit or individuals), not the form	*Ten years **is** a long time. · The jury **are** divided in opinion.*

3.2 Long and Disguised Subjects

- **Phrases between subject and verb are ignored:** *The quality of the mangoes **is** poor. · The boy, along with his parents, **has** arrived. · The price of vegetables **has** risen.*
- **Subject after the verb (inversion):** find the subject by asking *who/what + verb? — Among the winners **were** a girl and two boys. · Never **has** he **seen** such a sight. · Here **come** the bride and groom. · On the table **lie** a pen and a book.*
- **Questions:** *Where **are** my keys? How **is** your brother? What **are** the symptoms?*
- **Infinitive / gerund / clause as subject → singular:** *To err **is** human. · Swimming **is** healthy. · What he said **was** true. · That he failed **surprises** everyone.* A *what*-clause normally takes a singular verb: *What we need **is** discipline.*
- **Two nouns, one idea (joined by *and*) → singular:** *Bread and butter **is** my breakfast. · Rice and curry **is** a popular dish. · The poet and statesman **was** honoured* (one man); *The poet and the statesman **were** honoured* (two men).

3.3 Compound Subjects: the Full Picture

Pattern	Verb agrees with	Example
A and B (two persons/things)	plural	Ram and Shyam **are** friends.
Each / every / many a + A and B	singular	*Every boy and girl **has** a book. · Many a boy and girl **has** failed.*
A or / nor B	nearer subject	Either you or he **is** guilty. · Neither Ravi nor his friends **were** there.
Either/neither of + plural	singular (formal)	Neither of the two answers **is** right.
not only A but also B	nearer (B)	Not only the boys but also the girl **was** late.

Pattern	Verb agrees with	Example
A as well as / in addition to / together with / besides / rather than / no less than B	**A** (first subject)	The teacher, as well as the students, **was** tired. · Honesty, rather than wealth, **is** the key.
Not A but B	B (nearer)	Not the actors but the director **was** praised.
A and also B / A with B	as per the phrase (A)	The captain with his men **is** coming.
Both A and B; all of them	plural	Both the brothers **are** doctors.
One of / each of / none of + plural noun	one, each → singular; *none* → singular (formal) or plural (informal)	One of the books **is** missing. · None of them **has / have** come.

IMPORTANT

Person rule with proximity: *Either you or I **am** wrong. · Neither he nor I **am** ready. · Either he or you **are** right.* If the awkward order troubles you, put the **plural subject nearest the verb**: *Neither the teacher nor the students **are** ready.*

3.4 Collective Nouns, Quantity Words and 'of' Phrases

Subject	Verb	Why	Example
Collective noun — acting as one unit	singular	committee, team, jury, family, class, army, staff, crew, audience	The committee **has** decided. · The class **is** noisy.
Collective noun — members acting individually	plural	emphasis on persons	The committee **are** divided in their opinions. · The staff **have** taken their seats.
the police, the people, cattle, poultry, clergy, gentry, the public (people)	plural	always plural in form	The police **have** arrested him. · The cattle **are** grazing.
a number of + plural / the number of + plural	plural / singular	*a number of* = many; *the number of* = the count	A number of students **are** absent. · The number of students **is** small.
a variety of / a series of / a range of / a pair of / a couple of / a group of	plural (quantity sense) when meaning *several*	the *of*-noun decides	A variety of books **are** on sale. · A pair of shoes **is** on the table (the pair = one).
the variety / the pair / the series of	singular	head noun is the first noun	The variety of food **is** amazing.
a lot of / plenty of / most of / all of / some of / half of / the rest of / the remainder of / the majority of	agrees with the noun **after of**	the *of*-noun is the real quantity	*Most of the **milk** is spoilt. / Most of the **students** are present. · A lot of **work** has been done.*
more than one + singular noun	singular	despite 'more'	More than one candidate **has** withdrawn.
more than two / less than two	plural		More than two students **have** failed.
Fractions, percentages, 'two-thirds of'	by the noun after *of*		Two-thirds of the land **is** barren. · Forty per cent of the voters **were** women.
one in ten / one or two	plural verb for 'one or two'		One or two mistakes **are** acceptable.

Subject	Verb	Why	Example
Distance, time, money, weight, measure	singular	one unit	Ten kilometres **is** a long walk. · Fifty rupees **is** enough.
the + adjective (class of people)	plural		The poor **are** suffering. · The young **are** impatient.

3.5 Relative Clauses and Cleft Sentences

- **Relative pronouns *who / which / that*** take the verb in the person and number of their **antecedent**: *He is one of the boys who **are** always late.* (antecedent = boys, plural)
- **'one of the … who/that' = plural; 'the only one of the … who/that' = singular:** *Ravi is one of those students who **work** hard. · Ravi is the only one of the students who **has** passed.*
- **'It is I who am', 'It is you who are', 'It is he who is':** the relative verb follows the **pronoun before 'who'**: *It is I who **am** responsible.* (~~It is I who is~~ is wrong)
- **'You and I', 'he and I' (first person plural idea):** *You and I **are** friends. · My brother and I **were** there.*
- **Words ending in -s** that are singular: **mathematics, physics, economics, politics, ethics, news, measles, mumps, athletics, gymnastics, billiards, innings, summons, series, species, means (a way), headquarters (usually singular)**. *Means* in the sense *wealth* is plural: *His means **are** limited.*
- **Always plural** (no singular): **scissors, trousers, jeans, spectacles, binoculars, pliers, tongs, clothes, goods, riches, thanks, belongings, savings, earnings, congratulations, annals**. But *a pair of scissors **is*** on the table (the *pair* is the subject).

3.6 Pronoun–Antecedent Agreement (Often Tested with Verbs)

Antecedent	Pronoun	Example
each, every, one, everyone, everybody, someone, anybody, nobody, either, neither	he / she / his / her (or *one's* after *one*); modern formal English accepts *their*	*Everyone must do **his or her** work. · One must do **one's** duty.*
Collective noun as a unit	it / its	*The team has won **its** first match.*
Collective noun as individuals	they / their	*The team have taken **their** places.*
Two antecedents joined by or / nor	agrees with the nearer one	*Neither Ravi nor his brothers brought **their** books.*
Pronoun with *as well as*	agrees with the first subject	*The captain as well as the players has done **his** best.*
Uncountable / abstract	it	*Water is scarce, so **it** must be saved.*

3.7 Agreement in Special Tenses and Moods

- **Past of *be*:** *was* for I / he / she / it / singular; *were* for you / we / they / plural — and *were* for **all persons in unreal conditions** (*If I **were** you…, I wish he **were** here*).
- **'Do / does / did':** *Does* the rule apply to **each** of them? (singular) · Why **do** the police arrive late? (plural noun *police*)
- **'Have / has' in perfect tenses:** *The news **has** (not have) arrived. · Neither of the boys **has** come.*
- **Subjunctive:** after *demand, insist, suggest, recommend, propose, order + that*, the verb stays in the base form: *She insisted that he **go**. · It is essential that every student **be** present.*

3.8 Board-style Error Patterns

Wrong	Right	Rule
The cost of the books are high.	The cost of the books *is* high.	head noun = cost
A number of student is absent.	A number of *students are* absent.	a number of + plural
The number of students are small.	The number of students *is* small.	the number of → singular
Neither of the boys have come.	Neither of the boys *has* come.	neither = singular
Each of the girls have a prize.	Each of the girls *has* a prize.	each = singular
He is one of those who works hard.	…one of those who *work* hard.	antecedent = those
Mathematics are difficult.	Mathematics *is* difficult.	singular noun with -s
The police has arrested him.	The police *have* arrested him.	plural collective
Two-thirds of the students was absent.	…of the students *were* absent.	fraction + plural noun
Ten miles are a long distance.	Ten miles *is* a long distance.	measure as a unit
The teacher with his students are here.	The teacher with his students *is* here.	with ≠ and
Neither you nor I is wrong.	Neither you nor I *am* wrong.	proximity (person)
More than one student are absent.	More than one student *is* absent.	more than one + singular
Bread and butter are his breakfast.	Bread and butter *is* his breakfast.	single idea
It is I who is to blame.	It is I who *am* to blame.	antecedent = I
Where is my glasses?	Where *are* my glasses?	glasses = plural
All the milk were spilt.	All the milk *was* spilt.	uncountable
There are a book and two pens on the desk.	There *is* a book and two pens on the desk.	*there* + verb agrees with the nearer subject

REMEMBER

Method for any agreement item: (1) cross out every phrase beginning with a preposition between subject and verb; (2) find the head noun; (3) decide *unit or individuals* for collective nouns; (4) apply *proximity* for or/nor; (5) check for inversion (*there / here / not only / never / among*); (6) check pronouns that refer back to the subject.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- The verb agrees with the **head noun** of the subject, not the nearest noun; ignore phrases between them.
- Or / nor / either…or / neither…nor / not only…but also → **nearer** subject; as well as / with / along with → **first** subject.
- *A number of* + plural → plural verb; *the number of* → singular; *more than one* + singular → singular verb.
- Words like *most of, a lot of, half of, two-thirds of* take the number of the noun after *of*.
- *One of the … who* → plural verb; *the only one of the … who* → singular verb; *It is I who am*.
- Singular -s words: mathematics, news, politics, measles, innings; always plural: scissors, trousers, police, cattle, goods.
- Infinitive, gerund and clause subjects are singular; inverted sentences hide the subject after the verb.
- Subjunctive after demand / insist / suggest + *that*: base verb (*go*, *be*).

CHAPTER 04 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 4

Non-finites: Advanced Patterns

At board level non-finites are tested through verb patterns (does this verb take -ing or to?), participle clauses (who is doing the action?), dangling modifiers, meaning changes (stop, remember, try) and perfect/passive forms. These are also the structures that make writing compact and mature. This chapter covers them in exam order.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 11): finite vs non-finite, uses of the *to*-infinitive, bare infinitive after modals, gerund as noun, present/past participle as adjective, gerund vs participle, *to* as preposition, infinitive of purpose. These are assumed here.

4.1 Full Forms of the Non-finites

	Infinitive	Gerund	Participle
Simple (active)	(to) do	doing	doing / done
Continuous	(to) be doing	—	—
Perfect (earlier action)	(to) have done	having done	having done
Passive	(to) be done	being done	being done / done
Perfect passive	(to) have been done	having been done	having been done
Example	He seems *to have finished*. · I want *to be told*.	She regrets *having lied*. · He hates *being laughed at*.	*Having finished*, he left. · *Being warned*, he stopped.

IMPORTANT

Use the **perfect** form when the non-finite action is **earlier** than the main verb: *He claims to have met the Prime Minister.* (claims now, met earlier) · *She denied having seen him.* Use the **passive** form when the subject receives the action: *The work needs to be done / needs doing.*

4.2 Participle Clauses: Shortening Sentences

Meaning	Full sentence	Participle clause
Time (at the same time)	While he was walking home, he met a friend.	*Walking home*, he met a friend.
Time (earlier action)	After he had finished his work, he went out.	*Having finished his work*, he went out.
Reason	Because he was tired, he slept early.	*Being tired*, he slept early.
Reason (earlier)	As he had lost his way, he asked a policeman.	*Having lost his way*, he asked a policeman.
Condition	If it is carefully handled, it will last.	*Carefully handled*, it will last.
Result	He fired, and killed the deer.	He fired, *killing* the deer.
Description (passive)	The boy, who was punished, wept.	*Punished*, the boy wept.
Concession	Though he was warned, he went on.	*Though warned*, he went on.

IMPORTANT

Same-subject rule: the participle's doer must be the **subject of the main clause**. Otherwise it 'dangles'.

▸ Dangling participles and their repairs

Wrong (dangling)	Corrected
***Walking down the road*, the trees looked beautiful.**	*Walking down the road*, **I** saw beautiful trees. / As **I** walked down the road, the trees looked beautiful.
***Having finished the work*, the bell rang.**	*Having finished the work*, **we** heard the bell. / After **we** had finished, the bell rang.
***Being a rainy day*, the match was cancelled.**	*It being a rainy day*, the match was cancelled. (absolute) / As it was a rainy day, …
***Entering the room*, the fan was on.**	*Entering the room*, **I** found the fan on.
***Tired after the journey*, a bath was welcome.**	*Tired after the journey*, **he** welcomed a bath.

▸ Absolute constructions and fixed participles

- **Nominative absolute** (own subject): *The sun **having set**, we returned.* · *Weather **permitting**, the match will be held.* · *It **being** Sunday, the office was closed.*
- **Participles that are conventionally allowed to 'dangle'** (they function like prepositions): *generally speaking, strictly speaking, judging from, considering, talking of, taking everything into account, provided/providing, given, granted, supposing*.
- **Never join two unrelated subjects with a participle** in a transformation answer; if the subjects differ, use the absolute form or keep the finite clause.

4.3 Verb Patterns: Gerund, Infinitive or Both?

Pattern	Verbs and expressions
+ gerund only	admit, avoid, appreciate, consider, delay, deny, detest, dislike, enjoy, escape, excuse, face, fancy, finish, give up, imagine, involve, keep (on), mention, mind, miss, postpone, practise, put off, recall, resent, resist, risk, suggest, understand, can't help, can't stand, it's no use / no good, it's worth, be busy, feel like, look forward to, object to, be used to, be accustomed to, insist on, succeed in, prevent … from, in addition to, with a view to, on (+ ing = as soon as)
+ to-infinitive only	afford, agree, aim, appear, arrange, ask, attempt, beg, care, choose, claim, consent, dare, decide, demand, deserve, expect, fail, happen, hesitate, hope, learn, manage, mean (intend), neglect, offer, plan, prepare, pretend, promise, prove, refuse, seem, swear, tend, threaten, turn out, volunteer, wait, want, wish
verb + object + to-infinitive	advise, allow, ask, beg, cause, command, compel, encourage, enable, expect, forbid, force, get, instruct, invite, oblige, order, permit, persuade, remind, request, teach, tell, urge, want, warn
verb + object + bare infinitive	make, let, have (causative), see, hear, watch, notice, feel, observe, help (*help him (to) do*)
+ gerund or infinitive, little change	begin, start, continue, like, love, hate, prefer, intend, can't bear, attempt: *It started raining / to rain.*
+ gerund or infinitive, meaning changes	see §4.4

> **NOTE**
> **Passive of perception and causative verbs takes *to*:** *He **made** me wait.* → *I **was made to wait**.* · *They **saw** him enter.* → *He **was seen to enter**.* · *I **heard** her sing.* → *She **was heard to sing**.* (The bare infinitive returns in the active.)

4.4 Verbs that Change Meaning

Verb	+ gerund	+ to-infinitive
remember	remember an earlier action: *I remember **locking** the door.*	remember a duty: *Remember **to lock** the door.*
forget	forget something done: *I'll never forget **meeting** her.*	forget a duty: *Don't forget **to post** the letter.*
regret	regret a past act: *I regret **telling** him.*	regret to inform / say: *I regret **to say** you failed.*
stop	end an activity: *He stopped **smoking**.*	stop in order to: *He stopped **to smoke**.*
try	experiment: *Try **adding** salt.*	make an effort: *Try **to finish** early.*
go on	continue the same activity: *He went on **talking**.*	move on to a new one: *He went on **to talk** about sports.*
mean	involve: *This job means **working** late.*	intend: *I meant **to call** you.*
need / want / deserve / require	passive sense: *The car needs **washing** (= **to be washed**).*	active sense: *I need **to wash** the car.*
like / love / hate / prefer	enjoy in general: *I like **swimming**.*	choose / habit for a particular time: *I like **to get** up early.* · *Would you like **to come**?*
be afraid	*I'm afraid of **falling**.*	*I'm afraid **to go** alone.* (too scared to)

4.5 More Infinitive Structures Tested in Boards

- **too … to / enough … to / so … as to / in order to / so as to:** *He is **too weak to walk**.* (negative) · *He is **strong enough to lift** it.* · *He was **so kind as to help** us.*
- **only to** (unhappy result): *He ran to the station, **only to find** the train gone.*
- **adjective + to-infinitive:** *easy to solve, sure to win, ready to go, glad to meet.* **Noun + to-infinitive:** *a house **to let**, time **to leave**, the first **to arrive**, nothing **to eat**, a chance **to win**.*
- **wh-word + to:** *I don't know **what to do**. She told me **where to go**.* (*Why* never takes *to*.)
- **It + be + adjective + (of/for) + to:** *It is kind **of** you to help. / It is easy **for** me to solve this.* (*of* = character; *for* = situation)
- **Absolute infinitive phrases:** *to be honest, to tell the truth, to cut a long story short, to begin with, needless to say, so to speak.*
- **Bare infinitive after:** *had better, would rather, would sooner, why not, cannot but, do nothing but, rather than, let's, help*: *You **had better go**.* · *He did nothing but **laugh**.* · *I cannot but **admire** him.*
- **Be + to-infinitive** (plan, order, fate): *The Prime Minister **is to address** the nation.* · *He **was never to return**.*
- **Split infinitive** (*to boldly go*) should be avoided in formal writing: *to go boldly*.

4.6 More Gerund Structures Tested in Boards

- **Possessive + gerund:** *I dislike **his shouting**.* · *She insisted on **my staying**.* (not ~~*I dislike him shouting*~~ in formal English)
- **Preposition + gerund (never to-infinitive):** *Instead of **going**, after **finishing**, without **saying**, by **working** hard, fond of **reading**, capable of **doing**, interested in **learning**, good at **swimming**.* ***To* as a preposition** also takes a gerund: *look forward **to meeting**, be used **to waking** early, object **to paying**.*
- **Fixed patterns:** *It is no use **crying** over spilt milk.* · *There is no point **in arguing**.* · *It is worth **visiting**.* · *He is busy **writing**.* · *I have difficulty **in understanding** it.* · *He spent two hours **reading**.* · *It is not worth **the trouble** / worth **trying**.*
- **Gerund after *on / upon*** = as soon as: *On reaching home, he called us.* (= As soon as he reached)
- **Gerund as subject → singular verb:** *Reading novels **is** my hobby.*

4.7 Participle Adjectives: -ing vs -ed

-ing (cause / active)	-ed (feeling / passive)
The film was boring / interesting / shocking / tiring.	I was **bored / interested / shocked / tired**.
It was a surprising result.	He looked **surprised**.
a running tap, falling leaves, a sleeping child	a **fallen** tree, a **lost** purse, **fried** rice, **frozen** water

4.8 Error Patterns and Corrections

Wrong	Right	Rule
He enjoys to play cricket.	He enjoys *playing* cricket.	enjoy + gerund
She decided going home.	She decided *to go* home.	decide + to
I look forward to meet you.	I look forward to *meeting* you.	to = preposition
He was made work late.	He was made *to work* late.	passive of *make*
I am used to get up early.	I am used to *getting* up early.	be used to + gerund
Walking in the park, a snake bit him.	Walking in the park, *he was bitten by a snake*.	dangling participle
He stopped to smoke. (he gave it up)	He stopped *smoking*.	meaning of *stop*
It was kind for you to help me.	It was kind *of* you to help me.	of / for
I insisted him to go.	I insisted *on his going*.	insist on + possessive + gerund
He suggested to go out.	He suggested *going* out.	suggest + gerund
I am interested to learn music.	I am interested *in learning* music.	preposition + gerund
I remember to meet him last year.	I remember *meeting* him last year.	remember + gerund = past act
The car needs to wash.	The car needs *washing* / *to be washed*.	passive sense
I cannot but to admire him.	I cannot but *admire* him.	cannot but + bare infinitive

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Use the perfect form (to have done / having done) for an earlier action; passive (to be done / being done) when the subject receives the action.
- Participle clause: the doer must be the main-clause subject; otherwise it dangles. Absolute: *The sun having set, we left.*
- Gerund only: enjoy, avoid, finish, suggest, mind, deny, postpone, practise, can't help, look forward to, be used to, object to.
- To-infinitive only: decide, hope, refuse, promise, manage, fail, afford, want, plan, learn, offer, pretend, seem.
- Meaning changes: remember / forget / regret / stop / try / go on / mean / need.
- Passive of *make, see, hear* takes *to*: *He was made to wait. She was seen to leave.*
- Preposition (even *to*) + gerund; *had better / would rather / cannot but* + bare infinitive; *too … to* has a negative meaning.

CHAPTER 05 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 5

Relatives: Advanced Usage

Relative clauses are tested in gap-filling (which relative?), editing (wrong relative or wrong verb), omission (missing that / who) and transformation (join two sentences). At board level the difficulty lies in which relative is possible, when it can be dropped, prepositions with relatives, and reduced relative clauses.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 14): who / whom / whose / which / that / where / when / why, defining vs non-defining clauses, basic omission of the object relative, simple joining of sentences. These are assumed here.

5.1 When 'That' Is Preferred or Compulsory

Antecedent / context	Relative	Example
After superlatives and ordinals (*first, last, only, same, very*)	that	This is **the best** film **that** I have seen. · He was **the first** man **that** reached the top.
After all, everything, anything, nothing, something, much, little, none, no one	that	**All that** glitters is not gold. · There is **nothing that** I can do.
Antecedent is both a person and a thing (or a person with a thing)	that	He spoke of **the men and the machines that** had built the dam.
After a question beginning with who / which (avoid repeating *who*)	that	**Who** is the girl **that** won?
In cleft sentences (*It is … that …*)	that	**It was** Ravi **that** broke the glass. · **It is** English **that** unites us.
After a preposition stranded at the end	that (or none)	This is the pen **that** I wrote **with**.

IMPORTANT

'That' is never used: (a) in **non-defining** clauses (~~My uncle, that lives in Pune,…~~ → *My uncle, **who** lives in Pune,…*); (b) **directly after a preposition** (~~the house in that I live~~ → *the house **in which** I live*); (c) with a **comma before it**.

5.2 'Which', 'What' and the Sentence Relative

Use	Example
Which refers to a whole clause (comma before it)	He passed the test, **which** surprised everyone. · She helped the poor, **which** was nice of her.
Which in a non-defining clause about things	The Taj Mahal, **which** stands on the Yamuna, is a wonder.
What = *that which* (no antecedent)	I know **what** you did. · **What** I need is rest.
Whatever / whichever / whoever / whomever = *any … that*	Take **whichever** you like. · **Whoever** comes is welcome.
What is not used when an antecedent exists	~~All what he said~~ → *All **that** he said.* · ~~The thing what I want~~ → *The thing **that/which** I want.*
Which is not used after *all/everything/only*	~~everything which I had~~ → *everything **that** I had*

5.3 'Who / Whom / Whose' at Exam Level

- **Whom** is the **object** form and the form **after a preposition**: *The man **whom** I met… / The man **to whom** I spoke… / The man **who** I spoke **to**…* (stranded preposition; **who** is acceptable in informal speech, **whom** in board answers when the preposition comes first).
- **Whose** shows possession for **persons and things**: *a child **whose** parents work abroad · a house **whose** roof is red · a mountain **the top of which** is snowy* (formal alternative).
- **Quantifier + of + whom / which / whose** (very common in joined sentences): *He has three sons, **two of whom** are doctors. · I bought five books, **all of which** are novels. · She has many friends, **none of whom** lives here. · The students, **most of whose** parents were present, clapped.*
- **Who vs whom in questions inserted in the main clause:** *Who do you think **is** the best?* (*who* because it is the subject of *is*) · *Whom did you meet?*

5.4 Preposition + Relative

Informal (stranded)	Formal (preposition first)
The girl who I was talking to	The girl **to whom** I was talking
The pen that I wrote with	The pen **with which** I wrote
The house that I live in	The house **in which** I live
The man whom she was angry with	The man **with whom** she was angry
The result that we were waiting for	The result **for which** we were waiting

> **NOTE**
> After a preposition use **whom** (persons) or **which** (things) — **never *who* or *that***. When the preposition stays at the end, *who/that/none* may be used. **The verb decides the preposition:** *depend on, listen to, look at, laugh at, believe in, aim at* — keep it with the verb.

5.5 Relative Adverbs: Where, When, Why, and Their Equivalents

Relative adverb	Equals preposition + which	Examples
where	*in / at / on which*	This is the town **where** I was born. = …**in which** I was born.
when	*on / in / at which*	I remember the day **when** we met. = …**on which** we met.
why (after *the reason*)	*for which*	This is **the reason why** he left. = …**for which** he left. (also *the reason that*)
how (not used with *the way*)	*in which / that*	~~the way how he spoke~~ → *the way **(in which / that)** he spoke* or *how he spoke*

5.6 Omission of the Relative Pronoun

Can be dropped	Cannot be dropped
Object of the verb in a defining clause: *The book (that) I bought is old.*	**Subject** of the clause: *The man **who** lives next door is a doctor.* (~~The man lives next door…~~)
Object of a stranded preposition: *The girl (whom) I spoke to…*	In **non-defining** clauses: *Ravi, **who** is my cousin, … (never dropped)*
Relative adverb *when / why*: *the day (when) he came · the reason (why) he left*	**After a preposition:** *the man to **whom** I wrote* (cannot drop)

Can be dropped	Cannot be dropped
that after *the way: the way (that) he walks*	**Who / which as a subject after a comma** (non-defining): never dropped

IMPORTANT

Omission tasks: the missing word is most often *that* (after *so, such, said, thought*, or after a noun), *who/which/whom*, or a preposition before the relative. Fill with *that* when unsure and the antecedent is a thing; use *who* for persons.

5.7 Reduced Relative Clauses (Participle and Infinitive Phrases)

Full relative clause	Reduced form	Rule
The boy who is standing there is my brother.	The boy **standing** there is my brother.	active → *-ing*
The letters that were written by him are lost.	The letters **written** by him are lost.	passive → *V3*
The first man who reached the top was Tenzing.	The first man **to reach** the top was Tenzing.	after *first / last / only / superlative* → *to-infinitive*
I have a letter that I must write.	I have a letter **to write**.	need / purpose → *to-infinitive*
Delhi, which is the capital of India, is crowded.	Delhi, **the capital of India**, is crowded.	non-defining: **apposition**
The man who is in charge …	The man **in charge** …	*who is / which is* + adjective / preposition phrase → drop both

5.8 Joining Sentences with Relatives (Transformation Method)

Step 1 — Choose the sentence to become the relative clause
The sentence that gives *extra or identifying information*.

Step 2 — Replace the repeated noun with the relative
Person: *who / whom / whose*. Thing: *which / that*. Place: *where*. Time: *when*.

Step 3 — Place the clause next to its noun
*The boy **who won** is my cousin.*

Step 4 — Punctuate
Defining: **no commas**. Non-defining: **commas around** the clause.

Step 5 — Check agreement
Verb after the relative agrees with the antecedent: *a girl who **sings** / girls who **sing**.*

Two sentences	Joined
This is Ravi. His father is a pilot.	This is Ravi, **whose father is a pilot**.
He has two cars. Both are red.	He has two cars, **both of which are red**.
The book was missing. I had lent it to him.	The book **that I had lent him** was missing.
She won the race. It made us proud.	She won the race, **which made us proud**.
I know a place. Cheap books are sold there.	I know a place **where cheap books are sold**.
The man was rewarded. He had saved a child.	The man **who had saved a child** was rewarded.

5.9 Position and Punctuation Traps

- **Keep the relative clause next to its antecedent:** ~~He gave a book to the boy which was torn.~~ (ambiguous) → *He gave the boy **a book which was torn**.* · ~~I met a girl in the park who was singing.~~ → *I met **a girl who was singing** in the park.*
- **Commas matter for meaning:** *My brother **who lives in Pune** is a doctor.* (I have more than one brother) · *My brother, **who lives in Pune**, is a doctor.* (I have only one)
- **Verb agreement with the relative:** *one of the girls who **are**; the only one of the girls who **is**; I, who **am** …; You, who **are** ….*
- **Do not repeat the pronoun** inside the clause: ~~the man who he came~~ → *the man who came*; ~~the book which I bought it~~ → *the book which I bought*.

5.10 Error Patterns and Corrections

Wrong	Right	Rule
The man which helped me is a teacher.	The man *who/that* helped me …	person → who/that
This is the girl whom is my friend.	This is the girl *who* is my friend.	subject → who
All what he said was true.	All *that* he said was true.	all + that
The house in that I live is old.	The house in *which* I live is old.	no *that* after preposition
My uncle, that lives in Pune, is rich.	My uncle, *who* lives in Pune, is rich.	non-defining → who
She is the girl who I gave the book.	She is the girl *to whom* I gave the book.	missing preposition
He is one of the boys who is always late.	…who *are* always late.	antecedent = boys
The book, which I bought it, is lost.	The book, which I bought, is lost.	double object
This is the best which I can do.	This is the best *that* I can do.	superlative → that
He failed, that made us sad.	He failed, *which* made us sad.	sentence relative
The man whose his son won …	The man *whose son* won …	no extra possessive
I don't know the reason for he left.	I don't know the reason *why* he left.	relative adverb

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- *That* is compulsory after superlatives, ordinals, *all / everything / nothing / only*, and after person + thing; it is never used in non-defining clauses or directly after a preposition.
- *Which* can refer to a whole clause (comma before it); *what* = that which and has no antecedent.
- Preposition + relative: *to whom / in which* (never *who* / *that*); stranded preposition: *who / that / none*.
- Quantifier + of + whom / which / whose: *two of whom, all of which, most of whose*.
- Subject relatives cannot be dropped; object relatives can; non-defining relatives are never dropped.
- Reduced forms: *-ing* (active), *V3* (passive), *to-infinitive* (after first/last/only), apposition.
- Commas change meaning: no commas (defining), commas (non-defining). Verb after *who/which/that* agrees with the antecedent.

CHAPTER 06 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 6

Connectors: Advanced Usage

Connectors are the glue of editing, gap-filling, sentence-joining and writing tasks. Board questions test meaning (does the connector show contrast or reason?), grammar (what follows it — a clause, a noun or an -ing form?), position and punctuation, and parallel structure with correlatives. This chapter covers the finer distinctions and the inversion patterns.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 13): FANBOYS, *because / since / as*, *although / though*, correlatives (both…and, either…or, neither…nor), common linkers (however, therefore, moreover) and simple joining of sentences. These are assumed here.

6.1 Contrast and Concession

Connector	Followed by	Example	Trap
although / though / even though	a clause	*Although* he was tired, he worked on.	never with *but* / *yet* in the same sentence
in spite of / despite	noun / gerund / *the fact that* + clause	*In spite of* his illness, he came. · *Despite* being ill, … · *In spite of the fact that* he was ill, …	~~despite of~~; ~~in spite~~ (without *of*)
while / whereas	a clause (contrast of two facts)	Ravi is tall, *whereas* his brother is short.	*while* also means *at the same time*
however / nevertheless / nonetheless / still / yet / all the same / even so	sentence adverbs (own clause)	He was ill; *however*, he attended school.	**semicolon / full stop before, comma after**
but / yet	coordinating (clause)	He is poor *but* honest. · He tried hard, *yet* he failed.	can start a sentence
(as) … as / much as / adjective + though / as	inverted concession	*Poor though he was*, he was honest. · *Much as I like him*, I cannot agree. · *Try as he might*, he failed.	'as' and 'though' follow the adjective
however + adjective / adverb; no matter how / what	a clause	*However hard* he tried, he failed. · *No matter what* they say, …	*However* + adj before the subject
whether … or (not)	two alternatives	*Whether* you agree *or not*, I shall go.	not ~~whether … or if~~

6.2 Reason and Result

Connector	Use	Example
because / since / as / for	reason; *because* = main reason (answer to *why?*); *since / as* = known reason (usually first); *for* = formal, after a comma, never first	*Because* it rained, … · *Since* you insist, … · He wept, *for* he was sad.
because of / owing to / due to / on account of / thanks to	reason + **noun / gerund** (not a clause)	*Because of* the rain, the match was cancelled. · *Due to* illness… (*due to* is also used after *be*: *The delay was **due to** fog*)
now that / seeing that / in that / in view of	reason with a present situation	*Now that* you have come, we can begin.

Connector	Use	Example
so / therefore / thus / hence / consequently / as a result / accordingly	result	He was late; *therefore* he missed the bus. · It rained; *hence* the match was cancelled.
so … that / such … that	degree + result	He was *so* tired *that* he fell asleep. · It was *such* a cold day *that* we stayed in.
too … to / enough … to	degree + (negative) result	He is *too* young *to* vote. · He is old *enough* to vote.

NOTE

So vs so that: *so* (coordinator) gives a **result** after a comma: *It was late, **so** we left. So that* gives **purpose**: *We left early **so that** we could catch the train.* **Such** goes with a noun phrase, **so** with an adjective/adverb: *such a nice day = so nice a day*.

6.3 Purpose, Condition and Time

Group	Connectors and patterns	Examples
Purpose	so that / in order that + clause with *can/could/may/might/will/would*; **lest + should / base verb** (negative sense — no *not*); **in order to / so as to** + base verb; *for fear that*	*Work hard **lest** you **should fail**. · He worked hard **so that** he **might** succeed. · He rose early **so as to** catch the first bus.*
Condition	unless (= if … not); provided / providing (that); as / so long as; on condition that; in case; supposing; otherwise / or else	*Unless you work hard, you will fail. · Take an umbrella **in case** it rains. · Work hard, **otherwise** you will fail.*
Time	when, while, as, before, after, till / until, since, as soon as, once, the moment (that), by the time, whenever, every time, **no sooner … than, hardly / scarcely … when / before**	*As soon as he arrived, we left. · **The moment** he saw me, he ran. · **By the time** I reached, the show had begun.*
Addition	and, also, too, as well, besides, moreover, furthermore, in addition, what is more, not only … but also	*He is clever; **moreover**, he is hardworking.*
Comparison / Contrast of choice	rather than, instead of, either … or, whereas, on the other hand, in contrast	*He chose to walk **rather than** wait.*
Example / Emphasis / Summary	for example, for instance, such as, in particular, in fact, indeed, in short, in conclusion, to sum up, after all	*Many birds, **such as** crows and sparrows, nest here.*

IMPORTANT

In case vs if: *if* = condition for action; *in case* = precaution against a possibility. *I'll take a taxi **if** it rains.* (when it rains) · *I'll take an umbrella **in case** it rains.* (before it rains). **Unless** already has a negative sense: ~~unless you do not work~~ → *unless you work*.

6.3a Inversion After Negative and Restrictive Connectors

Pattern	Structure	Example
No sooner … than	No sooner + *had* + subject + V3 … **than** + simple past	*No sooner had* he *left* **than** it *began* to rain. (~~no sooner … when~~)
Hardly / Scarcely … when / before	Hardly + *had* + subject + V3 … **when** + simple past	*Hardly had* we *started* **when** it *rained*.

Pattern	Structure	Example
Not only … but also	Not only + auxiliary + subject + verb …, **but** + subject + *also* + verb	*Not only did* he *win*, **but** he *also* broke the record.
Neither … nor / Nor / Neither + auxiliary	inversion after a negative opener	*Neither* does he *nor* his brother *know* the answer. · He didn't come; *nor did* she.
Never / Seldom / Rarely / Little / Only then	auxiliary before the subject	*Seldom has* he *been* late. · *Only then did* I *realise* my mistake.
So / Such + clause beginning the sentence	*So* + adjective + *be* + subject	*So* great *was* his fame *that* …

6.4 Correlative Conjunctions and Parallel Structure

Pair	Rule	Right	Wrong
both … and	same grammatical form after each part; never *both … as well as*	He is *both* a poet *and* a painter.	~~both a poet and paints~~
either … or / neither … nor	parallel; *neither … nor* has no extra negative	*Either* come now *or* wait. · *Neither* he *nor* she came.	~~neither he nor she did not come~~
not only … but also	same form after both; *also* may be dropped	He is *not only* clever *but also* kind.	~~not only clever but he is kind~~
not … but	contrast of two parts of the same form	He is *not* a fool *but* a genius.	—
whether … or	alternatives, parallel	Tell me *whether* you will go *or* stay.	~~whether … or if~~
as … as / so … as / such … as	comparison / example	He is *as* tall *as* his brother. · He is *not so* tall *as* I.	~~as tall than~~
rather … than / would rather … than	bare infinitive after both	I would *rather* walk *than* wait.	~~rather to walk than waiting~~

REMEMBER

Parallelism: the words that follow the two halves of a correlative pair must belong to the **same part of speech or form**: *She likes **dancing** and **singing**.* (both gerunds), not *She likes dancing and to sing.*

6.5 Position and Punctuation of Connectors

Connector type	Pattern	Example
Subordinating (when, because, although)	comma **after** the clause if it comes **first**; no comma if it comes second	*Although* he was ill, he came. · He came *although* he was ill.
Coordinating (and, but, or, so, yet)	comma before when joining two **full** clauses	He studied hard, *but* he failed.
Sentence adverbs (however, therefore, moreover)	**semicolon / full stop before** + comma after; or enclosed in commas inside the clause	He was late; *however*, he got in. · He, *however*, did not mind.
Comma splice (error)	two clauses joined with only a comma	~~It rained, we stayed in.~~ → *It rained, **so** we stayed in.* / *It rained; we stayed in.*
Run-on / fused (error)	no punctuation	~~It rained we stayed in~~

6.6 Joining Sentences: the Choice of Connector

Given sentences	Joined sentence	Connector used
He was ill. He attended the class.	*Although* he was ill, he attended the class. / *In spite of* being ill, he attended …	contrast
It rained heavily. The match was cancelled.	*Because* it rained heavily, the match was cancelled. / It rained heavily; *therefore* …	reason / result
She is rich. She is not happy.	*Though* she is rich, she is not happy.	contrast
Work hard. You will fail.	*Unless* you work hard, you will fail. / Work hard, *otherwise* you will fail.	condition
He ran fast. He wanted to catch the train.	He ran fast *so that* he could catch the train.	purpose
He reached the station. The train left.	*No sooner had* he reached the station *than* the train left.	time (inversion)
He is clever. He is lazy.	*Though* he is clever, he is lazy.	contrast
He is clever. He is honest.	He is *not only* clever *but also* honest.	addition

6.7 Board-level Error Patterns

Wrong	Right	Rule
Although he was poor but he was honest.	Although he was poor, he was honest.	no *but* with *although*
Despite of the rain, we went out.	*Despite* the rain, we went out.	despite has no *of*
In spite he was ill, he came.	In spite *of* being ill, …	spite of
Because of he was late, he lost marks.	Because he was late, … / Because *of his being late*, …	clause vs noun
Due to he was ill, he left.	*Because* he was ill, he left. / *Due to illness*, he left.	due to + noun
No sooner he came when it rained.	*No sooner had* he come *than* it rained.	no sooner … than
Hardly had he come than it rained.	Hardly had he come *when* it rained.	hardly … when
Work hard lest you will fail.	Work hard lest you *should* fail.	lest + should
Lest you do not fail …	Lest you *fail* / *should fail* …	lest already negative
Not only he came but also stayed.	*Not only did he come* but he also stayed.	inversion
Both he as well as she came.	Both he *and* she came.	both … and
Unless you do not study, you will fail.	Unless you study, you will fail.	unless = if not
He is intelligent however he is lazy.	He is intelligent; *however*, he is lazy.	punctuation
Tell me if you will come or not.	Tell me *whether* you will come *or not*.	*whether … or not*

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Contrast: although / though + clause; in spite of / despite + noun or gerund; never *but* with *although*; *despite of* is wrong.
- Reason: because + clause; because of / owing to / due to + noun; *since / as* = known reason; *for* only after a comma.
- Purpose: so that + can/could/may/might; lest + should (already negative); in order to / so as to + base verb.
- *No sooner had … than* / *hardly had … when* / *not only did … but also*: auxiliary comes before the subject.
- Unless = if … not (no extra negative); in case = precaution; provided / as long as = condition.
- Correlatives need parallel forms after both halves: both … and, either … or, neither … nor, not only … but also.
- However / therefore / moreover: semicolon (or full stop) before, comma after — a comma alone is a comma splice.

CHAPTER 07 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 7

Conditionals, Wishes and Unreal Situations: Advanced

At board level conditionals are tested as sentence transformation (if ↔ unless, if ↔ inversion, if ↔ compound/simple), in editing (wrong tense in the if-clause or result clause) and in gap-filling (wish, as if, would rather, it is time). This chapter covers every variant beyond the four basic types.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 15): zero, first, second and third conditionals with their basic structures, *unless*, *provided that*, *in case* and the simple use of *wish*. These are assumed here.

7.1 The Four Types, Extended with Modals and Variants

Type	If-clause	Main clause	Variants worth knowing
Zero (general truth)	if + present	present / imperative	*If you heat ice, it melts.* · *If you see him, tell him.* (*when* is possible)
First (real / likely future)	if + present (also *should*, *were to*, *will* for willingness)	will / shall / can / may / must / might / imperative	*If you **should** see him, give him this.* (unlikely but possible) · *If you **will** wait, I'll call him.* (= are willing to) · *If he **comes**, tell me.*
Second (unreal / improbable present or future)	if + past (***were* for all persons**); *were to* + base	would / could / might + base	*If I **were** you, I **would** accept.* · *If he **were to** come, we **could** begin.* · *If I **had** wings, I **could** fly.*
Third (unreal past)	if + past perfect	would / could / might + **have + V3**	*If you **had worked**, you **would have passed**.* · *If I **had known**, I **might have helped**.*

IMPORTANT

Never *would* in the if-clause: ~~If I would know, I would tell you.~~ → *If I **knew**, I **would** tell you.* (Exception: *would* = willingness in a polite request: *If you **would** wait a moment, ….*) **Were, not *was*,** in formal and board answers: *If I **were** a bird…*

7.2 Mixed Conditionals

Mix	Pattern	Example
Past cause → present result	if + past perfect, would + base	*If he **had taken** the medicine, he **would be** well now.*
Present state → past result	if + past, would have + V3	*If she **were** more careful, she **would not have made** that mistake.*
Present state → present unreal result with 'could'	if + past perfect, could + base	*If I **had studied** medicine, I **could treat** you now.*

Test: ask *when* the condition and *when* the result belong. If the times differ, use the mixed pattern.

7.3 Inverted Conditionals (If Omitted)

In formal writing and in board transformations, *if* can be dropped when the clause begins with *were, had* or *should*; the **auxiliary comes before the subject**.

With 'if'	Without 'if' (inversion)	Type
***If I were* you, I would apply.**	***Were I** you, I would apply.*	second

With 'if'	Without 'if' (inversion)	Type
***If he were to come*, we would be happy.**	***Were he to come**, we would be happy.*	second
***If you had asked* me, I would have helped.**	***Had you asked** me, I would have helped.*	third
***If it should rain*, we will cancel the picnic.**	***Should it rain**, we will cancel the picnic.*	first (formal)
***If they had not warned us*, we would have been late.**	***Had they not warned** us, …*	negative: **not after the subject**

> **NOTE**
> In inverted forms **do not contract and do not put *not* before the subject**: ~~Hadn't they warned us~~ → *Had they **not** warned us*.

7.4 Unless, Provided, As Long As, In Case, Otherwise and Other Substitutes for 'if'

Word / phrase	Meaning	Example	Note
unless	if … not (**exception**)	*Unless you hurry, you will miss the bus. = If you do not hurry …*	no negative verb after *unless*; mainly used with **real** conditions; **not with a question**: ~~Unless will he come?~~
provided / providing (that), as long as, so long as, on condition that	only if	*You may go **provided that** you return by six.*	limiting condition
in case	as a precaution	*Take a map **in case** you get lost.*	not the same as *if*
supposing / suppose / what if	imagine that	*Suppose it rains, what shall we do?*	present for real, past for unreal
otherwise / or else	if not (result of ignoring a command or fact)	*Start now, **otherwise** you will be late. · I was busy; **otherwise** I would have come.*	**otherwise** goes with the opposite situation
but for + noun / without + noun	if it were not for / had it not been for	***But for** your help, I would have failed. = **Had it not been for** your help, …*	noun, never a clause
even if / only if / if only	emphasis	*I will go **even if** it rains. · Only if you apologise will I forgive you.* (inversion after *only if* at the start)	
as if / as though	unreal comparison	*He looks **as if** he **were** ill.*	past/*were* for an unreal present; past perfect for an unreal past

▸ Changing if … not ↔ unless

With if	With unless
If you do not study, you will fail.	*Unless* you study, you will fail.
If he does not apologise, I shall not forgive him.	*Unless* he apologises, I shall not forgive him.
If I were not ill, I would attend.	(No *unless* with unreal conditions: *Were I not ill, …*)
Do not touch the wire or you will get a shock.	*Unless* you leave the wire alone, you will get a shock.

7.5 Wish, If Only, As If, It Is Time, Would Rather

Structure	Meaning / tense used	Example
wish + simple past (were)	regret about the **present** (unreal)	I wish I **were** taller. · I wish I **knew** the answer. · I wish she **lived** nearer.
wish + past perfect	regret about the **past**	I wish I **had listened** to you. · I wish I **had not said** that.
wish + would + base	a **future** change wanted / annoyance (not for *I / we* about oneself)	I wish it **would stop** raining. · I wish he **would** be quiet.
If only + same tenses	stronger regret	**If only** I **had** more time! · **If only** he **had come** earlier!
as if / as though	unreal or doubtful comparison	He behaves **as if** he **owned** the place. · She spoke **as though** she **had seen** the accident.
It is (high) time + past	something should be done **now**	It is time we **left**. · It is high time you **took** a decision.
would rather + base / subject + past	preference (own action / another person's)	I would rather **stay** here. · I would rather you **stayed** here. · I would rather you **had told** me earlier.
had better + base	advice / warning (no *to*)	You **had better consult** a doctor.
What if / Suppose + past / past perfect	imagine	**What if** he **refused**? · **Suppose** you **had missed** the train?

REMEMBER

The unreal past rule: for something that is not true **now** use the **simple past** (even for present time); for something that was not true **earlier** use the **past perfect**; **were** for all persons with *wish / as if / if* (formal). **Wish for a future event = *would*.**

7.6 Converting Conditional Sentences (Transformation Tasks)

Given	Converted	Technique
If he works hard, he will succeed.	*Unless he works hard, he will not succeed. / Work hard and you will succeed.*	if ↔ unless / imperative + and
Work hard or you will fail.	*If you do not work hard, you will fail. / Unless you work hard, you will fail.*	imperative + or → if … not / unless
If you hurry, you will catch the train.	*Hurry up and you will catch the train.*	imperative + and → if
If he had been careful, he would not have fallen.	*Had he been careful, he would not have fallen. / He fell because he was not careful. / He was not careful; otherwise he would not have fallen.*	inversion / reason / otherwise
If I were rich, I would buy a car.	*Were I rich, I would buy a car. / I am not rich; I cannot buy a car. / I would buy a car if I were rich.*	inversion / negative fact
I did not know. I did not help.	*Had I known, I would have helped. / If I had known, I would have helped.*	two negative facts → third conditional
Without your help, I would have failed.	*If you had not helped me, I would have failed. / But for your help, …*	without ↔ if … not / but for
He is not here, so I cannot ask him.	*If he were here, I could ask him.*	negative facts → second conditional
He studied hard and passed.	*If he had not studied hard, he would not have passed.*	positive facts → negative if-clause

7.7 Conditionals in Reported Speech

- **First conditional** shifts after a past reporting verb: *He said, 'If it rains, I will stay.' → He said that if it **rained**, he **would stay**.*
- **Second and third conditionals** do **not change**: *'If I were rich, I would help.' → He said that if he **were** rich, he **would help**. · 'If I had known, I would have come.' → He said that if he **had known**, he **would have come**.*
- **Zero conditional / general truths** do not change: *The teacher said that if you **heat** ice, it **melts**.*

7.8 Board-level Error Patterns

Wrong	Right	Rule
If I would be you, I would accept.	If I *were* you, I would accept.	no *would* in the if-clause
If it will rain, we will stay home.	If it *rains*, we will stay home.	first conditional
If I knew, I would have told you.	If I *had known*, I would have told you.	third conditional
If he had come, I will meet him.	If he *had come*, I *would have met* him.	tense match
Unless he does not come, I will wait.	*Unless* he *comes*, I will wait.	unless = if not
I wish I was a pilot.	I wish I *were* a pilot.	were for all persons
I wish I had the money yesterday.	I wish I *had had* the money yesterday.	past regret → past perfect
It is time we will go.	It is time we *went*.	time + past
He talks as if he is the boss.	He talks as if he *were* the boss.	unreal comparison
I would rather to stay.	I would rather *stay*.	bare infinitive
Had he not warned, we would be late.	Had he *not* warned *us*, …	negative inversion pattern
Take a coat if it will rain.	Take a coat *in case* it rains.	precaution = in case
Without he helped me, I would fail.	*Had he not helped me*, I would have failed. / *Without his help*, …	without + noun
If I am you, I would refuse.	If I *were* you, I *would* refuse.	unreal condition

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Second conditional: if + past (*were*), would + base; third: if + past perfect, would have + V3; mixed when the times differ.
- Never *would* in the if-clause; never *will* in a first-conditional if-clause (except willingness: *if you will wait*).
- Inversion without *if*: *Were I you*, *Had I known*, *Should it rain*; negative: *Had they **not** ….*
- *Unless* = if … not (no negative verb after it; not for unreal conditions); *in case* = precaution; *otherwise* = if not.
- *Wish / as if / it is time / would rather you* take a **past** form with present meaning; wish about the past takes **past perfect**; wish for change takes **would**.
- Imperative + *and* = if; imperative + *or / otherwise* = if … not / unless.
- In reported speech, second and third conditionals stay unchanged.

CHAPTER 08 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 8

Comparison: Advanced Structures and Degree Transformation

Comparison is tested in editing (than / to / the, double comparatives), gap-filling (the correct degree) and sentence transformation (positive ↔ comparative ↔ superlative). This chapter covers the structures that decide those answers: Latin comparatives with to, absolute adjectives, modifiers of degree, double comparatives, comparison of unlike things and the three-way degree conversion.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 5): the three degrees, regular and irregular comparison, *-er / -est* vs *more / most*, basic use of *than, to, the*, simple degree changes. These are assumed here.

8.1 Structures of Equality, Inequality and Proportion

Pattern	Example	Note
as + adjective/adverb + as	He is *as* tall *as* his father.	equality; **not so/as … as** for negative: *He is **not so/as** tall **as** I (am).*
twice / three times / half as … as	The new road is *twice as wide as* the old one.	multiples go before the first *as*
the same … as / similar to / different from / identical with	This is *the same* pen *as* yours. · His view is *different from* mine. (not ~~different than~~)	same + noun + **as**
more … than / less … than	She is *more* intelligent *than* her sister.	*than* after the comparative; never ~~than~~ after positive
the + comparative … the + comparative	*The more* you read, *the more* you learn. · *The sooner*, *the better*.	two parallel comparatives (proportion)
comparative + and + comparative	It is getting *hotter and hotter*. · *More and more* people are coming.	continuous increase
as much / as many / as soon / as well as	He earns *as much as* she does. · *As soon as possible*	with measures and adverbs
no sooner / not so much … as / rather … than	He is *not so much* a teacher *as* a friend.	relative importance
no more … than / not more than; no less than / not less than	He is *no more* a doctor *than* I am (= not a doctor). · *Not more than* ten came (at most). · *No less than* fifty came (as many as).	*no* = emphasis; *not* = plain limit

8.2 Latin Comparatives: Followed by 'to', Not 'than'

Word	Pattern	Example
senior / junior	senior / junior **to**	He is *senior to* me in service.
superior / inferior	superior / inferior **to**	This cloth is *superior to* that.
prior / anterior / posterior	prior **to**	*Prior to* his arrival, we had left.
prefer / preferable	prefer A **to** B; preferable **to**	I *prefer* tea *to* coffee. · Death is *preferable to* dishonour.

Word	Pattern	Example
would rather / would sooner	would rather A **than** B (bare infinitive)	I *would rather walk than wait*.
different, similar, identical	different **from**; similar **to**; identical **with**	His plan is *different from* mine.

IMPORTANT

Prefer takes **to**, not *than*: ~~I prefer tea than coffee~~. With verbs: *I prefer* ***walking to riding***, but *I would rather* ***walk than ride***. In *prefer … to*, both items must be of the **same form** (two nouns or two gerunds): ~~I prefer to walk than riding~~.

8.3 Common Pairs: Older / Elder, Farther / Further, Later / Latter

Word	Meaning and use	Example
older / oldest	age in general; before or after nouns; takes *than*	He is *older than* I. · the *oldest* tree
elder / eldest	age within **a family**, before a noun; **no *than*** (uses *to*)	my *elder* brother · the *eldest* son
farther / farthest	physical distance	Jaipur is *farther* than Ajmer.
further / furthest	additional (*further* information) or distance	Please wait for *further* instructions.
later / latest	*later* = more recent / afterwards; *latest* = newest	the *latest* news · *later* in the day
latter / last	*latter* = second of two (opposite of *former*); *last* = final of many	Of Ram and Sham, the *former* is tall, the *latter* is short.
nearest / next	*nearest* = shortest distance; *next* = following in order	the *nearest* bank · the *next* bus
less / lesser	*less* = smaller amount; *lesser* = smaller in importance	*lesser* evil, *lesser* known
worse / worst	irregular of *bad / ill*	His condition is *worse*.
most / the most	*most* + noun = almost all; *the most* = highest degree	*Most* students came. · He is *the most* helpful.

8.4 Modifiers of Degree and 'Very / Much'

Modifier	Used with	Example
much / far / a lot / a great deal / even / still / rather / a bit / slightly / any / no	**comparative**	He is **much / far** taller than I. · **Even** better · **A bit** earlier · **No** better
by far / much / quite / easily / nearly / almost	**superlative**	She is **by far** the best student. · He is **easily** the tallest.
very	positive degree / adverbs; **very + superlative** with *own, same, first, last, best, worst*	the **very** best · the **very** first day
too (more than needed) / quite / fairly / rather	positive degree	It is **too** hot. · **Rather** difficult
most / a most + adjective (= extremely)	absolute sense (formal)	a **most** interesting book

> **NOTE**
> *Much* is used with a comparative, *very* with a positive: ~~very better~~ → *much better*; ~~much good~~ → *very good*.

8.5 Other-than-Standard Superlative Structures

- **One of the + superlative + plural noun + singular verb:** *Ravi is **one of the best students** in the class.* (not ~~one of the best student~~)
- **The + superlative of two** is wrong; use the comparative for **two**: *Ram is **the taller of the two**.* · *She is **the elder of the two** sisters.* (not ~~the tallest of the two~~)
- **Superlative + in / of / among:** *in* + place/group noun (*in the class, in India*), *of / among* + plural (*of all, among the girls*).
- **By far / far and away / easily + superlative:** *This is by far the cheapest.*
- **The second / third + superlative:** *Mumbai is **the second largest** city in India.* (ordinal before superlative)
- **Superlative adverbs** take no *the* in modern usage: *She sings **best** of all.* · *He works **hardest**.*
- **Comparison with *than any other* + singular; *all the other* + plural:** *Delhi is bigger than **any other** city in India.* · *Delhi is bigger than **all the other** cities in India.*

8.6 Illogical and Double Comparison (Editing Traps)

Wrong	Right	Reason
He is more cleverer than me.	He is *cleverer than I (am)*.	double comparative
This is the most unkindest cut.	This is the *unkindest* cut.	double superlative
The climate of Jaipur is hotter than Shimla.	The climate of Jaipur is hotter than *that of* Shimla.	compare like with like
The weather of Delhi is colder than Mumbai.	The weather of Delhi is colder than *that of* Mumbai.	use *that of / those of*
Gold is costlier than any metal.	Gold is costlier than *any other* metal.	same class → *other*
Ram is taller than any boy in his class.	Ram is taller than *any other* boy in his class.	he is a boy in the class
She is the tallest of the two.	She is the *taller* of the two.	two → comparative
He is junior than me.	He is junior *to* me.	Latin comparative
I prefer coffee than tea.	I prefer coffee *to* tea.	prefer … to
This is more better than that.	This is *better* than that.	double comparative
He is much honest.	He is *very* honest.	very with positive
It is very better.	It is *much* better.	much with comparative
Mount Everest is the highest than all peaks.	Mount Everest is *higher than all the other peaks*. / *the highest of all*.	mixing degrees
He is the best of the other boys.	He is the best *of all the boys*. / *better than the other boys*.	'other' with superlative
The Sun is the most unique star.	The Sun is a *unique* star.	absolute adjective (unique, perfect, complete, full, empty, round, universal)
He runs faster than I do it.	He runs faster than *I do*.	avoid repeating the verb

IMPORTANT

Absolute adjectives (unique, perfect, complete, final, ideal, total, entire, empty, full, round, square, infinite, universal) are not normally compared. *Almost / nearly / more nearly perfect* is accepted in careful English.

8.7 Pronoun Case After Than / As

After *than* and *as*, a verb is understood. Use the case that would be correct **with that verb**: *She is taller **than I** (am).* · *He likes you more **than I** (do).* (= more than I like you) · *He likes you more **than me**.* (= more than he likes me). Informal English accepts *than me*; board answers prefer *than I (am/do)*.

8.8 Degree Transformation (Three-way Conversion)

Superlative	Comparative	Positive
Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.	Mount Everest is **higher than any other** peak in the world.	**No other** peak in the world is **as high as** Mount Everest. / **Very few** peaks are as high as Mount Everest.
Rajasthan is the largest state in India.	Rajasthan is **larger than any other** state in India.	**No other** state in India is **as large as** Rajasthan.
Honesty is the best policy.	Honesty is **better than any other** policy.	**No other** policy is **as good as** honesty.
Kalidas was one of the greatest poets.	Kalidas was **greater than most other** poets.	**Very few** poets were **as great as** Kalidas.
Gold is more precious than silver.	Silver is **less precious than** gold.	Silver is **not so precious as** gold.
She is taller than her sister.	Her sister is **shorter than** she (is).	Her sister is **not so tall as** she (is).
Sachin is the best batsman.	Sachin is **better than all the other** batsmen.	**No other** batsman is **as good as** Sachin.
This is the most beautiful garden in town.	This garden is **more beautiful than any other** in town.	**No other** garden in town is **so/as beautiful as** this.

REMEMBER

Rules of conversion: (1) superlative → comparative: *than any other* + **singular** noun / *than all the other* + **plural**; (2) superlative → positive: *No other … as/so + positive + as …* or *Very few … as … as …*; (3) comparative → positive (negative sentence): *not so/as … as*; (4) with **'one of the' + superlative**, use *than most other* + plural or *very few*; (5) keep **meaning and number** unchanged.

8.9 Comparison of Adverbs and Special Cases

- **Adverbs** take *more / most* if they end in *-ly*: *more carefully, most quickly*; short adverbs add *-er / -est*: *faster, earlier, hardest, soonest.* (*Early → earlier*, *earliest*.)
- **Irregular adverbs:** well → better → best; badly → worse → worst; much → more → most; little → less → least; far → farther/further.
- **Compound adjectives:** *good-looking → better-looking → best-looking*; *well-known → better known → best known*.
- **Participle adjectives** take *more / most*: *more tired, most pleased, more interesting*.
- **Comparison with 'other' and 'else':** *He is taller than **anyone else** in the class.* (*anyone / anybody / everyone + else*)
- **Fewer / less:** *fewer* mistakes (count), *less* money (mass); *less than* with measures: *less than five kilometres*.
- **Comparative with 'to' phrases:** *older than* (never *older to*), *senior to*.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- *Not so/as … as* for negative equality; *twice / half as … as* for multiples; *the more … the more* for proportion.
- Senior / junior / superior / inferior / prior / prefer / preferable take **to**, not *than*; *would rather … than* takes a bare infinitive.
- Elder / eldest: family only, no *than*; farther = distance; further = additional; later = time; latter = second of two.
- *Much / far / even / a lot* modify a comparative; *very* modifies a positive; *by far / easily* modify a superlative.
- *Than any other* + singular; *than all the other* + plural; *one of the best + plural*; *the + comparative of two*.
- Never use a double comparative or double superlative; absolute adjectives (unique, perfect) are not compared.
- Compare like with like: *the climate of Jaipur is hotter than **that of** Shimla*.
- Degree conversion: superlative ↔ *than any other* ↔ *no other … as … as* / *very few … as … as*.

CHAPTER 09 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 9

Avoiding Repetition: Substitution and Ellipsis

Good English does not repeat itself. We replace words with pronouns, one/ones, do/does/did, so/not, or simply leave them out when the meaning is already clear. This chapter shows the exact devices used in conversation, in writing and in board-exam items such as dialogue completion, editing and sentence reordering.

Pronouns as Substitutes

- **Personal pronouns** replace nouns: *Anil lost his bag, and he found it later.*
- **Reflexive** pronouns avoid repeating the subject as object: *She hurt herself.*
- **Demonstratives** refer back: *Physics is difficult. That is why few choose it.*
- **Possessive pronouns** replace noun + possessive: *This pen is mine, not yours.* (= my pen, your pen)
- **That of / those of** replace a repeated noun in comparisons: *The climate of Shimla is cooler than that of Delhi.*
- **The former / the latter**: *Ram and Shyam are friends; the former is a doctor and the latter an engineer.* (former = first of two, latter = second of two; use first / last for three or more)

One / Ones

- **one** replaces a singular countable noun: *I lost my red pen; I will buy a new **one**.*
- **ones** replaces a plural countable noun: *These shoes are old; I prefer the new **ones**.*
- One / ones cannot replace uncountable nouns: *Do you want tea or coffee? I like the hot **tea**.* (not 'hot one')
- After 'this / that / these / those' one(s) is usually dropped: *Which pen do you want? This one, not that.*
- One / ones are not used after possessives or numbers alone: *my one* is wrong; say *mine*.
- After an adjective alone (the red one) or after 'which / each / either' one is natural.

Do / Does / Did as Substitutes

The auxiliary **do** stands for a whole verb phrase already mentioned.

Full sentence	Shorter sentence
She sings better than her sister sings.	She sings better than her sister **does**.
I like cricket and my brother likes cricket too.	I like cricket and so **does** my brother.
He worked hard, and I worked hard too.	He worked hard and so **did** I.
Do you play chess? Yes, I play chess.	Do you play chess? Yes, I **do**.

IMPORTANT

Use do/does/did only when the original sentence has **no auxiliary**. If there is an auxiliary or modal, repeat it: *She has finished, and so **have** I. He can swim and so **can** I. She is tired and so **am** I.*

So, Neither, Nor, Either, Too

▸ Agreeing with an affirmative: so + auxiliary + subject / subject + auxiliary + too

Statement	Agreement
I am hungry.	So am I. / I am too.
She plays tennis.	So does her brother. / Her brother does too.

Statement	Agreement
They have won.	So have we. / We have too.
He will come.	So will she. / She will too.

▸ Agreeing with a negative: neither / nor + auxiliary + subject / subject + auxiliary + not + either

Statement	Agreement
I don't like fish.	Neither do I. / Nor do I. / I don't either.
She has not come.	Neither has he. / He hasn't either.
They can't swim.	Neither can we. / We can't either.

> **IMPORTANT**
> After **so / neither / nor** the auxiliary comes BEFORE the subject (inversion). With **too / either** the usual order is kept. 'Too' goes with positive, 'either' with negative. WRONG: *She doesn't like tea and I don't too.* RIGHT: *She doesn't like tea and I don't either* (or *neither do I*).

So and Not Replacing Clauses

- After verbs of thinking and saying: *Will it rain? I think **so**. I hope **not**. I am afraid **so** / **not**. I suppose so. I believe so. It appears **so**.*
- With say, tell: *Is he coming? He said **so**.* (not 'he said it')
- Negatives: *I don't think so = I think not* (more formal). With hope and be afraid use *hope not*, *afraid not*.
- **If so / if not**: *Are you free? If so, come with me. If not, I will go alone.*
- **Do so**: *He asked me to leave, and I did so.* (formal substitute for 'did that')
- **Not** replaces a negative clause: *Perhaps not. Certainly not. Of course not.*

Ellipsis: Leaving Words Out

▸ In coordination

- Repeated subject: *She opened the door and (she) walked in.*
- Repeated auxiliary: *He has finished the work and (has) gone home.* (same auxiliary may be dropped only if it has the same form)
- Repeated verb: *Ram plays cricket and Shyam (plays) football.* (gapping)
- Repeated preposition: *He spoke to the principal and (to) the teachers.* (dropping is common, but keep it if clarity is needed)
- Repeated article: *a pen and (a) pencil* - repeat the article when the nouns are different people: *the poet and the painter* = two persons; *the poet and painter* = one person.

▸ With infinitives: reduced 'to'

Do you want to go? Yes, I want to. (The full infinitive is replaced by 'to' alone.) *I didn't go because I didn't want to.* Never drop the 'to' in this case.

Reducing Relative and Adverbial Clauses

Full clause	Reduced form	Device
The boy who is standing there is my cousin.	The boy standing there is my cousin.	present participle replaces who + be
The book that was written by Tagore is famous.	The book written by Tagore is famous.	past participle

Full clause	Reduced form	Device
The man who lives next door is a doctor.	The man living next door is a doctor.	-ing form
Rahul, who is my friend, is a pilot.	Rahul, my friend, is a pilot.	apposition
When he reached home, he had dinner.	Reaching home, he had dinner.	participle phrase
Because she was tired, she slept.	Being tired, she slept.	being + adjective
After he had finished the work, he left.	Having finished the work, he left.	perfect participle
If it is necessary, call me.	If necessary, call me.	ellipsis of subject + be
Though he was poor, he was honest.	Though poor, he was honest.	ellipsis of subject + be

Tag Questions and Short Responses

A tag question is itself an example of avoiding repetition. It repeats the auxiliary of the main sentence with a pronoun.

Main sentence	Tag	Rule
She is a doctor,	isn't she?	positive sentence, negative tag
They didn't come,	did they?	negative sentence, positive tag
You like tea,	don't you?	no auxiliary, use do / does / did
I am late,	aren't I?	'am' becomes 'aren't'
Let's go,	shall we?	let's takes shall we
Open the door,	will you?	imperative takes will you / won't you
Nobody called,	did they?	negative words (nobody, never, hardly) take positive tag
There is a problem,	isn't there?	'there' is the subject of the tag

Other Devices

- **The same**: *He ordered tea; I'll have the same.*
- **Such**: *He is a poet and I hope to be one too. He is a scholar; such men are rare.*
- **Respectively**: *Ram and Shyam are 15 and 17 years old, respectively.* avoids two full sentences.
- **Each other / one another**: *Ram helped Shyam and Shyam helped Ram = They helped each other.* (each other for two, one another for more)
- **Both / all / either / neither**: *Neither of them came* (replaces 'Ram did not come and Shyam did not come').
- **Whose, which**: *The man, whose car was stolen, called the police.*
- **Which** referring to a whole clause: *He passed the test, which surprised everyone.*
- **Both ... and, not only ... but also**: compress two sentences into one.

Common Errors

Wrong	Right	Reason
I like it and he likes it too.	I like it and so does he.	avoid repeating verb and object
She can sing and so does her sister.	She can sing and so can her sister.	repeat the modal, not 'does'
I don't have a pen. Do you have it?	I don't have a pen. Do you have one?	'one' for any non-specific item

Wrong	Right	Reason
The girl who is sitting there is my sister.	The girl sitting there is my sister.	reduce the relative clause
Ram and Shyam are brothers; the first is older than the second.	Ram and Shyam are brothers; the former is older than the latter.	for two use former / latter
He told that he will come and I told that I will not come.	He said he would come, but I said I would not.	ellipsis

How This Is Tested

- **Editing / omission**: the missing or incorrect word is often an auxiliary after so / neither or a pronoun that should replace a repeated noun.
- **Dialogue completion**: choose the elliptical reply (e.g., 'So have I', 'I don't think so').
- **Sentence transformation**: combine sentences using relative reduction, 'both ... and', 'neither ... nor'.
- **Gap filling**: choose between one / ones, so / neither, do / does.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Substitute with pronouns, one / ones, do / does / did, so / not, and that of / those of.
- Use do / does / did only if the first sentence has no auxiliary; otherwise repeat the auxiliary or modal.
- So + aux + subject = agree with positive; neither / nor + aux + subject = agree with negative.
- I think so / I hope not / I am afraid so: so and not replace a whole clause.
- Former / latter are for two; first / last for three or more.
- Participle phrases reduce clauses, but the doer must be the same as the main subject.
- Tag questions repeat the auxiliary with opposite polarity.

CHAPTER 10 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 10

Nominalisation: Turning Verbs and Adjectives into Nouns

Nominalisation means expressing an action or quality as a noun instead of a verb or adjective: 'The government decided' becomes 'The government's decision'. It makes writing compact, formal and impersonal, and it is the key skill behind transformation items such as 'Rewrite the sentence using the noun form of the word in brackets'.

What is Nominalisation?

DEFINITION

Nominalisation is the process of forming a noun (or noun phrase) from a verb, an adjective or a whole clause. The resulting noun is called a **nominal**.

Verb / adjective / clause	Nominalised form
The committee decided to close the school.	The committee's **decision** to close the school ...
The city expanded rapidly.	The rapid **expansion** of the city ...
Meena is honest.	Meena's **honesty** is well known.
The river flooded the village.	The **flooding** of the village ...
Because the rain was heavy, the match stopped.	The **heaviness** of the rain / **heavy rain** caused the **stoppage** of the match.

Forming Nouns from Verbs

▸ Common noun-forming suffixes

Suffix	Verb	Noun	More examples
-tion / -ation / -ion	act, inform, decide	action, information, decision	creation, education, protection, invitation, explanation, collection, discussion, permission
-ment	develop, achieve, move	development, achievement, movement	agreement, amusement, argument, arrangement, announcement, management, payment
-al	refuse, approve, arrive	refusal, approval, arrival	survival, proposal, removal, denial, revival, burial
-ance / -ence	appear, perform, differ	appearance, performance, difference	attendance, assistance, guidance, resistance, existence, obedience, conference
-ing (gerund)	swim, read, build	swimming, reading, building	meeting, painting, teaching, saving
-er / -or / -ant	teach, act, assist	teacher, actor, assistant	writer, visitor, inhabitant, servant (these name the doer)
-ure / -age	fail, press, marry	failure, pressure, marriage	closure, departure, damage, breakage, passage, storage
-y / -ery	discover, deliver, recover	discovery, delivery, recovery	inquiry, victory, robbery, bravery
-sion / -ssion	decide, permit, revise	decision, permission, revision	division, confusion, admission, impression, expression, possession

Suffix	Verb	Noun	More examples
no change (conversion)	walk, answer, help, look	a walk, an answer, help, a look	hope, love, cry, smile, plan, test, request, visit, rest, dream

▸ Verbs with irregular noun forms

Verb	Noun	Verb	Noun
choose	choice	prove	proof
sell	sale	speak	speech
live	life	think	thought
give	gift	see	sight
die	death	grieve	grief
lose	loss	believe	belief
succeed	success	complain	complaint
laugh	laughter	know	knowledge
fly	flight	bleed	blood
advise	advice	practise	practice

IMPORTANT

Advise / advice and **practise / practice** are verb / noun pairs in British English; in the noun the 's' becomes 'c'. Similarly *license (n) – license (v)* is a point of spelling checked in editing items.

Forming Nouns from Adjectives

Suffix	Adjective	Noun	More examples
-ness	kind, happy, dark	kindness, happiness, darkness	weakness, sadness, goodness, illness, willingness, awareness
-ity / -ty	able, active, rare	ability, activity, rarity	reality, purity, security, cruelty, safety, honesty, humanity, generosity
-ence / -ance	patient, absent, important	patience, absence, importance	silence, violence, intelligence, innocence, elegance, brilliance
-th	long, strong, wide	length, strength, width	depth, breadth, height, warmth, truth
-dom / -hood / -ship	free, child, friendly	freedom, childhood, friendship	wisdom, boredom, brotherhood, neighbourhood, leadership
-ism	real, social, hero	realism, socialism, heroism	patriotism, optimism
-y	difficult, honest, jealous	difficulty, honesty, jealousy	modesty, curiosity (-ity), victory
-cy	accurate, fluent, urgent	accuracy, fluency, urgency	privacy, bankruptcy

IMPORTANT

Spelling shifts to watch: *happy – happiness* (y to i), *wise – wisdom*, *strong – strength*, *deep – depth*, *high – height*, *proud – pride*, *hot – heat*, *young – youth*, *brave – bravery*, *free – freedom*, *please – pleasure*, *vain – vanity*.

Converting Clauses and Sentences into Noun Phrases

The syllabus mentions nominalisation as a technique in 'sentence transformation'. Follow this approach: (1) find the verb or adjective carrying the main idea, (2) change it to a noun, (3) turn the subject into a possessive or an 'of' phrase, (4) adjust the remaining verb.

Original	Nominalised
Scientists discovered a new planet. This surprised everyone.	The discovery of a new planet by scientists surprised everyone.
The government has introduced the scheme quickly.	The quick introduction of the scheme by the government ...
She refused the offer, and nobody expected it.	Her refusal of the offer was unexpected.
People are polluting the rivers, and this is dangerous.	The pollution of rivers by people is dangerous.
The train arrived late. The passengers were angry.	The late arrival of the train angered the passengers.
He was absent, so the teacher scolded him.	His absence led to the teacher's scolding.
It is important that we conserve water.	The conservation of water is important.
If prices rise, people will suffer.	A rise in prices will cause suffering to people.
As soon as he arrived, the meeting began.	On his arrival, the meeting began.
Because she worked hard, she succeeded.	Her success was the result of hard work. / She owed her success to hard work.

▸ Typical sentence frames after nominalisation

- ... is due to / is the result of / results from / is caused by + noun phrase
- ... led to / resulted in / gave rise to / brought about + noun phrase
- The + noun + of + noun (The destruction of forests)
- The + adjective + noun + of + noun (The rapid growth of cities)
- On / Upon + noun (On his arrival)
- In spite of / Because of / Owing to + noun (In spite of his illness)

▸ Turning nominals back into clauses (reverse transformation)

Nominal	Clause
His refusal surprised us.	We were surprised that he refused.
The destruction of the forest worried the villagers.	The villagers were worried because the forest was destroyed.
Her success is due to her hard work.	She succeeded because she worked hard.
Due to the heavy rainfall, the match was cancelled.	The match was cancelled because it rained heavily.

Formal Register and Nominalisation

Informal (verb)	Formal (noun)
We discussed the problem.	A discussion of the problem took place.
Please reply soon.	An early reply will be appreciated.
They are building a bridge.	The construction of a bridge is under way.
The school may reopen.	The reopening of the school is possible.
We want to cut costs.	Our aim is a reduction in costs.

Common Errors

Wrong	Right	Reason
His arrive was late.	His arrival was late.	noun needed
Please give me an advise.	Please give me advice.	advice (n), advise (v); advice is uncountable
She won the prize by hard-working.	She won the prize by hard work.	work as noun, or 'by working hard'
There was a big decide.	There was a big decision.	noun form
Their friend was long.	Their friendship was long-lasting.	friend / friendship
The grow of the city is fast.	The growth of the city is fast.	growth
The heighth of the tower	The height of the tower	spelling
He insisted to go.	He insisted on going.	preposition + gerund

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Nominalisation turns verbs, adjectives or clauses into nouns to give a compact, formal style.
- Learn the suffix families: -tion, -ment, -al, -ance / -ence, -ness, -ity, -th, -dom / -hood / -ship.
- Watch irregular pairs: choose-choice, die-death, believe-belief, prove-proof, fly-flight, advise-advice.
- When transforming, subject becomes a possessive or 'of' phrase; link with led to / resulted in / due to.
- After a preposition, use a gerund or noun, not a base verb.
- Headlines are heavily nominalised; expanding them means restoring verbs and tenses.

CHAPTER 11 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 11

Modals: Can, Could, May, Might, Will, Would, Shall, Should, Must and More

Modals are helping verbs that add a shade of meaning to the main verb: ability, permission, possibility, advice, duty, certainty. They are among the most tested items in gap filling and editing, and the past forms (should have, could have, needn't have) are a favourite of board papers.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 10): modal basics, the five modal rules, and the everyday uses of can, could, may, might, will, shall, should, ought to, must and have to. This chapter covers only the advanced uses tested at board level.

▸ May have / might have (possibility in the past)

He may have missed the train. (perhaps he did) *She might have forgotten. They might have won if they had played better.* (might have + past participle = unreal past possibility).

Must, Have to, Need

▸ Certainty (deduction)

Time	Certainty (positive)	Certainty (negative)	Possibility
Present	He must be at home. (I am sure)	He cannot / can't be at home.	He may / might / could be at home.
Past	He must have gone home.	He cannot / can't have gone home.	He may / might / could have gone home.

Note that the opposite of 'must' in deduction is **can't / cannot**, not 'mustn't'. *The lights are on, so he must be in. He can't be asleep.*

▸ Need

- **Need as a modal** is used in negatives and questions: *You needn't go. Need I go?* (no -s, no to)
- **Need as an ordinary verb** takes to and -s: *He needs to rest. Do you need to go? I don't need to know.*
- **Needn't have + past participle** = did something that was not necessary: *You needn't have bought it. I already have one.* **Didn't need to** = it wasn't necessary and we don't say if done: *I didn't need to hurry.*
- **Need** is also followed by a gerund / passive infinitive for things: *The car needs repairing / to be repaired.*

Used to; Would; Be used to; Get used to

Form	Meaning	Example
used to + base verb	past habit or past state that no longer exists	She used to live in Jaipur. We used to play cricket daily.
didn't use to / never used to	negative (questions: Did you use to ... ?)	I didn't use to like tea.
be used to + noun / -ing	be accustomed to	I am used to getting up early.
get used to + noun / -ing	become accustomed to	He is getting used to the cold.

In a question or negative with 'did', the spelling is **use to** (without d): *Did you use to smoke?* A frequent editing error.

Dare and Had Better

- **Dare** as a modal in negatives/questions: *He dare not speak. How dare you!* As an ordinary verb: *He did not dare to speak. I dare you to jump.*
- **Had better + base verb**: strong advice with a warning: *You had better hurry or you will miss the bus.* Negative: *had better not go.* It refers to the present or future, though it has 'had'.
- **Be able to**: replaces can in other tenses and when no modal is possible: *She will be able to join us. He has been able to swim for years.*
- **Be going to**: plan or prediction: *I am going to buy a bicycle. It is going to rain.*
- **Be to**: arrangement or order: *The Prime Minister is to visit Japan next week. You are to stay here.*

Modals in the Past (Perfect Modals)

Form	Meaning	Example
could have + V3	was able to but did not	I could have won, but I was careless.
couldn't have + V3	it was impossible that	She couldn't have seen him; she was abroad.
may / might have + V3	perhaps, uncertain past	He may have lost his way.
might have + V3	unreal past (did not happen) / criticism	You might have told me!
must have + V3	sure that something happened	It must have rained last night; the road is wet.
can't have + V3	sure it did not happen	He can't have stolen it.
should have + V3	right thing not done (regret / criticism)	You should have started earlier.
shouldn't have + V3	wrong thing done	You shouldn't have shouted at her.
needn't have + V3	did something unnecessary	You needn't have waited.
would have + V3	result in the third conditional	If I had known, I would have helped.

Modals in the Passive Voice

Pattern: **modal + be + V3**. *The work must be finished today. The gate can be opened from inside. Rules should be obeyed. The letter ought to have been posted yesterday.* (More in Chapter 12.)

Modals in Reported Speech

Direct	Reported (reporting verb in past)
will	would
shall	would (or should, in advice / offers)
can	could
may	might
must	had to (obligation) / must (deduction or if still valid)
could, would, should, might, ought to	no change
need	needed to / need (no change)
used to	no change

- *He said, "I can help you."* = He said that he could help me.
- *She said, "You must leave."* = She said that I had to leave.
- *He said, "Shall I help you?"* = He asked if he should help me.

- *She said, "I may come."* = She said that she might come.
- *The teacher said, "You should work harder."* = The teacher said that I should work harder. (no change)

Common Errors with Modals

Wrong	Right	Reason
He can swims.	He can swim.	base verb after modal
She will can come.	She will be able to come.	double modal
You ought go.	You ought to go.	ought takes to
I must to go.	I must go.	no to after must
He did not dared to go.	He did not dare to go.	dare as main verb
Does he needs to go?	Does he need to go? / Need he go?	no -s after does
You mustn't come if you don't want.	You needn't come if you don't want.	mustn't = forbidden
Did you used to play?	Did you use to play?	use to after did
May he not walk after the accident.	He cannot walk after the accident.	inability
She said she shall come.	She said she would come.	backshift in reported speech
He should have went.	He should have gone.	V3 after modal + have
I can able to swim.	I can swim / I am able to swim.	can and able to together

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Modals take the base verb, have no -s, and form questions and negatives without do.
- Can/could = ability; may/might = possibility and formal permission; should/ought to = advice and duty; must = strong obligation and certainty.
- Mustn't = prohibition; needn't / don't have to = no necessity; can't = impossibility in deduction.
- Perfect modals (should have, could have, needn't have, must have) take V3 and refer to the past.
- Shall with I/we, will with others for plain future; reversed for determination, promise or threat.
- Used to = past habit; be used to + -ing = accustomed; after did write 'use to'.
- Passive with modals: modal + be + V3. Reported speech: will-would, can-could, may-might, must-had to.

CHAPTER 12 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 12

Active and Passive Voice

Voice shows whether the subject does the action (active) or receives it (passive). The passive is used when the action, not the doer, is important, which is why it dominates scientific writing, news reports and procedure writing. Board papers test it through sentence transformation, gap filling and process descriptions.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 16): the idea of voice, the three-step conversion, the case table and the passive in every tense (passive = be in the tense of the active verb + V3). Here we deal with the harder structures.

▸ Imperative sentences

Type	Active	Passive
Command	Close the door.	Let the door be closed. / You are ordered to close the door.
Request	Please help me.	You are requested to help me.
Advice	Work hard.	You are advised to work hard.
Prohibition	Do not touch the wire.	Let the wire not be touched. / You are forbidden to touch the wire.
Suggestion	Let us play.	Let the game be played.
Order with 'let'	Let him sing.	Let him be allowed to sing. / He should be allowed to sing.

Common formula: **Let + object + be + V3**. If the verb is in the negative: **Let + object + not + be + V3**.

▸ Exclamatory and optative sentences

What a beautiful painting she has made! - What a beautiful painting has been made by her! May God bless you! - Let it be hoped that God will bless you. These are rarely asked.

Two Objects: Direct and Indirect

Verbs such as give, send, tell, show, teach, offer, lend, buy, bring, pay take two objects: **indirect object (to whom)** and **direct object (what)**. *I teach you English.* (What do I teach? English - direct. Whom do I teach? You - indirect.) Either object can become the subject.

Active	Passive 1 (indirect as subject)	Passive 2 (direct as subject)
She gave me a book.	I was given a book by her.	A book was given to me by her.
The teacher taught us grammar.	We were taught grammar by the teacher.	Grammar was taught to us by the teacher.
He sent her a gift.	She was sent a gift by him.	A gift was sent to her by him.
They offered him a job.	He was offered a job.	A job was offered to him.

IMPORTANT

When the **direct object** is the new subject, the indirect object keeps 'to' (or 'for' with buy, make, get, bring): *A gift was bought for her.* Passive 1 (person as subject) is more natural in English.

Active	Passive
The doctor looked after the patient.	The patient was looked after by the doctor.
They laughed at him.	He was laughed at.

Active	Passive
The police are looking into the matter.	The matter is being looked into by the police.
The manager turned down our request.	Our request was turned down by the manager.
The teacher called off the match.	The match was called off.
People look up to a hero.	A hero is looked up to.
We must put up with this.	This must be put up with.
The crowd cheered the winner.	The winner was cheered by the crowd.

Special Cases and Exceptions

▸ A. Verbs not used in the passive

Intransitive verbs (go, come, arrive, sleep, die, fall) have no passive. Some **transitive** verbs of state also refuse it: *have (possess), resemble, suit, fit, lack, become, cost, weigh, like (state)*. *She has a car - A car is had by her* (wrong). *She resembles her mother* - no passive.

▸ B. Verbs of knowing, thinking and saying: impersonal passive

Active	Passive 1 (it-structure)	Passive 2 (personal)
People say that honesty is the best policy.	It is said that honesty is the best policy.	Honesty is said to be the best policy.
They believe that he is innocent.	It is believed that he is innocent.	He is believed to be innocent.
Experts think that prices will rise.	It is thought that prices will rise.	Prices are thought to rise.
People know that he is a thief.	It is known that he is a thief.	He is known to be a thief.

Verbs: say, think, believe, know, report, expect, consider, find, claim, suppose, understand. *To have + V3* is used for an earlier action: *He is said to have won the prize.*

▸ C. 'Let' in the passive

They let him go. - He was allowed to go. (not 'was let go' in formal English). *Let him do it. - Let it be done by him.*

▸ D. Causative 'have/get'

I had my car repaired means someone repaired it for me. Pattern: have / get + object + V3. *She got her hair cut. He is having his house painted.* The agent is rarely mentioned.

▸ E. Verbs followed by an infinitive or gerund

They want to complete the work. - The work is wanted to be completed by them. (awkward; better: *It is wanted that the work be completed.*) *She likes teaching children. - She likes children to be taught. He remembers being praised.* - gerund passive: **being + V3**.

▸ F. Passive with 'by' left out

Omit the agent when it is unknown (someone, people, they, one), general (everyone, anybody) or obvious (police arrested him).

▸ G. Passive with agents other than 'by'

- with: *The glass was filled with water.* (instrument or material)
- to: *He is known to me.*
- at: *I was surprised at the news.*
- in: *He is interested in music.*
- of: *The room is full of people.*
- with: *I was pleased with the gift.*

This is called the **'by' exception**: surprise, pleasure, interest, concern verbs take at / with / in / to instead of by. E.g., *The news surprised me. - I was surprised at the news. The sight pleased her. - She was pleased with the sight. Music interests him. - He is interested in music. The result disappointed us. - We were disappointed with the result. His name is known to everyone.*

Passive in Process and Procedure Writing

Instructions, recipes and experiments are written in the **passive** (usually present simple) with sequence words: first, then, next, after that, finally. See also the worked tasks in Chapter 16.

Instruction (imperative)	Process (passive)
Boil the water.	The water is boiled.
Add sugar and stir.	Sugar is added and stirred.
Take out the cloth and rinse it.	The cloth is taken out and rinsed.
Do not heat the solution too much.	The solution is not heated too much.

Worked example: *Collect the clothes. Soak them in hot water. Beat them. Rinse and dry.* **The clothes are collected. They are soaked in hot water. Then they are beaten. They are rinsed and dried.** The hint for tense is given in the question ('Hint - are / is').

Passive Voice in Reported Speech and Conditionals

- Reported: *He said that the work had been completed.* (past perfect passive)
- Conditional: *If the bridge had been repaired, the accident would not have happened.*
- Purpose: *The roads are widened so that traffic can be handled smoothly.*

Common Errors

Wrong	Right	Reason
The letter is wrote by him.	The letter is written by him.	use V3
The work was been done.	The work was done / has been done.	do not mix was and been
He was knew by all.	He was known to all.	V3 'known'
I was surprised by the news.	I was surprised at the news.	'at' with surprise
The patient is being looked.	The patient is being looked after.	keep the preposition
It is happened.	It happened.	intransitive, no passive
The food is being ate by us.	The food is being eaten by us.	V3 'eaten'
Let the work done.	Let the work be done.	missing 'be'

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Only transitive verbs have a passive; passive = be (in the tense) + V3.
- Object becomes subject; the subject becomes agent with 'by' in objective case (me, us, him, her, them).
- Continuous tenses use being; perfect tenses use been; modals use be; perfect continuous and future continuous have no passive.
- Questions invert; who becomes by whom; imperatives use let ... be ... V3 or 'you are requested / advised / ordered to'.
- Two objects: either can be the subject; prepositional and phrasal verbs keep their particle.
- Say/believe/think verbs have impersonal passive: It is said that ... / He is said to be ...
- Surprise-type verbs take at/with/in/to instead of by; process writing uses the present passive.

CHAPTER 13 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 13

Reported Speech (Direct and Indirect Narration)

Reported speech lets us tell what someone said without using their exact words. It tests four skills at once: choosing the reporting verb and the linking word, backshifting the tense, changing pronouns, and changing words of time and place. In the board exam it appears as a conversation or comic strip you must convert into a paragraph.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 17): the five conversion steps, the reporting verb and link word table, tense backshift, pronoun and time/place changes, and the basic rules for reporting statements, questions and commands. Use those tables here; this chapter deals with the advanced cases.

▸ When the tense does NOT change even if the reporting verb is in the past

- **Universal truths and scientific facts:** *The teacher said, "The earth moves round the sun." - The teacher said that the earth moves round the sun.*
- **Habits that still continue** and statements that are still true: *He said, "I live in Jaipur." - He said that he lives in Jaipur* (if he still does).
- **Historical facts:** *He said that Akbar was born in 1542.*
- **Past perfect** and the modals would, could, should, might, ought to, used to.
- **Conditional (second / third)** and wishes: *If I were rich ... remains.*
- **Reported soon after speaking** (the same day, same situation): present tense may be kept.

Reporting Exclamations and Wishes

- *She said, "Hurrah! We have won."* - She exclaimed with joy that they had won.
- *He said, "Alas! I am ruined."* - He exclaimed with sorrow that he was ruined.
- *She said, "What a lovely day!"* - She exclaimed that it was a very lovely day.
- *The teacher said, "Bravo! You have done well."* - The teacher applauded him saying that he had done well.
- *He said, "May you live long!"* - He prayed that I might live long.
- *"Good morning," he said.* - He wished me good morning. *"Happy birthday!"* - He wished her a happy birthday.

Words like Oh!, Alas!, Hurrah!, Wow! are dropped and expressed by the reporting verb (exclaimed with joy / sorrow / surprise / grief / wonder).

Mixed Sentences

When one direct speech contains two or more kinds of sentences, convert each separately with its own link word and keep the reporting verb for each: *He said, "I am tired. Will you make some tea?"* - He said that he was tired and asked me if I would make some tea.

- Two statements: join with **and** / **that**.
- Statement + question: *said that ... and asked ...*
- Question + command: *asked ... and told / requested ...*
- Commas, full stops inside the quote mark the breaks.

Longer extract: *The teacher said, "Good morning, children. Open your books. Who will read the first paragraph?"* - The teacher wished the children good morning, told them to open their books and asked who would read the first paragraph.

Special Cases

▸ A. Sentences with 'let'

Let us go - suggestion: *He suggested that we should go. Let him go* - permission / order: *He ordered that he should be allowed to go. Let there be light - He said that there should be light.*

▸ B. Sentences with 'should, ought to, must'

No change in should, ought to, would, could, might. 'Must' is unchanged or becomes 'had to' for obligation; remains 'must' for certainty or prohibition: *He said, "You must not smoke." - He said that I must not smoke / He told me not to smoke.*

▸ C. Conditionals

She said, "If I were rich, I would buy a car." - She said that if she were rich, she would buy a car. (no change). *He said, "If it rains, I will stay."* - He said that if it rained, he would stay.

▸ D. Questions with 'shall I / shall we'

Offer: *He said, "Shall I help you?"* - He offered to help me. Suggestion: *"Shall we go?"* - He suggested going / asked if we should go.

▸ E. 'Yes' and 'No' answers

"Do you like it?" - "Yes." - He said that he did. *She said, "No, I can't."* - She replied in the negative / said that she couldn't.

▸ F. Greetings and thanks

"Thank you," he said to me. - He thanked me. *"Congratulations!"* - He congratulated me. *"Sorry!"* - He apologised.

Reporting Verbs and Their Patterns

Pattern	Verbs	Example
verb + that-clause	say, tell, state, explain, announce, claim, argue, complain, admit, deny, promise, add, remark	He admitted that he had made a mistake.
verb + object + to-infinitive	order, tell, advise, ask, request, warn, invite, remind, urge, encourage, permit, instruct	She advised him to rest.
verb + to-infinitive	offer, refuse, promise, agree, threaten, demand	He refused to help.
verb + gerund / preposition	suggest, deny, admit, insist on, apologise for, accuse of, thank for, congratulate on	She apologised for being late.
verb + object + preposition + gerund	accuse, blame, thank, congratulate, warn against, prevent from	He accused me of lying.
verb + wh-/if clause	ask, wonder, enquire, want to know	He wondered whether she would come.

Better reporting verbs make better answers: instead of 'said that he was sorry' write *apologised*; instead of 'said that he would help' write *promised to help*.

Dialogue to Paragraph and Comic-Strip Tasks

Board papers give a short conversation (sometimes a comic strip) and a paragraph with blanks, e.g. 'Rama told Sita (a) ____ ...'. Fill the blanks with indirect speech. Method:

Step 1 — Identify the speaker and listener
for each line; the speaker of the line before the blank is the subject of the reporting verb.

Step 2 — Decide the sentence type
statement, question, command or exclamation, and the reporting verb already given in the paragraph (told, asked, suggested, exclaimed).

Step 3 — Backshift
tense, pronouns, time and place words; check that the blank follows the linking word in the paragraph.

Step 4 — Read the whole paragraph aloud
for flow and for the correct word order.

▸ Worked example (from the syllabus pattern)

Rama: I am going to the jungle. / Sita: Why? / Rama: I have been banished for fourteen years by my father. / Sita: Oh! It is very sad. Can I go with you? / Rama: No. Stay at home to take care of my old parents.

Rama told Sita (a) **that he was going to the jungle**. She asked him (b) **why he was going to the jungle** (c) Rama said **that he had been banished for fourteen years by his father**. Sita exclaimed that it was very sad and asked Rama (d) **if she could go with him**. Rama told her not to go and asked her to stay at home to take care of his old parents.

▸ Notes-to-report tasks

Sometimes notes of a speech are given. Use passive-like reporting verbs: *The speaker said that ..., added that ..., pointed out that ..., concluded by saying that ...*

Common Errors

Wrong	Right	Reason
He said me that he was ill.	He told me that he was ill.	said needs no object; told does
She asked where was I going.	She asked where I was going.	statement order
He asked if did I like it.	He asked if I liked it.	no do/did
He said that he will come tomorrow.	He said that he would come the next day.	tense and time word
He told to me to go.	He told me to go.	no 'to' before the object
She asked that what was my name.	She asked what my name was.	no 'that' with wh-word
He said that the earth moved round the sun.	He said that the earth moves round the sun.	universal truth
He suggested me to go.	He suggested that I should go.	suggest takes that-clause / gerund
She asked me where do I live?	She asked me where I lived.	no question mark, no inversion

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Link words: that (statement), if / whether (yes/no), same wh-word (wh-question), to / not to (commands).
- Reporting verb present/future: no tense change. Past: backshift present-past, past-past perfect, will-would, can-could, may-might.
- No change for universal truths, past perfect, would/could/should/might/ought to.
- I-person follows the subject, II-person follows the object, III-person unchanged.
- Now-then, today-that day, tomorrow-the next day, yesterday-the day before, here-there, this-that.
- Questions become statements: statement order, no question mark, no do/did.
- Choose precise reporting verbs: order, request, advise, warn, forbid, suggest, exclaim, promise, apologise.

CHAPTER 14 · GRAMMAR · SYLLABUS TOPIC 14

Prepositions: Time, Place, Direction and Dependent Prepositions

A preposition links a noun or pronoun to the rest of the sentence and shows relations of time, place, direction, cause or means. Most mistakes happen with dependent prepositions (verbs, adjectives and nouns that need a particular preposition), so this chapter gives full lists to memorise, along with confusing pairs and tips for omission and editing items.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 12): what a preposition does and the prepositions of time, place, direction, cause and means (at/on/in, between/among, beside/besides, made of/from, by/with). Below are the less common dependent prepositions and board-exam traps that Part 1 does not list.

Verb + preposition	Example
abstain from	abstain from voting
accuse of	accused him of theft
agree with (person) / to (proposal) / on (matter)	agree with you, agree to the plan
apologise to (person) for	apologise to her for the delay
appeal to / for	appeal to the court for justice
apply to (person) for (thing)	apply to the principal for leave
approve of	approve of his conduct
argue with (person) about	argue with him about money
arrive at (place) / in (city, country)	arrive at the station; in Delhi
attend to	attend to the guests
avail of	avail of the offer
beg for / of	beg for mercy
believe in (trust) / believe (a person)	believe in God
belong to	belongs to me
blame for / blame on	blame him for the failure
boast of / about	boast of his wealth
call at (place) / on (person) / for (collect)	call on a friend
charge with	charged with murder
cheat of / out of	cheated of his money
compare with (similar) / to (unlike)	compare this with that
complain to (person) of / about	complain to the teacher about noise
comply with	comply with the rules
consist of	consists of ten members
consult with / consult (no prep)	consult a doctor

Verb + preposition	Example
congratulate on	congratulate him on his success
contribute to	contribute to charity
cope with	cope with stress
count on / upon	count on me
cure of	cured of cancer
deal with / in	deal with a problem; deal in cloth
decide on	decide on a plan
depend on / upon	depend on parents
differ from (things) / with (opinion)	differs from the other
disagree with	disagree with him
discuss (no prep)	discuss the matter
dispose of	disposed of waste
distinguish between	distinguish between right and wrong
divide into / among / between	divide the cake into four parts
dream of / about	dream of becoming a doctor
drink to	drink to his health
escape from	escaped from jail
excel in	excels in sports
exchange for / with	exchange rupees for dollars
fall in love with / ill	fell in love with her
feed on	cows feed on grass
fight against / with	fight against injustice
forgive for	forgive me for my mistake
glance at	glanced at the clock
hint at	hinted at his plan
inquire into / about	inquire into the case
interfere in / with	do not interfere in my work
introduce to	introduce him to the guests
invite to	invited me to dinner
jump at / to	jump at the chance
lead to	this led to trouble
live on (food) / in (place) / at (address)	live on rice
look at / for / after / into / up / down on	look after children
operate on	operate on a patient

Verb + preposition	Example
participate in	participate in a debate
part with / from	part with money
pay for / to	pay for the ticket
persist in	persist in his plan
pray to / for	pray to God for peace
prefer to	prefer tea to coffee
prevent from	prevent them from entering
prohibit from	prohibited from smoking
protect from / against	protect from danger
provide with / for	provide the poor with food
punish for	punished for lying
quarrel with (person) over / about	quarrel with a neighbour
recover from	recovered from illness
rely on / upon	rely on him
remind of / about	reminds me of my mother
resign from	resigned from the post
result in / from	results in failure; results from carelessness
shout at (angry) / to (call)	shout at the child
speak to / with / about	speak to the manager
spend on	spend money on books
stare at	stared at the stranger
subscribe to	subscribe to a magazine
suspect of	suspected of theft
think of / about	think of a plan
throw at (hit) / to (give)	threw a stone at me
trust in / with	trust in God
warn of / against	warn him of danger
wish for	wish for peace
write to / on / about	write to a friend
yearn for	yearn for home

Dependent Prepositions: Adjectives and Participles

Adjective + preposition	Example
angry with (person) / at (thing) / about	angry with him; angry at his behaviour
anxious about / for	anxious about the result

Adjective + preposition	Example
ashamed of	ashamed of his conduct
careful of / about	careful of your health
certain of / about	certain of success
confident of	confident of winning
conscious of	conscious of his mistake
crazy about	crazy about cricket
deaf to	deaf to advice
delighted at / with	delighted with the gift
disappointed with / at	disappointed with the result
envious of	envious of his luck
essential to / for	essential for health
faithful to	faithful to his friends
free from / of	free from worry
friendly with / to	friendly with all
furious with / at	furious with him
glad at / about	glad at the news
good at / for / to	good at maths; good for health; good to the poor
grateful to (person) for	grateful to you for your help
happy about / with	happy with the result
hopeful of	hopeful of success
identical with / to	identical with that
ignorant of	ignorant of the law
impressed with / by	impressed with his speech
independent of	independent of parents
indifferent to	indifferent to pain
innocent of	innocent of the crime
liable to	liable to error
mad at / about	mad about cricket
necessary for	necessary for life
obedient to	obedient to parents
opposed to	opposed to the plan
pleased with / at	pleased with the gift
poor in / at	poor in maths
popular with / among	popular with children

Adjective + preposition	Example
quick at / in	quick at learning
ready for / to	ready for the exam
responsible for (thing) / to (person)	responsible for the loss
sad at / about	sad at the news
scared of	scared of snakes
sensitive to	sensitive to light
short of	short of money
shy of	shy of strangers
sick of	sick of waiting
slow in / at	slow in replying
sorry for / about	sorry for the delay
strict with	strict with students
superior / inferior to	superior to others
sure of / about	sure of success
suspicious of	suspicious of strangers
tired of (bored) / from (exhausted)	tired of waiting
true to	true to his word
useful for / to	useful for students
worthy of	worthy of praise

Dependent Prepositions: Nouns

Noun + preposition	Example
access to	access to the library
admiration for	admiration for heroes
advantage of / over	the advantage of speed; over others
application for (job) / to (person)	application for leave
attitude to / towards	attitude to work
belief in	belief in God
charge of / against	a charge of theft
comparison between / with	comparison between two
confidence in	confidence in him
connection between / with	connection with crime
contribution to	contribution to science
damage to	damage to property
decrease / increase in	increase in prices

Noun + preposition	Example
difference between / in	difference between right and wrong
doubt about / of	doubt about his honesty
example of	an example of courage
exception to	exception to the rule
faith in	faith in God
hope of	hope of success
love for / of	love for the country
objection to	objection to the plan
opinion of / about	opinion of him
pity on / for	pity on the poor
pride in	pride in his work
problem with	a problem with the machine
responsibility for	responsibility for the work
room for	no room for argument
solution to / for	the solution to the problem
sympathy for / with	sympathy for the victims
taste for	taste for music
trouble with	trouble with the car
visit to	a visit to Agra
wish for	wish for a bicycle

Idioms and Fixed Prepositional Phrases

Preposition	Common phrases
at	at all, at once, at least, at last, at length, at random, at ease, at peace, at war, at work, at risk, at a loss, at a glance, at hand, at fault, at first sight, at heart, at large, at stake, at the cost of, at the mercy of, at ease
by	by chance, by mistake, by heart, by far, by name, by hand, by air / sea / road, by the way, by oneself, by turns, by degrees, by and large
for	for good, for ever, for example, for instance, for sale, for the time being, for the sake of, for certain, for fun, for free, for short
from	from time to time, from top to bottom, from beginning to end, from door to door
in	in fact, in case, in charge of, in danger, in debt, in detail, in fashion, in favour of, in front of, in general, in haste, in order to, in a hurry, in short, in public, in private, in all, in turn, in vain, in tears, in trouble, in a nutshell, in the long run, in memory of, in time, in need, in person, in place of, in the open, in tune
of	of course, of late, of use, of value, of no avail, out of order, out of date, out of the question, out of stock, out of work
on	on account of, on behalf of, on business, on duty, on fire, on foot, on holiday, on leave, on purpose, on the whole, on sale, on time, on the contrary, on the other hand, on the spot, on the verge of, on strike, on and off

Preposition	Common phrases
to	to my surprise, to a great extent, to the point, to the best of my knowledge, to some extent, face to face, back to back
under	under control, under construction, under arrest, under pressure, under the circumstances, under discussion
with	with care, with regard to, with reference to, with a view to, with pleasure, with effort, with the exception of
without	without doubt, without fail, without delay

Confusing Pairs of Prepositions

Pair	Distinction
at / to	at = position; to = movement; throw at = to hit; throw to = to catch
by / until	by = deadline; until = continuing action
during / for	during = within a period; for = how long
in / within	in an hour = after an hour; within an hour = before the hour ends
across / through / over	across = from side to side on a surface; through = inside a space; over = above and across
from / since	from = starting point (any tense); since = perfect tenses
after / behind	after = later in time or follows; behind = in the back

Omission and Editing: Preposition Errors

In 'omission' items a preposition is often the missing word; in 'editing' a wrong preposition is replaced.

- Missing after verbs: *He is fond **of** music. They congratulated me **on** my success. She is waiting **for** the bus.*
- Wrong choice: *He is good in maths* - good **at** maths. *Angry on him* - angry **with** him. *Died from cancer* - died **of** cancer.
- Unnecessary preposition: *Discuss **about** the matter* - discuss the matter; *enter into the room* - enter the room; *reach to Delhi* - reach Delhi; *marry with her* - marry her; *order for tea* - order tea; *attack on the enemy* is fine, but *attacked on the enemy* is wrong.
- Preposition before gerund: *He is capable to do* - capable **of** doing; *insist to go* - insist **on** going.
- Adverbs mistaken for prepositions: *went to home* - went home.

Wrong	Right
Different than	different from
Prefer to walk than to ride	prefer walking to riding
Discuss about the problem	discuss the problem
She is married with a doctor	married to a doctor
He died from cancer	died of cancer
I am agree with you	I agree with you
He entered into the hall	He entered the hall
He reached to the station	He reached the station / got to the station
Listen me	Listen to me
She is senior than me	senior to me

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- At = point; on = surface / day / date; in = enclosed space / month / year / period.
- Since = point of time; for = period; by = deadline; till = continuing; during = within.
- Between = two; among = many; beside = next to; besides = in addition to; in = place; into = movement.
- After a preposition use a noun, pronoun or gerund. Never 'to home', 'discuss about', 'reach to', 'marry with'.
- Senior / junior / superior / inferior / prefer / prior take to; different takes from.
- Learn dependent prepositions as fixed pairs: afraid of, good at, angry with, interested in, responsible for, proud of.
- Use the grouped lists for verbs, adjectives, nouns and idioms; test yourself in the exercise bank.

Sentence Structure, Clauses and Transformation

Transformation means rewriting a sentence in a different form without changing its meaning: simple to complex, active to passive, affirmative to negative, statement to question. It rests on understanding phrases and clauses. This chapter first builds that foundation and then drills every transformation pattern asked in board papers.

NOTE

Foundation (revise from Part 1, Chapter 18): phrases, clauses, simple/compound/complex sentences, affirmative-negative and assertive-interrogative-exclamatory changes, word order and punctuation. Here we deal with synthesis, analysis, degree of emphasis and inversion.

▸ Complex to compound and back

Although he is rich, he is unhappy = He is rich but unhappy. He told me that he was ill = He told me about his illness. (simple).

Synthesis: Joining Sentences

Method	Two sentences	Joined
Participle (present)	He saw the snake. He ran away.	Seeing the snake, he ran away.
Participle (perfect)	She finished her work. She went home.	Having finished her work, she went home.
Participle (past)	He was shocked by the news. He fainted.	Shocked by the news, he fainted.
Infinitive	He worked hard. He wanted to pass.	He worked hard to pass.
Gerund / preposition	He was punished. He told a lie.	He was punished for telling a lie.
Noun in apposition	Rahul is my friend. He is a pilot.	Rahul, my friend, is a pilot.
Adverb / adverbial phrase	He did the work. He did it carefully.	He did the work carefully.
Relative clause	I met a man. He knew you.	I met a man who knew you.
Co-ordinator	She is clever. She is hard-working.	She is both clever and hard-working.
Subordinator	He was tired. He kept working.	Though he was tired, he kept working.
not only ... but also	He is a singer. He is a dancer.	He is not only a singer but also a dancer.
either ... or / neither ... nor	He did not call. He did not write.	He neither called nor wrote.
no sooner ... than	He reached the station. The train left.	No sooner had he reached the station than the train left.

Analysis is the opposite: breaking a complex or compound sentence into simple ones or listing its clauses with their kinds.

Too ... to, So ... that, Enough ... to

Pattern	Example	Equivalent
too + adj + to	The tea is too hot to drink.	The tea is so hot that I cannot drink it.
so + adj + that + cannot	He is so weak that he cannot walk.	He is too weak to walk.

Pattern	Example	Equivalent
enough + to	He is strong enough to lift it.	He is so strong that he can lift it.
adj + enough (positive)	She is old enough to vote.	She is so old that she can vote.
too ... to (negative sense)	The news is too good to be true.	The news is so good that it cannot be true.

IMPORTANT

'Too' has a negative sense ('more than needed'). Do not say 'too happy to see you' - say *very glad*. In 'too ... to' there is **no 'not'**: *The box is too heavy to lift* (not 'to not lift'). When changing to 'so ... that', add **cannot / could not** with the same tense and a pronoun object.

Inversion and Emphasis

When certain negative or restrictive words open a sentence, the auxiliary comes before the subject.

Opening	Pattern	Example
Never / Rarely / Seldom / Scarcely	adverb + aux + subject + verb	Never have I seen such a sight.
No sooner ... than	No sooner + had + subject + V3 + than	No sooner had he left than it rained.
Hardly / Scarcely ... when / before	Hardly + had + subject + V3 + when	Hardly had I reached when the bell rang.
Not only ... but also	Not only + aux + subject + verb	Not only did he lie, but he also cheated.
Only after / Only when / Only then	Only after ... + aux + subject	Only after the bell did he leave.
Little / Under no circumstances / On no account	aux + subject	Little did she know. On no account must you leave.
So + adj + be / Such + be	So great was the shock that ...	So loud was the noise that he woke.
Here / There + verb (nouns)		Here comes the bus. There goes the bell.

▸ Emphasis by 'It is ... that' (cleft sentences)

Ravi broke the window. - It was Ravi who broke the window. It was the window that Ravi broke. What I need is rest.

Other Transformation Patterns

Pattern	Original	Transformed
Degree	She is the best singer in the class.	No other singer in the class is as good as she.
Voice	Ravi wrote the letter.	The letter was written by Ravi.
Narration	He said, "I am tired."	He said that he was tired.
Unless / if not	Unless you work hard, you will fail.	If you do not work hard, you will fail.
Condition to other	If you hurry, you will catch the bus.	Hurry up, or you will miss the bus. / Hurry up and you will catch the bus.
Despite / in spite of	Although he was ill, he went to school.	In spite of his illness, he went to school.
As soon as	As soon as he saw me, he ran away.	On seeing me, he ran away.
Because / due to	He failed because he was careless.	He failed due to his carelessness.

Pattern	Original	Transformed
Not only	He is intelligent as well as hard-working.	He is not only intelligent but also hard-working.
Wish	I am sorry I am not rich.	I wish I were rich.
Prefer	I like tea more than coffee.	I prefer tea to coffee.
Would rather	I prefer staying home to going out.	I would rather stay at home than go out.
Used to	He smoked in the past.	He used to smoke.
Suggest	Why don't we go for a walk?	Let us go for a walk. / How about going for a walk?

Common Errors

Wrong	Right	Reason
Seeing the tiger, the fear gripped him.	Seeing the tiger, he was gripped by fear.	dangling participle
Though he is poor but he is honest.	Though he is poor, he is honest.	no 'but' with though
Because he was ill, so he did not come.	Because he was ill, he did not come.	no 'so' with because
He is too tired to not walk.	He is too tired to walk.	no double negative
No sooner he came when it rained.	No sooner had he come than it rained.	inversion and than
Hardly he had arrived than the bell rang.	Hardly had he arrived when the bell rang.	hardly - when
I wish I was rich.	I wish I were rich.	subjunctive were
Not only he is clever but also honest.	Not only is he clever but also honest.	inversion after not only

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- A clause has a subject and a finite verb; kinds: noun, adjective (relative), adverb clauses.
- Simple = one finite verb; compound = and / but / or; complex = main + subordinate clause.
- Too ... to = so ... that ... cannot; enough ... to = so ... that ... can.
- Opposite-meaning swaps, no other ... as ... as, none but, never + opposite give negative forms.
- Negative openers (never, no sooner, hardly, not only, little) trigger inversion.
- Rhetorical questions flip polarity; exclamatory: What a / How.
- Participle phrases need the same subject as the main clause.
- Avoid double connectors: though ... but, because ... so.

Writing-Support Grammar: Techniques for Board Exam Items

Section C of the paper does not ask for rules; it asks you to apply them quickly to passages, dialogues and headlines. This chapter gives a method, the typical traps and solved examples for each item type: editing, omission, sentence reordering, dialogue completion, gap filling, newspaper headlines and procedure (process) reporting.

Overview of the Item Types

Item type	What you do	Grammar tested	Typical marks
Gap filling (multiple choice)	choose the best option for each blank in a passage	determiners, tenses, prepositions, connectors, modals, relatives	4
Sentence completion / dialogue completion	choose or write what fits a conversation	tenses, modals, question forms, reported speech	4
Sentence reordering	arrange jumbled words / phrases into a sentence	word order, subject-verb-object	4
Editing	find and correct one error per line	tense, agreement, determiners, prepositions, comparison, modals	4
Omission	supply the missing word in each line	articles, prepositions, auxiliaries, connectors	4
Sentence transformation / reported speech / voice	rewrite in another form	voice, narration, clauses	4
Newspaper headlines	complete news items from headlines	tense, voice, headline language	4
Procedure reporting	complete a process in passive	passive voice	4

Editing

▸ How the item works

A passage of 8 lines (each has one error) with columns 'Incorrect word' and 'Correction'. The first line is solved as an example. Write only the one wrong word and its correct form in the columns. Underline the word in the passage if asked.

▸ Twelve typical error categories

No.	Error type	Wrong	Correct	How to spot
1	Tense / verb form	People physical activity **had** decreased these days.	has	time word 'these days' needs present perfect
2	Subject-verb agreement	Their excess weight **make** them sick.	makes	subject 'weight' is singular
3	Subject-verb agreement (plural)	They **does** not want to walk.	do	they takes do
4	Determiners (article)	He is **a** honest man.	an	honest has a vowel sound
5	Determiners (quantity)	He has **few** water.	little	uncountable noun takes little
6	Comparison	Inactivity is the **greater** cause.	greatest	'the' + superlative
7	Preposition	They spend money **in** medicine.	on	spend ... on

No.	Error type	Wrong	Correct	How to spot
8	Connector	He was ill **but** he went to school. / Though he was poor, **but** honest.	yet / remove but	though does not take but
9	Non-finite (gerund/infinitive)	They spend time **watch** television.	watching	spend + time + -ing
10	Modal	You **must to** go.	must go	no to after must
11	Relative pronoun	The man **which** came was my uncle.	who	person takes who
12	Pronoun / number / gender	Each of the boys has **their** book.	his	each is singular

▸ Method

Step 1 — Read for sense
read the whole passage once and decide its tense and subject.

Step 2 — Check each line
run through the checklist: tense, agreement, article, preposition, comparison, modal, connector, gerund / infinitive, pronoun, spelling.

Step 3 — Correct only one word
the correction should be a single word (sometimes 'is - are', 'to - for') and must fit the line; keep the spelling exact.

Step 4 — Recheck
read the corrected line with its neighbours to make sure the passage reads smoothly.

▸ Solved example

Inactivity is the greater cause of overweight these days. People physical activity had decreased these days. The main reason is that there is many labour saving devices. They does not want to walk on foot. They spend enough time sitting and watch television. Their excess weight make them sick and they have to spend money in medicine.

Incorrect word	Correction	Reason
greater	greatest	'the cause' needs superlative
People (physical activity)	people's	possessive needed
had	has	present perfect with 'these days'
is (there is many)	are	plural 'devices' needs 'are'
does	do	plural subject 'They'
enough	more / much	enough does not fit sense
watch	watching	spend time + -ing
make	makes	singular subject
in	on	spend money on

IMPORTANT
Each line has exactly one error. Correct one word only and leave the rest of the line unchanged; do not rewrite the sentence.

Omission

▸ How the item works

In each line a word is missing. Mark the gap with a slash (/) and write the missing word in the blank. Only one word is missing per line.

▸ What usually goes missing

Category	Typical missing words	Example
Articles	a, an, the	He is / honest man. (an)
Prepositions	of, to, in, on, at, for, by, with	They are fond / music. (of)
Conjunctions / connectors	and, but, or, that, because, so, while, if	He ran fast / he missed the train. (but)
Auxiliary verbs	is, are, was, has, have, did, will	She / working in Delhi. (is)
Modals	can, must, should, may	You / follow the rules. (must)
Pronouns / relatives	who, which, that, it, they	The man / came is my uncle. (who)
'to' with infinitive	to	We need / watch out. (to)
Possessives / determiners	his, their, some, any, this	He lost / bag. (his)

▸ Method

1. Read each line with the line before and after, as one flowing passage.
2. Read aloud in your mind and find where the sentence feels incomplete.
3. Predict the category: after a verb of need / want / try / begin, think 'to'; after a noun before another noun, think 'of'; between two clauses think 'and / but / because'.
4. Put the slash exactly before the position where the word should come.

▸ Solved example (from the syllabus pattern)

One thing we all must do / to cooperate with police and pay heed to their advice. - missing **is**: 'One thing we all must do **is** to cooperate'. They warn us not / touch unidentified ... - missing **to**. 'unclaimed suspicious objects like transistors, brief cases etc.' - missing **and** before 'unclaimed'. 'we need / watch out for' - **to**. 'abandoned cars, scooters / report the details' - **and**. 'report the details / such objects' - **of**. 'to the nearest police control room / dialing 100' - **by**.

> **IMPORTANT**
> In omission the missing word must restore meaning with minimal change; grammar-function words (articles, prepositions, auxiliaries, conjunctions) are the missing items, not content words.

Sentence Reordering

▸ Method (the six-step rule)

Step 1 — Find the subject
noun / pronoun that begins the sentence (often capitalised or the doer).

Step 2 — Find the helping verb
is, was, has, will, can. It usually sits right after the subject.

Step 3 — Find the main verb
then locate its form (V1, V2, V3, -ing).

Step 4 — Find objects and complements
direct and indirect objects, then adverbs of manner, place and time.

Step 5 — Look for wh-words and linkers
they begin clauses (when, because, so that, which).

Step 6 — Build and check
arrange in a meaningful sentence; check the grammar (tense, agreement) and punctuation.

▸ Signal words that tell the order

Signal	What it tells you	Example
Capital letter (not a proper noun) or 'It / They / He'	starts the sentence	It was first grown ...
Adverbs of time like 'about 5000 years ago'	usually at the end	
'who / which / that'	follows the noun it describes	the man who came
'to' + verb	purpose, after the main clause	He went out to buy milk.
'when / while / because'	start a subordinate clause	when they travelled across a desert
'and / but / so'	between clauses	
'by' + noun	agent in a passive sentence	was used by travellers

▸ Solved examples

1. around / it is / 96 countries / cultivated in / the world. - **It is cultivated in 96 countries around the world.**
2. in Africa / about 5000 years / grown / ago / it was / first. - **It was first grown in Africa about 5000 years ago.**
3. say that / at the / it was grown / some researchers / same time / in India. - **Some researchers say that it was grown in India at the same time.**
4. the travellers / across a desert / it was / when they / used by / travelled. - **It was used by travellers when they travelled across a desert.**

Dialogue Completion

▸ How the item works

You get a conversation with 4 blanks and four options for each. Choose the reply that fits the tense, the speaker's role and the sense of the next line.

▸ Techniques

- Read the line **before** and the line **after** the blank; the answer must connect both.
- Match the **tense**: a question 'When did you leave?' needs a past reply; 'Have you decided?' needs 'I haven't decided yet'.
- Match the **question type**: yes / no question - 'Yes, I have'; wh-question - gives the information asked.
- Check **pronouns** and **time words** for consistency (reported statements within dialogue).
- Reject options that are grammatically wrong (wrong tense, wrong word order, wrong article).
- Prefer the **polite, complete** option in formal situations (may I know ... would you mind ...).

▸ Solved example

Sister: Where have you decided to stay? Brother: (a) **I haven't decided as yet.** Sister: Why are you not staying with Aunt and Uncle? Brother: (b) **They are too strict.** I won't be able to enjoy my holidays. Sister: Don't tell me you'll stay in a hotel! Brother: Definitely not (c) **I plan to stay with Rahul.** Sister: How are you both spending your vacation? Brother: (d) **We'll go sight-seeing.**

Why (a): the question uses present perfect ('have you decided'), the answer must be present perfect ('haven't decided'). Why (b): present tense general statement ('too strict') followed by the result clause. Why (c): 'Definitely not' means not a hotel; so the plan is another place. Why (d): the future ('will go') fits 'spending your vacation'.

Gap Filling

▸ Techniques

1. Read the passage once ignoring the blanks to get the sense and the tense.
2. For each blank decide the word class needed: noun, verb, adjective, preposition, article, connector, relative pronoun.
3. Test every option in the sentence and eliminate impossible ones (agreement, tense, collocation).

4. Check collocations: 'made large buildings sway', 'caught people off guard', 'works as a predictor'.
5. Check the sense of the surrounding sentences: cause / effect, contrast, addition.

▸ Tips for common blanks

Type of blank	Think of	Example
Article / determiner	countable / uncountable; first mention; superlative	its **biggest** earthquake in more than a year
Preposition	fixed pairs	escaped **with** little damage; caught people **off** guard
Relative pronoun	person - who, thing - which	a magnitude of 6.6, **which** made buildings sway
Tense	time words and neighbouring verbs	because it **was** centred far beneath the floor
Connector	meaning relationship	Fruits are picked early **for** otherwise they become overripe
Modal	possibility, necessity	they **may** become overripe
Non-finite	after prepositions use -ing	interested in **studying**

▸ Solved example

Tokyo was rocked by its (a) **biggest** earthquake in more than a year today, but escaped (b) **with** little damage because it (c) **was** centred far beneath the floor of the Pacific Ocean. The quake (d) **which** struck shortly before noon with a magnitude of 6.6, (e) **made** large buildings sway back and forth. The intense (f) **shaking** for about one minute caught people (g) **off** guard in Tokyo and other cities (h) **towards** the east.

Newspaper Headlines

▸ Headline language: the rules

Feature	Headline	Expanded sentence
Present tense for the past (news-simple present)	CAPARO ENTERS US MARKET	has entered / entered
Infinitive for the future	PM TO VISIT PAKISTAN ON APRIL 11	will visit / is to visit / will be going to Pakistan
Past participle without 'be' (passive)	BOY RESCUED FROM WELL	A boy was / has been rescued from a well.
-ing form for continuing action	PRICES RISING	Prices are rising.
Articles and auxiliaries dropped	TV SHOW LANDS BOY IN HOSPITAL	A TV show has landed a boy in hospital.
Short words: 'quit' for 'resign', 'ban', 'probe', 'row', 'hit'	MINISTER QUITS	The minister has resigned.
Colon / dash for the speaker	5 LAKH JOBS TO BE CREATED BY 2012: PLANNING COMMISSION	The Planning Commission said that 5 lakh jobs will be created by 2012.
Numerals	2 KILLED IN ACCIDENT	Two people were killed in an accident.

▸ Method for completing news items

- Identify the time: past (reported event) - simple past or present perfect; future - will + verb, is to + verb, is going to + verb.
- Identify voice: if the headline's subject is the sufferer (*Boy rescued*), use the passive; if it is the doer (*Show lands boy*), use the active.
- Expand abbreviations and numbers; add articles.

- Match the blank to the rest of the sentence: after 'when' keep the tense sequence; after 'that' use reported-speech tense.

▸ Solved examples

(a) CAPARO ENTERS US MARKET - The Lord Swaraj Paul Caparo group **has entered** the North American vehicle market. (b) PM TO VISIT PAKISTAN ON APRIL 11 - ... informed that Prime Minister Mr Manmohan **will be going to Pakistan on a three-day visit** in the second week of April. (c) TV SHOW LANDS BOY IN HOSPITAL - A popular show ... **has landed a 13-year-old boy in hospital**, when he filled his mouth with kerosene ... (d) KIDS FALL ILL AFTER EATING MID-DAY MEAL - 5 kids ... **fell ill** after having mid-day meal on Friday. (e) SPORTS WEEK CELEBRATION ENDS - A week-long sports day celebration ... **ended** on 22 April with a grand prize distribution ceremony.

Procedure (Process) Reporting

You are given a list of instructions (imperative) and have to complete a passage describing the process in the **passive**. The question usually gives a hint, 'Hint - is / are', for the tense.

Step 1 — Read the instructions
find the object of each imperative (Collect the clothes: object = the clothes).

Step 2 — Convert to passive present
object + is / are + V3 (clothes are collected).

Step 3 — Join with sequence words
first, then, after that, next, finally.

Step 4 — Keep numbers and plural agreement
is for singular / uncountable, are for plural: *water is boiled; noodles are added*.

Imperative	Passive
Collect all the dirty white clothes.	All the dirty white clothes are collected.
Soak them in a boiling water and soap solution.	They are soaked in a mixture of boiling water and soap.
Take them out and beat them with fists or stick.	They are taken out and beaten with fists or a stick.
Rinse them in running water until the soap is washed off.	They are rinsed in running water until the soap content is washed off.
Squeeze them and hang them for drying.	They are squeezed and hung for drying.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Editing: one error per line; check tense, agreement, article, preposition, comparison, modal, connector, gerund / infinitive.
- Omission: the missing word is a function word (article, preposition, auxiliary, conjunction, 'to').
- Reordering: subject, helping verb, main verb, object, wh-word / linker, then adverbs of manner, place, time.
- Dialogue completion: match tense and question type with the neighbouring lines.
- Gap filling: decide the word class, test collocations and eliminate options.
- Headlines: present for past news, 'to' for future, past participle for passive; expand with articles and auxiliaries.
- Procedure writing uses the present passive with sequence words.

CHAPTER 17 · EXERCISES

Exercise Bank · Part A — Topic-wise Practice (14 Syllabus Topics)

One exercise set for each of the fourteen prescribed grammar topics. Each set mixes board-paper forms: MCQ, fill-in, error correction, joining and rewriting. Do a set after revising the matching chapter and check it against Part D.

A1 · Determiners

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. ___ honest man is respected everywhere. (a) A (b) An (c) The (d) No article
2. ___ Ganga is the holiest river of India. (a) A (b) An (c) The (d) No article
3. ___ Himalayas protect India from the cold winds. (a) A (b) An (c) The (d) No article
4. Gold is ___ precious metal. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article
5. We saw ___ one-eyed beggar at the gate. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article
6. Kalidas is called ___ Shakespeare of India. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article
7. ___ poor deserve our help. (a) A (b) An (c) The (d) No article
8. My father reads ___ Hindu every morning. (a) a (b) an (c) the (d) no article
9. I have ___ money left, so I cannot buy the book. (a) a little (b) little (c) the little (d) few
10. There is ___ milk in the fridge, just enough for tea. (a) few (b) a few (c) a little (d) little
11. ___ of the two roads leads to the station. (a) Every (b) Either (c) Many (d) Several
12. ___ people attended the meeting, so it was cancelled. (a) A few (b) Few (c) The few (d) Little
13. ___ student of this school wears a uniform. (a) All (b) Both (c) Every (d) Many
14. ___ of the two answers is correct. (a) Neither (b) None (c) No (d) Every
15. Correct the error: She gave me many informations about the course.
16. Fill in with a/an/the or X (no article): Please give me ___ one-rupee coin.

A2 · Tenses

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. I ___ (know) him since my childhood.
2. By the time we reached the hall, the film ___ (begin).
3. They ___ (play) cricket when it started to rain.
4. She ___ (not / finish) her homework yet.
5. Tomorrow at this time, I ___ (fly) to Delhi.
6. By next June, he ___ (complete) his course.
7. The train ___ (leave) at 6 p.m. tomorrow.
8. The Prime Minister ___ (visit) Japan next week.
9. He is knowing the answer. (Correct the sentence.)
10. We ___ (wait) here since morning.
11. After she ___ (finish) her work, she went home.
12. The teacher said that the earth ___ (move) round the sun.
13. He ___ for the school team since 2019. (a) plays (b) is playing (c) has been playing (d) played
14. At 8 p.m. last night, we ___ dinner. (a) have (b) were having (c) had had (d) are having
15. Ravi ___ English for five years before he went abroad. (a) studies (b) has studied (c) had been studying (d) was studied
16. Name the tense: She will have been teaching for twenty years by 2030.

17. I ___ (go) to Agra tomorrow; I have already bought the ticket.

A3 · Subject-Verb Agreement

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. Each of the boys ___ a prize. (a) get (b) gets (c) have (d) has received
2. Neither Ram nor his brothers ___ present. (a) was (b) is (c) were (d) has been
3. The committee ___ announced its decision. (a) have (b) has (c) are (d) were
4. The news ___ shocking. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been
5. A number of students ___ absent today. (a) is (b) was (c) are (d) has been
6. The number of students ___ increasing. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been
7. Either you or I ___ responsible. (a) is (b) am (c) are (d) were
8. Two hundred rupees ___ a big amount for him. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been
9. The scissors ___ on the table. (a) is (b) was (c) are (d) has been
10. Many a boy ___ failed in the test. (a) have (b) has (c) are (d) were
11. She, as well as her sisters, ___ going to the fair. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been
12. Time and tide ___ for none. (a) waits (b) is waiting (c) wait (d) has waited
13. There ___ many reasons for his failure. (a) is (b) was (c) has (d) are
14. Half of the apples ___ rotten. (a) was (b) is (c) were (d) has been
15. Correct the error: Physics are a difficult subject.
16. My uncle, together with his children, ___ visiting us tomorrow. (a) are (b) is (c) were (d) have been

A4 · Non-finites

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. The boy, ___ (tire) after the race, slept at once.
2. Identify the non-finite: Swimming is a good exercise.
3. Identify the non-finite: A rolling stone gathers no moss.
4. Combine using a participle: He saw the lion. He ran away.
5. Combine using an infinitive: He works hard. He wants to pass.
6. I look forward to ___ (meet) you.
7. Would you mind ___ (close) the window?
8. Correct the error: He is interested to learn music.
9. Correct the error: She avoided to answer my question.
10. It is time ___ (go) home.
11. The mother made the child ___ (drink) the milk.
12. Identify: Having finished the work, he went home.
13. Rewrite using 'too ... to': He was so tired that he could not walk.
14. I am used to ___ (get) up early.
15. Remember ___ (lock) the door before you leave.

A5 · Relatives

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. This is the house ___ I was born. (a) which (b) who (c) where (d) whose
2. The man ___ car was stolen reported to the police. (a) who (b) whom (c) whose (d) which
3. The teacher ___ we respect most is Mr Sharma. (a) whose (b) which (c) whom (d) where
4. This is all ___ I have. (a) which (b) who (c) that (d) what
5. Join with 'whose': The boy is my friend. His bicycle was stolen.

6. Join: She is the girl. I told you about her.
7. Correct the error: The boy which won the race is my brother.
8. Correct the error: The woman whom lives next door is a nurse.
9. Everything ___ he said was true. (a) which (b) what (c) that (d) who
10. The first person ___ entered the room was the Principal. (a) which (b) whom (c) whose (d) who
11. I have two sisters, ___ are doctors. (a) both of whom (b) both of who (c) both of which (d) whose both
12. Join with 'that': Switch off the fan. It is not in use.
13. This is the school in ___ I studied. (a) that (b) which (c) who (d) where
14. She did not tell me ___ she wanted. (a) that (b) which (c) what (d) whose
15. Join with 'who': Gandhiji was a great leader. He led India to freedom.

A6 · Connectors

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. I will not go ___ you invite me. (a) until (b) unless (c) although (d) because
2. He is not only intelligent ___ hardworking. (a) and (b) but also (c) or (d) nor
3. Neither the manager ___ the clerks were present. (a) or (b) nor (c) but (d) and
4. He ran fast ___ he could catch the bus. (a) so that (b) because (c) although (d) unless
5. It was so cold ___ we lit a fire. (a) which (b) as (c) that (d) than
6. He studied hard. ___, he failed. (a) Therefore (b) However (c) Moreover (d) Besides
7. The roads were flooded. ___, schools remained closed. (a) However (b) Therefore (c) Otherwise (d) Instead
8. Leave now. ___ you will miss the train. (a) Otherwise (b) Moreover (c) Hence (d) Besides
9. Rahul was absent ___ his illness. (a) because (b) though (c) due to (d) unless
10. Both Ritu ___ Rani passed the test. (a) or (b) nor (c) and (d) but
11. Join with 'though': She is poor. She is honest.
12. Join with 'as soon as': The teacher entered. The students stood up.
13. Rewrite with 'unless': If you do not practise, you cannot win.
14. Join with 'so ... that': He was very weak. He could not walk.
15. Rewrite with 'No sooner': As soon as he saw the police, he ran away.
16. He worked hard, ___ he could not succeed. (a) but (b) so (c) because (d) or

A7 · Conditionals

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. If he had studied, he ___ passed. (a) would (b) will have (c) would have (d) had
2. Unless you hurry, you ___ the bus. (a) miss (b) missed (c) would miss (d) will miss
3. I wish I ___ a car. (a) have (b) had (c) will have (d) would have
4. If she ___ (know) the truth, she would have told us.
5. Had I known, I ___ come. (a) will (b) would have (c) would (d) have
6. Were I you, I ___ apologise. (a) will (b) can (c) would (d) did
7. Rewrite with 'if': Unless you work hard, you will not pass.
8. Rewrite: If he had not helped me, I would have failed. (Begin: Without)
9. Rewrite with 'if': Work hard or you will fail.
10. Correct the error: If I will see him, I will tell him.
11. Correct the error: If I had a million rupees, I would have bought a house.
12. I wish I ___ (be) taller.
13. He talks as if he ___ (be) the owner of the shop.
14. If it ___ (not / rain), the match would have been played.
15. Suppose you ___ (win) a lottery, what would you do?

16. I will lend you the book provided you ___ (return) it on Monday.
17. Rewrite beginning with 'Had': If she had told me, I would have helped her.
18. He would have won the race if he ___ (not / be) injured.

A8 · Comparison

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. Ravi is senior ___ me. (a) than (b) to (c) from (d) over
2. He prefers tea ___ coffee. (a) than (b) from (c) to (d) over
3. Change the degree (comparative): No other boy in the class is as tall as Arun.
4. Change the degree (superlative): No other boy in the class is as tall as Arun.
5. Change the degree (comparative): Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.
6. Change the degree (positive): Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.
7. Change the degree (superlative): Very few boys in the class are as clever as Mohan.
8. Change the degree (superlative): Iron is more useful than any other metal.
9. Correct the error: This is the more beautiful place I have seen.
10. Correct the error: He is more taller than I.
11. Correct the error: Ram is senior than me.
12. Of the two sisters, Neha is the ___. (a) tall (b) taller (c) tallest (d) more tall
13. The ___ (hard) you work, the ___ (good) results you get.
14. It is getting ___ and ___ (cold) every day.
15. Of the two proposals, the ___ is better. (a) later (b) latter (c) last (d) latest
16. Rewrite with 'as ... as': Seema is not as tall as Reena. (Use 'taller')
17. Rewrite with 'not as ... as': Mumbai is bigger than Pune.

A9 · Avoiding Repetition

Rewrite or complete each item so that nothing is repeated unnecessarily.

1. She can't swim and ___ can I. (a) so (b) neither (c) also (d) either
2. He passed the exam and so ___ his sister. (a) did (b) does (c) was (d) has
3. 'Are you coming?' 'I hope ___.' (a) so (b) it (c) that (d) yes
4. 'Will it rain tomorrow?' 'I don't think ___.'
5. 'Is the shop closed?' 'I'm afraid ___.'
6. Which pen do you want, the red ___ or the blue ___?
7. The weather of Shimla is cooler than the weather of Delhi.
8. The population of India is larger than the population of the USA.
9. The rivers of the north are longer than the rivers of the south.
10. She wanted to go but her mother did not let her go.
11. Rita likes dancing. Rita's sister does not like dancing.
12. 'I have never seen a tiger.' '___ have I.' (a) So (b) Neither (c) Also (d) Too
13. Mohan likes to read novels and I like to read novels too. (Avoid repetition.)
14. Aman went to the market. Aman bought some fruit. Aman returned home. (Combine.)
15. She has not finished her work, and he has not finished his work either. (Avoid repetition.)

A10 · Nominalisation

Fill in the noun form of the word in brackets, or rewrite as directed (model answers are given).

1. His ___ (decide) to resign surprised everyone.
2. The ___ (explain) given by him was not convincing.

3. The ___ (pollute) of rivers is a serious problem.
4. The ___ (succeed) of the plan depends on teamwork.
5. The ___ (invent) of the telephone changed the world.
6. The ___ (grow) in population puts pressure on resources.
7. Rewrite with a noun phrase: The doctor examined the patient carefully.
8. Rewrite beginning 'His failure': Because he failed, he was sad.
9. Rewrite beginning 'His carelessness': He was late because he was careless.
10. Rewrite beginning 'Poverty': People are poor, so they cannot afford medicines.
11. Rewrite beginning 'Punctuality': Teachers are required to be punctual.
12. Rewrite beginning 'His victory': Everybody was surprised that he won.
13. Rewrite beginning 'The students' protest': The students protested, so the college closed.
14. The ___ (move) of the planets round the sun follows a fixed path.

A11 · Modals

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. He ___ be at home; his car is outside. (a) must (b) would (c) can (d) need
2. You ___ not smoke in a hospital. (a) must (b) dare (c) used (d) could
3. When I was young, I ___ swim in this river. (a) must (b) used to (c) shall (d) ought
4. She ___ have reached by now. (a) may (b) shall (c) ought (d) used
5. ___ you help me with this bag, please? (a) Would (b) Shall (c) Ought (d) Need
6. We ___ respect the national flag. (a) ought to (b) used to (c) dare (d) can
7. She said that she ___ help me. (a) can (b) could (c) may (d) shall
8. ___ I carry your bag? (a) Will (b) Shall (c) Must (d) May
9. You ___ get a prize if you win; I promise. (a) will (b) shall (c) can (d) may
10. Rewrite with 'should': It is advisable to drink boiled water.
11. Rewrite with 'may': Perhaps it will rain today.
12. Rewrite with 'ought to': It is your duty to help the poor.
13. Correct the error: He can swims very well.
14. You ___ not come tomorrow; it is a holiday. (a) must (b) need (c) ought (d) used
15. They ___ be tired after such a long journey. (a) must (b) can't (c) shall (d) used

A12 · Active and Passive

Change the voice as directed. (Active ↔ Passive.)

1. Someone has stolen my bicycle.
2. They are building a bridge over the river.
3. Who wrote this poem?
4. Open the door.
5. The children were singing a song.
6. You must obey the rules.
7. Did she post the letters?
8. Do not tell lies.
9. I know him.
10. They had completed the project.
11. He gave me a pen.
12. She teaches us English.
13. People speak English all over the world.
14. The window was being cleaned by the servant.

15. The match has been won by India.
16. Let the work be done at once.
17. Correct the error: The cake was ate by the children.

A13 · Reported Speech

Change into reported (indirect) speech, or complete as directed.

1. She said to me, “I will help you.”
2. The teacher said, “The earth moves round the sun.”
3. “Where do you live?” he asked me.
4. She said to him, “Are you coming?”
5. The mother said to the child, “Don't touch the fire.”
6. “Please help me,” he said to us.
7. She said, “I saw him yesterday.”
8. He said, “Alas! I am ruined.”
9. “What a beautiful garden!” she said.
10. He said, “Let us go for a walk.”
11. The captain said to the soldiers, “Stand at ease.”
12. He said to me, “Why are you late?”
13. She told me that she had lost her pen. (Direct speech)
14. He asked me whether I had seen his book. (Direct speech)
15. She advised him to work hard. (Direct speech)
16. In reported speech (past reporting verb) 'now', 'here', 'today' and 'tomorrow' change to:
17. In reported speech (past reporting verb) 'yesterday', 'this', 'ago' and 'last night' change to:

A14 · Prepositions

Attempt every item. Where options are given, choose the correct one; otherwise do as directed.

1. She is fond ___ music. (a) of (b) at (c) for (d) with
2. I have lived here ___ 2010. (a) for (b) since (c) from (d) by
3. He has been ill ___ a week. (a) since (b) from (c) for (d) by
4. He divided the sweets ___ the two boys. (a) among (b) between (c) with (d) to
5. ___ the three sisters, Neha is the tallest. (a) Between (b) Among (c) With (d) By
6. He was accused ___ theft. (a) for (b) of (c) with (d) on
7. She is weak ___ English. (a) at (b) in (c) on (d) of
8. He is ashamed ___ his conduct. (a) of (b) for (c) at (d) with
9. We congratulated him ___ his success. (a) for (b) at (c) on (d) with
10. The boy is jealous ___ his brother. (a) from (b) of (c) to (d) at
11. He apologised ___ me ___ his rudeness. (a) to; for (b) for; to (c) with; for (d) to; of
12. He agreed ___ the proposal. (a) with (b) at (c) to (d) on
13. He insisted ___ paying the bill. (a) in (b) on (c) at (d) for
14. I was surprised ___ the news. (a) at (b) on (c) of (d) for
15. He is addicted ___ video games. (a) with (b) for (c) to (d) at
16. The shop is open ___ 9 a.m. ___ 9 p.m. (a) from; to (b) since; to (c) at; to (d) in; from
17. Correct the error: I prefer coffee than tea.
18. Correct the error: He is suffering with fever.
19. The police prevented the crowd ___ entering the building. (a) to (b) from (c) of (d) at

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Attempt a set without notes, then mark it with Part D.
- For every wrong answer, write the rule in one line; repeat the set after a week.

Exercise Bank · Part B — Question-type Practice

Board-pattern sets by question type: five gap-filling passages, five editing, five omission and five reordering sets, five dialogues, six reported-speech conversations, five sets of headlines, six procedure passages, five transformation sets and eight sentence-completion sets. Work through one type at a time.

B1 · Gap Filling (Passage-based MCQ)

▸ B1.1 · Gap Filling — Solar Energy

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

The sun is **(1)** _____ richest source of energy on Earth. Every day it sends **(2)** _____ the earth far more energy than all human beings **(3)** _____ in a year. Scientists **(4)** _____ developed panels which convert sunlight into electricity. These panels, **(5)** _____ are fitted on rooftops, work silently and cause no pollution. **(6)** _____ they are costly at first, they save money **(7)** _____ the long run. If more families **(8)** _____ solar power, our cities would breathe cleaner air.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	a	an	the	some
2	at	to	for	on
3	uses	using	use	used
4	has	have	are	had
5	who	whose	which	where
6	Because	Although	Unless	Until
7	on	at	in	by
8	adopt	adopted	will adopt	would adopt

▸ B1.2 · Gap Filling — Mobile Phones

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Mobile phones have **(1)** _____ a necessary part of our lives. Students use them **(2)** _____ searching for information, but many of them waste hours **(3)** _____ games and videos. A recent survey says that the number of teenagers **(4)** _____ sleep late **(5)** _____ steadily. Doctors warn that **(6)** _____ much screen time **(7)** _____ harm the eyes. It is high time we **(8)** _____ to use phones wisely.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	became	become	becomes	becoming
2	for	with	to	at
3	on	in	at	of
4	who	whose	whom	which
5	increase	are increasing	is increasing	were increased
6	too	enough	very	quite
7	can	could have	may be	is
8	learn	learnt	learning	will learn

▸ B1.3 · Gap Filling — Saving Water

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Water is **(1)** _____ precious that we cannot afford to waste even a drop. In many villages of Rajasthan, women walk **(2)** _____ kilometres to fetch water. Rainwater harvesting, **(3)** _____ was practised by our ancestors, is being revived **(4)** _____ the government. If we **(5)** _____ now, future generations **(6)** _____ face a severe shortage. Each of us **(7)** _____ a duty to save water **(8)** _____ we can.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	so	such	very	too
2	several	much	little	a little
3	who	what	which	whom
4	from	by	with	through
5	did not act	do not act	would not act	had not acted
6	would have	will have	would	will
7	have	has	are having	having
8	whichever	whatever	however	whomever

▸ B1.4 · Gap Filling — Yoga

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Yoga, **(1)** _____ originated in India thousands of years ago, is now practised **(2)** _____ the world. It consists of postures, breathing exercises and meditation. People **(3)** _____ practise yoga regularly **(4)** _____ fewer health problems than those who do not. Instructors advise beginners **(5)** _____ start with simple postures. One **(6)** _____ not expect results overnight; patience and regularity **(7)** _____ needed. Since 2015, the International Day of Yoga **(8)** _____ celebrated on 21 June.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	which	who	whose	where
2	all over	over all	all across of	around of
3	who	whom	which	whose
4	has	have	having	to have
5	to	for	by	on
6	should	would	might	used
7	is	are	was	has
8	is	has been	was	have been

▸ B1.5 · Gap Filling — A Museum Visit

Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option.

Last Sunday our class **(1)** _____ a visit to the museum. We **(2)** _____ there by 9 a.m., but the guide **(3)** _____ not yet arrived. While we **(4)** _____ for him, we looked at a huge stone statue. When he finally came, he apologised **(5)** _____ being late. He told us that the museum **(6)** _____ three floors. We **(7)** _____ never seen so many ancient coins **(8)** _____ one place. Everyone returned home tired but happy.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	did	made	took	gave
2	reached	arrive	are reaching	had reach

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
3	has	had	have	was
4	wait	waited	were waiting	had waited
5	for	of	at	to
6	have	would have	had	is having
7	had	have	has	were
8	in	at	on	to

B2 · Editing

▸ B2.1 · Editing — Sleep

The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Doctors says that an adult needs seven to eight hours of sleep.		
(b)	However, many students sleeps for only five hours every night.		
(c)	They stay awake since midnight to watch videos.		
(d)	As a result, they feel tired at the day.		
(e)	Lack of sleep make it difficult to concentrate.		
(f)	A child which sleeps well performs better in class.		
(g)	Teachers should advises students to go to bed early.		
(h)	Good sleep is the cheaper medicine of all.		

▸ B2.2 · Editing — A Fair in the Village

The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Last week a fair is held in our village.		
(b)	People come from nearby towns to enjoy it.		
(c)	There was many shops selling toys and sweets.		
(d)	I bought a umbrella for my mother.		
(e)	My brother was fond for riding the giant wheel.		
(f)	The children laughed loud and clapped with joy.		
(g)	We returned home late in night.		
(h)	I had never enjoyed me so much before.		

▸ B2.3 · Editing — Newspaper Report: Flood Relief

The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Heavy rains has flooded several villages in the district.		

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(b)	More than two thousand people is living in relief camps.		
(c)	The Collector visited a affected areas yesterday.		
(d)	He said that food packets will be supplied to everyone.		
(e)	Volunteers are working day or night to help the victims.		
(f)	A boat carrying medicines were sent to the island.		
(g)	The rain has stopping but the water level is still high.		
(h)	Officials hope that normal life resumes soon.		

▸ B2.4 · Editing — Importance of Reading

The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Reading is one of the good habits a student can develop.		
(b)	A good book take us to a different world.		
(c)	It also improves our vocabulary and write skills.		
(d)	Students who reads regularly are often more confident speakers.		
(e)	I had been reading a novel every month since last year.		
(f)	Neither my brother nor my sister are fond of reading.		
(g)	Parents should to buy books for their children.		
(h)	Reading is an habit that stays for life.		

▸ B2.5 · Editing — The Marathon

The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction.

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	The annual marathon will held in our city next Sunday.		
(b)	Thousands of runners is expected to take part.		
(c)	The race will start at six at the morning.		
(d)	Roads will be close to traffic till noon.		
(e)	Participants should to reach the venue by five.		
(f)	Those whom have registered will get a free T-shirt.		
(g)	The route is longer from last year's.		
(h)	Everyone is looking forward for the event.		

B3 · Omission

▸ B3.1 · Omission — Police and Public

In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. The omitted word is shown in the key. Put a slash (/) where the word is missing and write the missing word in the space provided.

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	One thing we all must do to cooperate with the police.	
(b)	We should pay heed their advice at all times.	
(c)	They warn us not to touch unidentified unclaimed objects.	
(d)	We need to watch for abandoned cars and scooters.	
(e)	Anything suspicious must reported at once.	
(f)	The police control room can be reached dialling 100.	
(g)	Always report suspicious objects the nearest police station.	
(h)	Public cooperation the work of the police easier.	

▸ B3.2 · Omission — My Grandmother

In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. The omitted word is shown in the key. Put a slash (/) where the word is missing and write the missing word in the space provided.

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	My grandmother lives a small village near Ajmer.	
(b)	She wakes up five every morning.	
(c)	After a bath, she prays half an hour.	
(d)	Then she milks cow and prepares tea for everyone.	
(e)	She tells us stories her childhood.	
(f)	Her stories are full of lessons humour.	
(g)	She never been to a city.	
(h)	Yet she is wisest person I know.	

▸ B3.3 · Omission — Healthy Habits

In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. The omitted word is shown in the key. Put a slash (/) where the word is missing and write the missing word in the space provided.

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	A healthy body the foundation of a happy life.	
(b)	We should fresh food and avoid junk food.	
(c)	Drinking enough water the body stay fit.	
(d)	Regular exercise keeps us active cheerful.	
(e)	Many people complain lack of time.	
(f)	But even a short walk is better no exercise.	
(g)	Sleeping on time is important.	
(h)	If we follow these habits, we stay healthy.	

▸ B3.4 · Omission — The Railway Station

In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. The omitted word is shown in the key. Put a slash (/) where the word is missing and write the missing word in the space provided.

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	The railway station was crowded passengers.	
(b)	Porters were running and there with luggage.	
(c)	A voice from the loudspeaker that the train was late.	
(d)	Many people were sitting benches and reading newspapers.	
(e)	A small boy was selling tea the waiting passengers.	
(f)	At last the train with a loud whistle.	
(g)	Passengers rushed their coaches.	
(h)	Within minutes the platform quiet again.	

▸ B3.5 · Omission — Digital India

In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. The omitted word is shown in the key. Put a slash (/) where the word is missing and write the missing word in the space provided.

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	Digital India is a campaign make government services available online.	
(b)	Today people can pay bills home.	
(c)	Farmers can check the prices crops on their phones.	
(d)	Students can attend classes the internet.	
(e)	This has saved a lot time and money.	
(f)	However, many villages still good internet connections.	
(g)	Efforts are made to solve this problem.	
(h)	A digitally literate India be a stronger nation.	

B4 · Sentence Reordering

▸ B4.1 · Reordering — Set 1

Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences.

1. in summer / one of the best / thirst quenchers / is the watermelon
2. it is cultivated / around the world / in many countries
3. in Africa / it was first grown / about five thousand years ago
4. at the same time / that it was grown / some researchers say / in India
5. as a source of water / when they crossed / a desert / travellers used it
6. and many vitamins / the fruit contains / a lot of water

▸ B4.2 · Reordering — Set 2

Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences.

1. has no parallel / in any walk of life / discipline
2. duties and rights / in a good society / should go together
3. as equally important / for a satisfying life / they should be treated
4. it will prove very bad / for the other / if one is ignored,
5. makes the best use / a disciplined student / of his time
6. self-discipline / to lasting success / is the key

▸ B4.3 · Reordering — Set 3

Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences.

1. from the leaves they eat / all their water / koalas get
2. so, in areas inhabited by koalas, / is high / the demand for tree leaves
3. to support / one group of koalas / it takes several acres of trees
4. of leaves every day / can eat up to one and a half kilograms / each adult koala
5. most of the day / sleeping in trees / koalas spend
6. to their homes / are a serious threat / bushfires

▸ B4.4 · Reordering — Set 4

Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences.

1. since about 500 A.D / has been depicted / in temple architecture / the Veena
2. today has few takers / sadly, / the instrument
3. to whom students can turn / there are / few exponents
4. it is not offered / in university curricula / even as a subsidiary subject
5. classical instruments / from schools and society / need support
6. only if we preserve it / our heritage / will survive

▸ B4.5 · Reordering — Set 5

Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences.

1. of a paralytic attack / high blood pressure / is the main cause
2. may not be able to speak / by a stroke / people affected
3. some can communicate / with their eyes / only
4. impossible / makes even a small gesture / damage to the nervous system
5. high blood pressure early / can detect / regular check-ups
6. help keep it under control / a balanced diet / and exercise

B5 · Dialogue Completion

▸ B5.1 · Dialogue Completion — Planning a Trip

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank.

Sister: When do you leave for Mumbai?
Brother: I am leaving the day after tomorrow.
Sister: Where have you decided to stay?
Brother: **(1)** _____
Sister: Why are you not staying with Aunt and Uncle?
Brother: **(2)** _____ I won't be able to enjoy my holidays.
Sister: Don't tell me you'll stay in a hotel!
Brother: Definitely not. **(3)** _____
Sister: How are you both spending your vacation?
Brother: **(4)** _____

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	I won't decide as yet.	I haven't decided as yet.	I hadn't decided as yet.	I don't decide as yet.
2	They were too strict.	They are too strict.	They will be too strict.	They are too funny.
3	I plan to stay with Rahul.	I plan to stay in a hotel.	I won't stay with anyone.	I plan to stay with Aunt.
4	We'll go nowhere.	We'll go sightseeing.	We'll stay inside.	We'll go somewhere else not.

▸ B5.2 · Dialogue Completion — At the Doctor

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank.

Doctor: How long have you been sick?
Patient: I have been having this headache **(1)** _____ one month.
Doctor: Have you taken any medicine?
Patient: No. But I **(2)** _____ by an eye specialist.
Doctor: What did he say?
Patient: He said my eyes are fine.
Doctor: **(3)** _____ sleeping late at night?
Patient: No, I sleep regularly at 10 p.m.
Doctor: Have you **(4)** _____ in the past or lately?
Patient: No, but I had injured my head when I was ten.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	for the past	since the past	during the past	for a past
2	got my eye test	will get my eyes	got my eyes tested	would get my eye
3	Has you been	Had you been	Have you been	Had you be
4	met with an accident	meets with an accident	meet with an accident	meeting with an accident

▸ B5.3 · Dialogue Completion — A Phone Call

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank.

David: Hello. Is this 26857903?
Meenu: Yes, **(1)** _____?
David: Could I speak to Meenu? I am her friend, David.
Meenu: David? It's Meenu. **(2)** _____?
David: I am calling from the Indira Gandhi International Airport. I am here for a visit.
Meenu: That's great. **(3)** _____ about your visit?
David: I wanted to give you a surprise.
Meenu: When did you arrive? **(4)** _____?
David: I just got here and I am alone.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	shall I know to whom do you want to talk	will I know which do you want to talk	may I know who is speaking	may I know who do you want to speak to
2	From where you are calling	Where you are calling from	Where are you calling from	You are calling from where
3	Why you did not inform me	Why didn't you inform me earlier	Why you didn't informed me	Why didn't you informed me
4	Are you being accompanied by someone	You are being accompanied by someone	Are someone accompanying you	Is anyone accompanied you

▸ B5.4 · Dialogue Completion — At the Bookshop

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank.

Customer: Do you have a good dictionary for Class 10?
Shopkeeper: **(1)** _____ Here are two editions.
Customer: **(2)** _____ is the difference between them?
Shopkeeper: The newer one has more words and pictures.
Customer: **(3)** _____ is the price of the newer one?
Shopkeeper: It costs three hundred rupees.
Customer: That is a bit costly. **(4)** _____ you give me a discount?
Shopkeeper: I can give you ten per cent off.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	Yes, we have.	Yes, we are having.	Yes, certainly we do.	Yes, we has.
2	Who	What	Which	Whom
3	How much	How many	What	Who
4	Should	Must	Could	Need

▸ B5.5 · Dialogue Completion — School Picnic

Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank.

Teacher: Where would you like to go for the picnic?
Student: **(1)** _____
Teacher: That place is quite far. How will we reach there?
Student: **(2)** _____
Teacher: Have you asked for permission from the Principal?
Student: Not yet, madam. **(3)** _____
Teacher: Do that today. And **(4)** _____

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	I suggests the zoo.	I suggest the zoo.	I am suggest the zoo.	I suggested the zoo tomorrow.
2	We can hire a bus.	We can hires a bus.	We hire can a bus.	We can to hire a bus.
3	I will go to meet her now.	I will went to meet her now.	I am go to meet her now.	I had meet her now.
4	collect the money from every students.	collect the money from every student.	collecting the money from each students.	to collect money from every students.

B6 · Reported Speech (Dialogue to Paragraph)

▸ B6.1 · Reported Speech — Rama and Sita

Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. Use the correct tense and pronouns.

- Rama: I am going to the jungle.
- Sita: Why?
- Rama: I have been banished for fourteen years by my father.
- Sita: Oh! It is very sad. Can I go with you?
- Rama: No. Stay at home and take care of my old parents.

Rama told Sita **(a)** _____. She asked him **(b)** _____. Rama replied **(c)** _____. Sita exclaimed that it was very sad and asked **(d)** _____. Rama refused and told her to stay at home and take care of his old parents.

▸ B6.2 · Reported Speech — Anita and Prakash

Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. Use the correct tense and pronouns.

- Anita: What do you want to do this morning?
- Prakash: I feel like taking a walk. It's so nice outside.
- Anita: Great, let's walk around the lake in the park.
- Prakash: It's really rocky here.
- Anita: Yes, watch your step so you don't trip.

Anita asked Prakash **(a)** _____. Prakash answered that he **(b)** _____. He added that it was so nice outside. Anita agreed and suggested **(c)** _____. Then Prakash observed that **(d)** _____. Anita cautioned him to watch his step.

▸ B6.3 · Reported Speech — Teacher and Student

Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. Use the correct tense and pronouns.

- Teacher: Why are you late today?
- Student: My bus broke down on the way, sir.
- Teacher: Did you inform your parents?
- Student: Yes, sir. I called them from a shop.
- Teacher: Go to your seat and do not be late again.

The teacher asked the student **(a)** _____. The student replied respectfully that **(b)** _____. The teacher asked him **(c)** _____. The student said that he had, and added that **(d)** _____. The teacher told him to go to his seat and not to be late again.

▸ B6.4 · Reported Speech — Shopkeeper and Customer

Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. Use the correct tense and pronouns.

- Customer: How much does this jacket cost?
- Shopkeeper: It costs two thousand rupees, madam.
- Customer: That is too expensive. Can you reduce the price?
- Shopkeeper: I will give you a ten per cent discount.
- Customer: Thank you. I shall take it.

The customer asked the shopkeeper **(a)** _____. The shopkeeper replied that **(b)** _____. The customer remarked that it was too expensive and asked **(c)** _____. The shopkeeper promised **(d)** _____. The customer thanked him and said that she would take it.

▸ B6.5 · Reported Speech — Mother and Son

Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. Use the correct tense and pronouns.

- Mother: Where are you going, Rohan?
- Rohan: I am going to play cricket, Mother.
- Mother: Have you finished your homework?
- Rohan: I shall do it after I return.
- Mother: Don't stay out after dark.

His mother asked Rohan **(a)** _____. Rohan replied that **(b)** _____. His mother wanted to know **(c)** _____. Rohan said **(d)** _____. His mother told him not to stay out after dark.

▸ B6.6 · Reported Speech — Comic Strip: Charlie and Patty

Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. Use the correct tense and pronouns.

- Charlie: I am making a list of what I want from Santa Claus. Do you think he can afford all this?
- Patty: Everything these days is promotion. If the truth were known, he is financed by some big chain.

While making the list of what he wanted from Santa Claus, Charlie asked Patty **(a)** _____. Patty replied that **(b)** _____. She added that **(c)** _____.

B7 · Newspaper Headlines

▸ B7.1 · Headlines — Set 1

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item. Write the missing words.

1. CAPARO ENTERS US MARKET — The Caparo group _____ the North American vehicle market.
2. PM TO VISIT JAPAN ON APRIL 11 — The Foreign Minister announced that the Prime Minister _____ in the second week of April.
3. TWO KILLED IN BUS ACCIDENT — _____ in a bus accident here on Monday.
4. SIX FLIGHTS DELAYED — There was anger among passengers of six flights _____ for hours at the airport.
5. CITY GETS NEW PARK — The municipal corporation _____ a new park in the city.

▸ B7.2 · Headlines — Set 2

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item. Write the missing words.

1. CHINA DEVELOPS MEDICAL ROBOT — A university in China _____ that can conduct surgeries.
2. KIDS FALL ILL AFTER MID-DAY MEAL — Five children of a primary school _____ after having the mid-day meal.
3. SPORTS WEEK ENDS — A week-long sports celebration in the schools _____ on 22 April with a prize distribution.
4. BUS CRUSHES GIRL TO DEATH — A four-year-old girl _____ to death when a speeding bus ran over her.
5. 5 LAKH JOBS TO BE CREATED BY 2030 — A member of the Planning Commission said that _____ by the year 2030.

▸ B7.3 · Headlines — Set 3

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item. Write the missing words.

1. STUDENTS SWEEP STATE QUIZ — Students of our school _____ the state-level quiz competition.
2. RIVER CLEANING DRIVE LAUNCHED — The district administration _____ a drive to clean the river.
3. FIRE DESTROYS MARKET — A fire _____ the main market last night.
4. TEACHERS TO GET TRAINING — The department said that all teachers _____ training next month.
5. RECORD RAIN LASHES CITY — The city _____ record rainfall on Sunday.

▸ B7.4 · Headlines — Set 4

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item. Write the missing words.

1. FARMERS PROTEST OVER PRICES — Farmers _____ outside the collectorate demanding better prices.
2. INDIA WINS SERIES — India _____ the series by two matches to one.
3. NEW BRIDGE OPENED FOR TRAFFIC — The new bridge _____ for traffic yesterday.
4. SCHOOLS TO REMAIN CLOSED — The Education Minister announced that schools _____ closed till Monday.
5. THIEF CAUGHT RED-HANDED — A thief _____ red-handed by villagers while breaking into a house.

▸ B7.5 · Headlines — Set 5

Use the information in the headline to complete the news item. Write the missing words.

1. LIBRARY GETS 1,000 NEW BOOKS — The school library _____ one thousand new books.
2. BOY SAVES DROWNING CHILD — A teenaged boy _____ a drowning child in the lake.
3. PRICES OF VEGETABLES FALL — The prices of vegetables _____ sharply this week.
4. CYCLONE TO HIT COAST TOMORROW — The weather office said that a cyclone _____ the coast tomorrow.
5. OLDEST TEMPLE RESTORED — The oldest temple in the town _____ by the archaeology department.

B8 · Procedure / Instruction Reporting

▸ B8.1 · Procedure — Washing White Clothes (hint: are)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice. A hint is given with each set.

- Collect all the dirty white cotton clothes.
- Soak them in a mixture of boiling water and soap.
- Take them out and beat them with fists or a stick.
- Rinse them in running water until the soap is washed off.
- Squeeze them and hang them out to dry.

All the dirty white cotton clothes are collected and **(a)** _____ of boiling water and soap. They **(b)** _____ with fists or a stick. Then they **(c)** _____ until the soap is washed off. Finally, they **(d)** _____ to dry.

▸ B8.2 · Procedure — Making Noodles (hint: is/are)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice. A hint is given with each set.

- Boil 500 ml of water in a pan.
- Add the noodles and the spice mix.

- Add finely chopped vegetables after steaming them.
- Cook for only two minutes.
- Serve hot.

Firstly, 500 ml of water **(a)** _____ in a pan. After that, the noodles and the spice mix **(b)** _____. Then finely chopped vegetables **(c)** _____ after they have been steamed. The mixture **(d)** _____ for only two minutes. It is then served hot.

▸ B8.3 · Procedure — Planting a Sapling (hint: is/are)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice. A hint is given with each set.

- Dig a pit about one foot deep.
- Fill it with manure and soil.
- Place the sapling in the centre of the pit.
- Press the soil around it.
- Water it every day.

A pit about one foot deep **(a)** _____. It **(b)** _____ with manure and soil. The sapling **(c)** _____ in the centre of the pit. The soil **(d)** _____ around it. Then the sapling is watered every day.

▸ B8.4 · Procedure — How a Letter Travels (hint: is/are)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice. A hint is given with each set.

- Write the address clearly on the envelope.
- Put a stamp on it.
- Drop it in the letter box.
- The postman collects the letters from the box.
- The sorting office sorts them by town.

The address **(a)** _____ clearly on the envelope. A stamp **(b)** _____ on it, and it is dropped in the letter box. The letters **(c)** _____ from the box by the postman. At the sorting office they **(d)** _____ by town.

▸ B8.5 · Procedure — Preparing Tea (hint: is)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice. A hint is given with each set.

- Boil a cup of water in a pan.
- Add tea leaves and sugar to it.
- Pour in half a cup of milk.
- Let it boil for two minutes.
- Strain it into cups.

First, a cup of water **(a)** _____ in a pan. Tea leaves and sugar **(b)** _____ to it. Then half a cup of milk **(c)** _____. It **(d)** _____ to boil for two minutes. At last the tea is strained into cups.

▸ B8.6 · Procedure — Recycling Paper (past hint: was/were)

Read the instructions and complete the passage using the passive voice. A hint is given with each set.

- Collect the waste paper.
- Soak it in water.
- Grind it into pulp.
- Spread the pulp on a screen.
- Dry it in the sun.

At the recycling unit, the waste paper **(a)** _____ first. It **(b)** _____ in water and then **(c)** _____ into pulp. The pulp **(d)** _____ on a screen and dried in the sun.

B9 · Sentence Transformation

▸ B9.1 · Transformation — Set 1

Rewrite each sentence as directed, without changing its meaning.

1. She is too weak to walk. (Use 'so ... that')
2. He is the tallest boy in the class. (Use comparative)
3. Because it rained, the match was cancelled. (Use 'due to')
4. Walking fast, he reached the station. (Use 'as')
5. Unless you work hard, you will fail. (Use 'if')
6. He said, “I shall help you.” (Indirect)
7. She sings well. (Begin: She is ...)
8. Please open the window. (Passive)
9. No sooner did he arrive than it began to rain. (Use 'as soon as')
10. The boy was so tired. He fell asleep at once. (Join)

▸ B9.2 · Transformation — Set 2

Rewrite each sentence as directed, without changing its meaning.

1. Though he is rich, he is unhappy. (Use 'but')
2. I am sure that he will win. (Use 'sure of')
3. It is raining. We cannot play. (Join with 'so')
4. The thief ran away. The policeman came. (Use 'before')
5. He is a man of honour. (Use adjective)
6. As soon as the teacher entered, the students stood up. (Use 'no sooner')
7. This book is mine. (Use 'belongs')
8. He worked hard. He wanted to win. (Use 'to')
9. She was punished for her laziness. (Use 'because she')
10. Mohan is better than all the other boys. (Superlative)

▸ B9.3 · Transformation — Set 3

Rewrite each sentence as directed, without changing its meaning.

1. “Where does he live?” she asked. (Indirect)
2. She said, “Don't make a noise.” (Indirect)
3. Everyone loves a kind person. (Passive)
4. I have not seen him since last Monday. (Use 'for'; today is Friday)
5. If I were rich, I would travel the world. (Use 'wish')
6. He is the man. I saw him yesterday. (Join with 'whom')
7. It is a pity that he failed. (Use 'unfortunately')
8. The girl is beautiful. She won the contest. (Join with 'who')
9. He ran fast but could not catch the bus. (Use 'although')
10. We must obey the law. (Passive)

▸ B9.4 · Transformation — Set 4

Rewrite each sentence as directed, without changing its meaning.

1. The Principal praised the winners. (Passive)
2. He is too proud to apologise. (Use 'so ... that')
3. Having completed the work, he went out. (Use 'after')
4. Rita is not as clever as Seema. (Comparative)
5. I don't know what to do. (Use 'idea')

6. He is not only rich but also generous. (Use 'both ... and')
7. Do you know the answer? (Reported: He asked me)
8. The sun having set, we returned home. (Use 'as')
9. She is so poor that she cannot buy books. (Use 'too ... to')
10. His arrival surprised us. (Verb form)

▸ B9.5 · Transformation — Set 5

Rewrite each sentence as directed, without changing its meaning.

1. It is necessary to save water. (Use 'must')
2. Although he was ill, he came to school. (Use 'in spite of')
3. You must run, otherwise you will miss the train. (Use 'unless')
4. The earthquake destroyed the town. (Passive)
5. Whoever works hard succeeds. (Use 'If')
6. He was foolish to trust them. (Use 'foolishness')
7. He asked, “Are you ready?” (Indirect)
8. The teacher is kind. He taught us last year. (Join with 'who')
9. It was a difficult exam. Everyone passed. (Use 'although')
10. She cannot but laugh. (Use 'help')

B10 · Sentence Completion

▸ B10.1 · Sentence Completion — Modals

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. You _____ (should / must) always speak the truth.
2. _____ I borrow your pen, please?
3. He _____ (ability) swim across the river when he was young.
4. Children _____ not play with fire.
5. They _____ be at home; the lights are on.

▸ B10.2 · Sentence Completion — Conditionals

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. If you heat ice, _____.
2. If I had known the answer, _____.
3. Had she studied harder, _____.
4. Unless you leave now, _____.
5. I wish I _____ (be) a pilot.

▸ B10.3 · Sentence Completion — Relatives and Connectors

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. The book _____ I borrowed is excellent. (relative)
2. He is the doctor _____ son is a cricketer.
3. She was tired, _____ she kept working. (contrast)
4. Do not move _____ I return.
5. _____ it was raining, we went out. (concession)

▸ B10.4 · Sentence Completion — Non-finites and Gerunds

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. _____ (swim) is a good exercise.
2. He wants _____ (become) a pilot.
3. I am tired of _____ (wait).
4. She was seen _____ (enter) the room.
5. The _____ (injure) player was carried out.

▸ B10.5 · Sentence Completion — Passive and Reported

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. The window _____ (break) by the boys yesterday.
2. The letters _____ (post) tomorrow.
3. He told me that he _____ (be) busy.
4. She asked me where I _____ (live).
5. The teacher said that the sun _____ (rise) in the east.

▸ B10.6 · Sentence Completion — Prepositions

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. She is afraid _____ spiders.
2. He was born _____ 12 March.
3. The cat jumped _____ the wall.
4. We have been waiting _____ two hours.
5. He is good _____ drawing.

▸ B10.7 · Sentence Completion — Nominalisation and Avoiding Repetition

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. He was angry. His _____ (angry) frightened us. Use the noun form.
2. She is honest; we admire her _____.
3. My pen is better than _____ of my brother. (avoid repetition)
4. Ravi works hard and so _____ his sister. (avoid repetition)
5. I like this shirt but not that _____. (avoid repetition)

▸ B10.8 · Sentence Completion — Mixed Revision

Complete each sentence using the cue in brackets. The answer shows one correct completion; any grammatically correct and meaningful one is accepted.

1. Despite _____ (be) ill, he attended school.
2. It is high time we _____ (leave).
3. She would rather _____ (stay) at home.
4. No sooner _____ he reached than it rained.
5. Not only _____ he sing, but he also dances.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Gap filling: read the whole passage first, find its tense, then check subject-verb agreement.
- Editing: one error per line — look for tense, agreement, articles, prepositions and word form.
- Omission: the missing word is usually an article, preposition, auxiliary or conjunction.
- Reordering: find subject, verb, object, then the adverbials.
- Headlines: decide past, present perfect or future from the news, and use the passive where the doer is unknown.
- Procedure: use the passive with the tense of the hint (is/are or was/were).

Exercise Bank · Part C — Eight Full Practice Tests (Section C, 20 marks)

Four tests for Class 9 and four for Class 10, each of 20 marks in the Section C pattern: gap filling (4 marks), a second question on dialogue, reported speech, headlines, procedure or transformation (4), editing (4), omission (4) and reordering (4). Attempt each test in 25 minutes without notes.

Practice Test 1 · Class 9 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C1.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

Festivals bring joy **(1)** _____ our lives. Diwali, **(2)** _____ is celebrated in autumn, is the festival of lights. Families clean their houses and **(3)** _____ them with lamps. Children burst crackers, **(4)** _____ causes noise and air pollution. This year, our colony **(5)** _____ decided to celebrate a green Diwali. Residents **(6)** _____ to use only earthen lamps. They will also **(7)** _____ sweets among the poor. Nobody **(8)** _____ a happier festival.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	to	at	by	with
2	who	which	whose	where
3	decorate	decorated	decorating	decorates
4	who	which	what	where
5	have	has	is	was
6	have agreed	has agreed	is agreed	agreeing
7	distribute	distributes	distributing	distributed
8	can imagine	can imagines	imagining	do imagine

▸ C1.Q2 · Dialogue Completion

Q2. Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank. (1 × 4 = 4)

Rita: Where are you off to so early?
Mohan: **(1)** _____
Rita: Which train are you taking?
Mohan: The Shatabdi. **(2)** _____
Rita: How long does the journey take?
Mohan: **(3)** _____
Rita: Will you return the same day?
Mohan: No. **(4)** _____

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	I go to the station to receive my uncle.	I am going to the station to receive my uncle.	I went to the station to receive my uncle.	I have going to the station.
2	It leaves at six thirty.	It leave at six thirty.	It is leave at six thirty.	It leaving at six thirty.
3	It takes about four hours.	It take about four hours.	It is taking about four hour.	It taken about four hours.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
4	I will stay overnight with my aunt.	I stay overnight to my aunt.	I will staying overnight with my aunt.	I shall stayed overnight.

▸ C1.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Last Sunday we visit the zoo with our teacher.		
(b)	There was many animals that we had never seen.		
(c)	The elephants were biggest than I had imagined.		
(d)	We returned on the evening feeling tired.		

▸ C1.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	The village school was built 1950.	
(b)	Today it has two hundred students.	
(c)	Most of walk to school every day.	
(d)	Some travel bus from nearby hamlets.	

▸ C1.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. asked us / our teacher / to submit / the project on Monday
2. was postponed / because of / heavy rain / the match
3. regular exercise / the body / fit and healthy / keeps
4. learning the piano / for / she has been / five years

Practice Test 2 · Class 9 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C2.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

The internet has changed **(1)** _____ way we learn. A student **(2)** _____ once spent hours in a library can now find the same information **(3)** _____ seconds. Online classes **(4)** _____ become common since the pandemic. **(5)** _____, not all information on the web is reliable. We must therefore **(6)** _____ the sources before we believe anything. Parents should also **(7)** _____ a watch on what their children **(8)** _____ online.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	a	an	the	that
2	who	which	whom	whose
3	in	on	at	for
4	has	have	had	are

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
5	However	Because	Unless	So that
6	check	checks	checked	checking
7	keep	hold	make	take
8	do	does	did	doing

▸ C2.Q2 · Reported Speech

Q2. Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. (1 × 4 = 4)

- Father: Why have you not started your homework?
- Son: I was helping Mother in the kitchen.
- Father: Finish it before dinner.
- Son: I shall do it right now.

Father asked his son **(a)** _____. The son replied that **(b)** _____. Father told him **(c)** _____. The son promised that **(d)** _____.

▸ C2.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	My sister are learning to drive a car.		
(b)	She goes to a driving school at the morning.		
(c)	Her instructor is kindest than the one before.		
(d)	She hopes to gets her licence next month.		

▸ C2.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	I always carry bottle of water with me.	
(b)	Water is for the body.	
(c)	Many people forget drink water.	
(d)	This can lead headaches and tiredness.	

▸ C2.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. early July / the monsoon / reaches Rajasthan / in
2. sown / have already / their seeds / farmers
3. heavy snowfall / several schools / due to / were closed
4. the new library / by the Mayor / inaugurated / will be

Practice Test 3 · Class 9 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C3.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

When I was ten, I **(1)** _____ a summer in my grandfather's village. Every morning he **(2)** _____ me to the fields. We would walk **(3)** _____ the narrow path between the wheat fields. He showed me how crops **(4)** _____ grown. I **(5)** _____ never seen a tractor at work before. One day, while we **(6)** _____ the tractor, it suddenly stopped. The driver, **(7)** _____ looked worried, called a mechanic. **(8)** _____ he arrived, it was already dark.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	spend	spent	have spent	spending
2	took	takes	taken	had taken
3	along	among	within	onto
4	are grown	grows	is grown	were growing
5	have	had	was	has
6	watch	watched	were watching	had watched
7	who	which	whom	whose
8	By the time	Until	Unless	During

▸ C3.Q2 · Newspaper Headlines

Q2. Use the information in the headlines to complete the news items. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. STUDENTS WIN QUIZ — Students of our school _____ the district quiz contest.
2. PM TO ADDRESS NATION TONIGHT — The Prime Minister _____ the nation tonight.
3. FIRE DESTROYS GODOWN — A fire _____ a godown near the market last night.
4. THIEF HELD AT STATION — A thief _____ by the police at the railway station.

▸ C3.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Our school have a large playground.		
(b)	Every evening many students plays on it.		
(c)	The ground is cleaned by the sweeper ever day.		
(d)	We feel proud on our school.		

▸ C3.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	Birds build nests twigs and leaves.	
(b)	They lay eggs and on them for days.	
(c)	After some time the chicks out.	
(d)	The parents feed them they can fly.	

▸ C3.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. the temple / was walking slowly / towards / the old man
2. the teacher / neither / were present / nor the students
3. not seen him / I have / last year / since
4. you will / succeed / work hard, / if you

Practice Test 4 · Class 9 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C4.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

Sports Day is the most awaited event **(1)** _____ our school year. Students **(2)** _____ part in races, jumps and team games. This year the chief guest, **(3)** _____ is an Olympic medallist, **(4)** _____ the prizes. She told us that hard work **(5)** _____ always rewarded. Our class **(6)** _____ the relay race for the third year in a row. We practised **(7)** _____ two months before the event. It is not **(8)** _____ winning but taking part that matters.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	of	at	by	with
2	takes	take	took	taking
3	who	whom	which	whose
4	distributed	distributes	distributing	distribute
5	is	are	has	have
6	win	won	wins	winning
7	for	since	from	during
8	about	to	at	by

▸ C4.Q2 · Procedure Writing

Q2. Read the instructions and complete the passage. (1 × 4 = 4)

- Take a clean glass jar.
- Fill it with water.
- Add three spoons of salt and stir.
- Place an egg in the water.
- Observe how it floats.

First, a clean glass jar **(a)** _____. It **(b)** _____ with water. Three spoons of salt **(c)** _____ and the water is stirred. Then an egg is placed in the water and its floating **(d)** _____.

▸ C4.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	The Taj Mahal were built by Shah Jahan.		
(b)	It attracts million of tourists every year.		
(c)	Tourists come at see its beauty in the moonlight.		

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(d)	It is one of the wonder of the world.		

▸ C4.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	Rani wants become a doctor.	
(b)	She studies four hours every day.	
(c)	Her parents are proud her.	
(d)	She never missed a class.	

▸ C4.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. honesty / is / policy / the best
2. is taller / my brother / than / my father
3. by / the thief / the police / was caught
4. since 2010 / they / living here / have been

Practice Test 5 · Class 10 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C5.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

Climate change is **(1)** _____ most serious challenge **(2)** _____ humanity today. Global temperatures **(3)** _____ steadily for the past century, and glaciers **(4)** _____ at an alarming rate. Scientists believe that unless carbon emissions **(5)** _____ drastically, sea levels **(6)** _____ rise further. Not only **(7)** _____ coastal cities face flooding, but farmers also **(8)** _____ from erratic rains.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	a	an	the	no article
2	facing	faced	faces	to face
3	rise	are rising	have been rising	were rising
4	melted	are melting	has melted	is melting
5	are reduced	reduce	will be reduced	were reduced
6	will	ought	dare	used
7	do	are	does	will
8	suffer	suffers	suffered	suffering

▸ C5.Q2 · Dialogue Completion

Q2. Complete the conversation by choosing the correct option for each blank. (1 × 4 = 4)

Customer: Good morning. I would like to return this mixer grinder.
Shopkeeper: **(1)** _____
Customer: It stopped working within a week.
Shopkeeper: **(2)** _____

Customer: Yes, here it is. I bought it on the fifth of this month.
Shopkeeper: **(3)** _____
Customer: I would prefer a replacement.
Shopkeeper: **(4)** _____

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	What seems to be the problem?	What do seem the problem?	Which problem seems to you?	What the problem seems?
2	Have you brought the bill with you?	Did you brought the bill?	Are you bringing the bill with?	You have brought bill?
3	Would you like a refund or a replacement?	Do you liked a refund or replacement?	Will you like refund or replace?	Would you likes a refund?
4	Certainly. We will replace it by tomorrow.	Certainly. We replaced it by tomorrow.	Certain. We are replace it tomorrow.	Certainly. We have replace it by tomorrow.

▸ C5.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Neither of the answers are correct.		
(b)	The committee has submitted their report to the minister.		
(c)	The man whom lives next door is a retired colonel.		
(d)	He suggested me to join the club.		

▸ C5.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	Had I known the truth, I have acted differently.	
(b)	She insisted paying the bill herself.	
(c)	The news was so shocking nobody spoke.	
(d)	He is too proud ask for help.	

▸ C5.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. when the lights went out / the speaker / begun / hardly had
2. he was also rude / late, but / not only / was he
3. that / it was / the first time / I had seen the sea
4. I would / in your place, / were I / accept the offer

Practice Test 6 · Class 10 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C6.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

India is fast becoming a hub of start-ups. Young entrepreneurs, **(1)** _____ ideas once seemed risky, now attract investors. A start-up needs more **(2)** _____ a good idea; it needs patience, funds and a strong team. Many ventures **(3)** _____ within a year of their launch, yet some **(4)** _____ to become global giants. Mr Kapoor, **(5)** _____ founded a delivery company in 2016, today **(6)** _____ over a thousand people. He **(7)** _____ that failure is a stepping stone. Had he given up early, he **(8)** _____ never have succeeded.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	who	whom	which	whose
2	then	than	that	as
3	fails	fail	failing	to fail
4	manages	manage	managing	has managed
5	who	whom	which	whose
6	employ	employs	employed	employing
7	believe	believes	believing	has believed
8	would	will	can	shall

▸ C6.Q2 · Reported Speech

Q2. Complete the paragraph by reporting the conversation. (1 × 4 = 4)

- Interviewer: What inspired you to become a writer?
- Writer: My grandmother's stories inspired me.
- Interviewer: Do you write every day?
- Writer: Yes. I write for three hours every morning.

The interviewer asked the writer **(a)** _____. The writer replied that **(b)** _____. The interviewer then asked **(c)** _____. The writer said that **(d)** _____.

▸ C6.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	The doctor advised me rest for a week.		
(b)	I look forward to meeting you.		
(c)	She is more taller than her sister.		
(d)	Each of the players were given a medal.		

▸ C6.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	He is the person car was stolen.	
(b)	Please wait I return.	
(c)	I congratulate you your success.	
(d)	Unless you hurry, you miss the bus.	

▸ C6.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. you practise, / the better / you will play / the more
2. steps / to save water / it is high time / we took
3. she asked me / I had / whether / finished my work
4. out to play / having finished / his homework, / he went

Practice Test 7 · Class 10 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C7.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

Time and tide wait for **(1)** _____. Those **(2)** _____ waste time later regret it. A student who plans his day well **(3)** _____ to achieve more than one who does not. Mahatma Gandhi **(4)** _____ very particular about punctuality. It is said that he never **(5)** _____ late for any meeting. If we **(6)** _____ each moment wisely, we **(7)** _____ our goals easily. As the proverb goes, a stitch in time **(8)** _____ nine.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	none	neither	no	anyone
2	who	which	whom	whose
3	is likely	likely	are likely	was likely
4	was	is	were	has been
5	is	was	were	being
6	use	using	to use	uses
7	will achieve	would achieve	achieved	achieving
8	save	saves	saved	saving

▸ C7.Q2 · Newspaper Headlines

Q2. Use the information in the headlines to complete the news items. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. METRO TO REACH AIRPORT BY 2028 — The Chief Minister said that the Metro _____ the airport by 2028.
2. TWO INJURED IN BUS-TRUCK COLLISION — Two persons _____ when a bus and a truck collided.
3. NEW SCHOOL BUILDING INAUGURATED — The new school building _____ by the Governor yesterday.
4. RAINS LASH THE CITY — Heavy rain _____ the city for the third day running.

▸ C7.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	Many a student have failed in this subject.		
(b)	She is the tallest of the two sisters.		
(c)	I have been waiting here since two hours.		
(d)	He is interested to learn music.		

▸ C7.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	No sooner did he enter the lights went out.	
(b)	I would rather at home than go out.	
(c)	She is the girl whom I gave the book.	
(d)	Many books were on the table.	

▸ C7.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. had he reached / the train left / no sooner / than
2. the owner / she speaks / she were / as if
3. if it / had not rained, / played the match / we would have
4. who won / the boy / the race / is my cousin

Practice Test 8 · Class 10 · Section C: Grammar (20 marks)

Time: 25 minutes. Attempt all questions.

▸ C8.Q1 · Gap Filling

Q1. Fill in each blank with the most appropriate option. (½ × 8 = 4)

Social media has made it easy for people to stay connected, **(1)** _____ it has also created new problems. Teenagers, in **(2)** _____, spend hours scrolling through posts. Not only **(3)** _____ their eyes get tired, but their attention also suffers. Some experts feel that children **(4)** _____ be allowed accounts before the age of thirteen. Others argue that a total ban **(5)** _____ not solve the problem. What is needed **(6)** _____ responsible use. If parents **(7)** _____ time with their children, they **(8)** _____ understand their online lives better.

Blank	(a)	(b)	(c)	(d)
1	but	so	because	or
2	particular	special	general	detail
3	do	are	does	will
4	should	would	used to	need
5	will	ought	dare	used
6	is	are	were	have
7	spend	spending	to spend	will spend
8	will	would	shall	did

▸ C8.Q2 · Sentence Transformation

Q2. Rewrite each sentence as directed. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. The audience applauded the singer. (Passive)
2. He is so weak that he cannot lift the box. (Use 'too ... to')
3. Unless you apologise, I will not forgive you. (Use 'if')
4. She said to him, “Where are you going?” (Indirect)

▸ C8.Q3 · Editing

Q3. The following passage has not been edited. There is one error in each line. Write the incorrect word and its correction. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line	Incorrect word	Correction
(a)	She asked me that I had seen her bag.		
(b)	The scissors is on the table.		
(c)	He has a MBA degree from Pune.		
(d)	My father is fond for gardening.		

▸ C8.Q4 · Omission

Q4. In the passage below, one word has been omitted in each line. Put a slash where it is missing and write the missing word. (1 × 4 = 4)

	Passage line (put a slash where a word is missing)	Missing word
(a)	As soon as the bell rang, the students the class.	
(b)	The earth round the sun.	
(c)	He prevented me going out.	
(d)	If you work hard, you pass.	

▸ C8.Q5 · Reordering

Q5. Rearrange the words and phrases to form meaningful sentences. (1 × 4 = 4)

1. win, but / not only / he also broke the record / did he
2. borrowed / that I / the book / is very interesting
3. they / to the museum / taken / are being
4. by next month / the course / have completed / I shall

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Time plan: gap filling 6 min, Q2 5 min, editing 4 min, omission 4 min, reordering 4 min, revision 2 min.
- Class 9 tests are at textbook level; Class 10 tests carry the harder structures (inversion, conditionals, subjunctive).
- Score yourself with Part D: below 14 means revise the weak topic chapter before the next test.

CHAPTER 20 · ANSWER KEY

Exercise Bank · Part D — Complete Answer Key

Answers to every exercise in Parts A, B and C. Check only after finishing a set.

Answers are listed set by set. In editing and omission keys, bold shows the wrong word and its correction or the missing word; italics give reasons for tricky items; a slash separates acceptable alternatives.

Part A — Topic-wise Exercises

▸ A1 · Determiners

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) An — *honest begins with a vowel sound*	2	(c) The — *names of rivers take 'the'*
3	(c) The — *mountain ranges take 'the'*	4	(a) a
5	(a) a — *one begins with a 'w' sound*	6	(c) the — *proper noun used as a common noun*
7	(c) The — *the + adjective = a class of people*	8	(c) the — *newspaper names take 'the'*
9	(b) little — *'little' = hardly any*	10	(c) a little — *uncountable, 'not much but enough'*
11	(b) Either	12	(b) Few — *'few' = hardly any (negative idea)*
13	(c) Every — *singular noun follows*	14	(a) Neither — *two items; 'none' is for three or more*
15	She gave me much information / a lot of information about the course. — *information is uncountable*	16	a — *one has a 'w' sound*

▸ A2 · Tenses

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	have known — *'know' is a stative verb: no continuous form*	2	had begun
3	were playing	4	has not finished
5	will be flying	6	will have completed
7	leaves — *scheduled future event*	8	is visiting — *planned future*
9	He knows the answer.	10	have been waiting
11	had finished	12	moves — *universal truth does not change*
13	(c) has been playing	14	(b) were having
15	(c) had been studying	16	Future perfect continuous
17	am going		

▸ A3 · Subject-Verb Agreement

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(d) has received — *each + singular verb*	2	(c) were — *verb agrees with the nearer subject*

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
3	(b) has — *collective noun as one unit*	4	(b) is
5	(c) are — *a number of = many*	6	(b) is — *the number = singular*
7	(b) am — *nearer subject*	8	(b) is — *sum of money as a single amount*
9	(c) are — *plural noun*	10	(b) has — *many a + singular*
11	(b) is — *verb agrees with the first subject*	12	(c) wait — *two separate subjects*
13	(d) are	14	(c) were
15	Physics is a difficult subject.	16	(b) is — *'together with' does not make the subject plural*

▸ A4 · Non-finites

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	tired	2	Swimming — gerund (subject)
3	rolling — present participle used as an adjective	4	Seeing the lion, he ran away.
5	He works hard to pass.	6	meeting — *'to' is a preposition here*
7	closing	8	He is interested in learning music.
9	She avoided answering my question.	10	to go
11	drink — *bare infinitive after 'made'*	12	Having finished — perfect participle phrase
13	He was too tired to walk.	14	getting
15	to lock		

▸ A5 · Relatives

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) where — *relative of place*	2	(c) whose — *possession*
3	(c) whom	4	(c) that — *'that' follows all/everything/nothing*
5	The boy whose bicycle was stolen is my friend.	6	She is the girl whom I told you about. / She is the girl about whom I told you.
7	The boy who won the race is my brother.	8	The woman who lives next door is a nurse.
9	(c) that	10	(d) who
11	(a) both of whom	12	Switch off the fan that is not in use.
13	(b) which — *preposition + which*	14	(c) what — *what = the thing which*
15	Gandhiji, who led India to freedom, was a great leader.		

▸ A6 · Connectors

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) unless	2	(b) but also
3	(b) nor	4	(a) so that — *purpose*
5	(c) that — *so ... that = result*	6	(b) However

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
7	(b) Therefore	8	(a) Otherwise
9	(c) due to — *followed by a noun phrase*	10	(c) and
11	Though she is poor, she is honest.	12	As soon as the teacher entered, the students stood up.
13	Unless you practise, you cannot win.	14	He was so weak that he could not walk.
15	No sooner did he see the police than he ran away.	16	(a) but

▸ A7 · Conditionals

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) would have — *Type 3*	2	(d) will miss
3	(b) had	4	had known
5	(b) would have	6	(c) would
7	If you do not work hard, you will not pass.	8	Without his help, I would have failed.
9	If you do not work hard, you will fail.	10	If I see him, I will tell him.
11	If I had a million rupees, I would buy a house.	12	were
13	were	14	had not rained
15	won	16	return
17	Had she told me, I would have helped her.	18	had not been

▸ A8 · Comparison

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) to — *senior, junior, superior, inferior take 'to'*	2	(c) to
3	Arun is taller than any other boy in the class.	4	Arun is the tallest boy in the class.
5	Mount Everest is higher than any other peak in the world.	6	No other peak in the world is as high as Mount Everest.
7	Mohan is one of the cleverest boys in the class.	8	Iron is the most useful of all metals.
9	This is the most beautiful place I have seen.	10	He is taller than I.
11	Ram is senior to me.	12	(b) taller — *two persons: comparative with 'the'*
13	harder; better — *'the ... the' structure*	14	colder; colder
15	(b) latter — *latter refers to the second of two*	16	Reena is taller than Seema.
17	Pune is not as big as Mumbai.		

▸ A9 · Avoiding Repetition

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) neither	2	(a) did
3	(a) so	4	so
5	so	6	one; one

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
7	The weather of Shimla is cooler than that of Delhi.	8	The population of India is larger than that of the USA.
9	The rivers of the north are longer than those of the south.	10	She wanted to go but her mother did not let her.
11	Rita likes dancing but her sister does not.	12	(b) Neither
13	Mohan likes to read novels and so do I.	14	Aman went to the market, bought some fruit and returned home.
15	Neither she nor he has finished the work. / She has not finished her work and neither has he.		

▸ A10 · Nominalisation

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	decision	2	explanation
3	pollution	4	success
5	invention	6	growth
7	The doctor made a careful examination of the patient.	8	His failure made him sad.
9	His carelessness made him late.	10	Poverty prevents people from affording medicines.
11	Punctuality is required of teachers.	12	His victory surprised everybody.
13	The students' protest caused the closure of the college.	14	movement

▸ A11 · Modals

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) must — *strong inference*	2	(a) must — *prohibition*
3	(b) used to — *past habit*	4	(a) may — *possibility*
5	(a) Would — *polite request*	6	(a) ought to
7	(b) could — *past of can*	8	(b) Shall — *offer*
9	(b) shall — *promise with the second person takes 'shall'*	10	You should drink boiled water.
11	It may rain today.	12	You ought to help the poor.
13	He can swim very well.	14	(b) need — *need not = no necessity*
15	(a) must		

▸ A12 · Active and Passive

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	My bicycle has been stolen.	2	A bridge is being built over the river.
3	By whom was this poem written?	4	Let the door be opened.
5	A song was being sung by the children.	6	The rules must be obeyed.
7	Were the letters posted by her?	8	Let not lies be told. / Lies should not be told.
9	He is known to me.	10	The project had been completed by them.

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
11	I was given a pen by him. / A pen was given to me by him.	12	We are taught English by her. / English is taught to us by her.
13	English is spoken all over the world.	14	The servant was cleaning the window.
15	India has won the match.	16	Do the work at once.
17	The cake was eaten by the children.		

▸ A13 · Reported Speech

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	She told me that she would help me.	2	The teacher said that the earth moves round the sun. — *universal truth: no change of tense*
3	He asked me where I lived.	4	She asked him if he was coming.
5	The mother told the child not to touch the fire.	6	He requested us to help him.
7	She said that she had seen him the day before.	8	He exclaimed sorrowfully that he was ruined.
9	She exclaimed with joy that it was a very beautiful garden.	10	He suggested that they should go for a walk.
11	The captain ordered the soldiers to stand at ease.	12	He asked me why I was late.
13	She said to me, “I have lost my pen.”	14	He said to me, “Have you seen my book?”
15	She said to him, “Work hard.” / “You should work hard.”	16	then; there; that day; the next / following day
17	the previous day / the day before; that; before; the previous night		

▸ A14 · Prepositions

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) of	2	(b) since — *point of time*
3	(c) for — *period of time*	4	(b) between — *two persons*
5	(b) Among — *more than two*	6	(b) of
7	(b) in	8	(a) of
9	(c) on	10	(b) of
11	(a) to; for	12	(c) to — *agree to a proposal; agree with a person*
13	(b) on	14	(a) at
15	(c) to	16	(a) from; to
17	I prefer coffee to tea.	18	He is suffering from fever.
19	(b) from		

Part B — Gap Filling

▸ B1.1 · Gap Filling — Solar Energy

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) the	2	(b) to
3	(c) use	4	(b) have
5	(c) which	6	(b) Although
7	(c) in	8	(b) adopted

▸ B1.2 · Gap Filling — Mobile Phones

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) become	2	(a) for
3	(a) on	4	(a) who
5	(c) is increasing	6	(a) too
7	(a) can	8	(b) learnt

▸ B1.3 · Gap Filling — Saving Water

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) so	2	(a) several
3	(c) which	4	(b) by
5	(b) do not act	6	(d) will
7	(b) has	8	(c) however

▸ B1.4 · Gap Filling — Yoga

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) which	2	(a) all over
3	(a) who	4	(b) have
5	(a) to	6	(a) should
7	(b) are	8	(b) has been

▸ B1.5 · Gap Filling — A Museum Visit

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) made	2	(a) reached
3	(b) had	4	(c) were waiting
5	(a) for	6	(c) had
7	(a) had	8	(a) in

Part B — Editing

▸ B2.1 · Editing — Sleep

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	says → say	(b)	sleeps → sleep
(c)	since → until	(d)	at → during
(e)	make → makes	(f)	which → who
(g)	advises → advise	(h)	cheaper → cheapest

▸ B2.2 · Editing — A Fair in the Village

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	is → was	(b)	come → came
(c)	was → were	(d)	a → an
(e)	for → of	(f)	loud → loudly
(g)	in → at	(h)	me → myself

▸ B2.3 · Editing — Newspaper Report: Flood Relief

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	has → have	(b)	is → are
(c)	a → the	(d)	will be → would be
(e)	or → and	(f)	were → was
(g)	stopping → stopped	(h)	resumes → will resume

▸ B2.4 · Editing — Importance of Reading

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	good → best	(b)	take → takes
(c)	write → writing	(d)	reads → read
(e)	had → have	(f)	are → is
(g)	to buy → buy	(h)	an → a

▸ B2.5 · Editing — The Marathon

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	held → be held	(b)	is → are
(c)	at → in	(d)	close → closed
(e)	should to → should	(f)	whom → who
(g)	from → than	(h)	for → to

Part B — Omission

▸ B3.1 · Omission — Police and Public

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**is** — One thing we all must do **is** to cooperate with the police.	(b)	**to** — We should pay heed **to** their advice at all times.
(c)	**and** — They warn us not to touch unidentified **and** unclaimed objects.	(d)	**out** — We need to watch **out** for abandoned cars and scooters.
(e)	**be** — Anything suspicious must **be** reported at once.	(f)	**by** — The police control room can be reached **by** dialling 100.
(g)	**to** — Always report suspicious objects **to** the nearest police station.	(h)	**makes** — Public cooperation **makes** the work of the police easier.

▸ B3.2 · Omission — My Grandmother

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**in** — My grandmother lives **in** a small village near Ajmer.	(b)	**at** — She wakes up **at** five every morning.
(c)	**for** — After a bath, she prays **for** half an hour.	(d)	**the** — Then she milks **the** cow and prepares tea for everyone.
(e)	**about** — She tells us stories **about** her childhood.	(f)	**and** — Her stories are full of lessons **and** humour.
(g)	**has** — She **has** never been to a city.	(h)	**the** — Yet she is **the** wisest person I know.

▸ B3.3 · Omission — Healthy Habits

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**is** — A healthy body **is** the foundation of a happy life.	(b)	**eat** — We should **eat** fresh food and avoid junk food.
(c)	**helps** — Drinking enough water **helps** the body stay fit.	(d)	**and** — Regular exercise keeps us active **and** cheerful.
(e)	**of** — Many people complain **of** lack of time.	(f)	**than** — But even a short walk is better **than** no exercise.
(g)	**also** — Sleeping on time is **also** important.	(h)	**will** — If we follow these habits, we **will** stay healthy.

▸ B3.4 · Omission — The Railway Station

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**with** — The railway station was crowded **with** passengers.	(b)	**here** — Porters were running **here** and there with luggage.
(c)	**announced** — A voice from the loudspeaker **announced** that the train was late.	(d)	**on** — Many people were sitting **on** benches and reading newspapers.
(e)	**to** — A small boy was selling tea **to** the waiting passengers.	(f)	**arrived** — At last the train **arrived** with a loud whistle.
(g)	**towards** — Passengers rushed **towards** their coaches.	(h)	**became** — Within minutes the platform **became** quiet again.

▸ B3.5 · Omission — Digital India

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**to** — Digital India is a campaign **to** make government services available online.	(b)	**from** — Today people can pay bills **from** home.
(c)	**of** — Farmers can check the prices **of** crops on their phones.	(d)	**through** — Students can attend classes **through** the internet.
(e)	**of** — This has saved a lot **of** time and money.	(f)	**lack** — However, many villages still **lack** good internet connections.
(g)	**being** — Efforts are **being** made to solve this problem.	(h)	**will** — A digitally literate India **will** be a stronger nation.

Part B — Reordering

▸ B4.1 · Reordering — Set 1

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	One of the best thirst quenchers in summer is the watermelon.	2	It is cultivated in many countries around the world.
3	It was first grown in Africa about five thousand years ago.	4	Some researchers say that it was grown in India at the same time.
5	Travellers used it as a source of water when they crossed a desert.	6	The fruit contains a lot of water and many vitamins.

▸ B4.2 · Reordering — Set 2

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Discipline has no parallel in any walk of life.	2	Duties and rights should go together in a good society.
3	They should be treated as equally important for a satisfying life.	4	If one is ignored, it will prove very bad for the other.
5	A disciplined student makes the best use of his time.	6	Self-discipline is the key to lasting success.

▸ B4.3 · Reordering — Set 3

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Koalas get all their water from the leaves they eat.	2	So, in areas inhabited by koalas, the demand for tree leaves is high.
3	It takes several acres of trees to support one group of koalas.	4	Each adult koala can eat up to one and a half kilograms of leaves every day.
5	Koalas spend most of the day sleeping in trees.	6	Bushfires are a serious threat to their homes.

▸ B4.4 · Reordering — Set 4

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	The Veena has been depicted in temple architecture since about 500 A.D.	2	Sadly, the instrument today has few takers.
3	There are few exponents to whom students can turn.	4	It is not offered even as a subsidiary subject in university curricula.

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
5	Classical instruments need support from schools and society.	6	Our heritage will survive only if we preserve it.

▸ B4.5 · Reordering — Set 5

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	High blood pressure is the main cause of a paralytic attack.	2	People affected by a stroke may not be able to speak.
3	Some can communicate only with their eyes.	4	Damage to the nervous system makes even a small gesture impossible.
5	Regular check-ups can detect high blood pressure early.	6	A balanced diet and exercise help keep it under control.

Part B — Dialogue Completion

▸ B5.1 · Dialogue Completion — Planning a Trip

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) I haven't decided as yet.	2	(b) They are too strict.
3	(a) I plan to stay with Rahul.	4	(b) We'll go sightseeing.

▸ B5.2 · Dialogue Completion — At the Doctor

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) for the past	2	(c) got my eyes tested
3	(c) Have you been	4	(a) met with an accident

▸ B5.3 · Dialogue Completion — A Phone Call

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) may I know who is speaking	2	(c) Where are you calling from
3	(b) Why didn't you inform me earlier	4	(a) Are you being accompanied by someone

▸ B5.4 · Dialogue Completion — At the Bookshop

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) Yes, certainly we do.	2	(b) What
3	(a) How much	4	(c) Could

▸ B5.5 · Dialogue Completion — School Picnic

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) I suggest the zoo.	2	(a) We can hire a bus.
3	(a) I will go to meet her now.	4	(b) collect the money from every student.

Part B — Reported Speech

▸ B6.1 · Reported Speech — Rama and Sita

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	that he was going to the jungle	(b)	why he was going to the jungle
(c)	that he had been banished for fourteen years by his father	(d)	if / whether she could go with him

▸ B6.2 · Reported Speech — Anita and Prakash

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	what he wanted to do that morning	(b)	felt like taking a walk
(c)	that they should walk around the lake in the park	(d)	it was really rocky there

▸ B6.3 · Reported Speech — Teacher and Student

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	why he was late that day	(b)	his bus had broken down on the way
(c)	if / whether he had informed his parents	(d)	he had called them from a shop

▸ B6.4 · Reported Speech — Shopkeeper and Customer

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	how much that jacket cost	(b)	it cost two thousand rupees
(c)	if / whether he could reduce the price	(d)	that he would give her a ten per cent discount

▸ B6.5 · Reported Speech — Mother and Son

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	where he was going	(b)	he was going to play cricket
(c)	if / whether he had finished his homework	(d)	that he would do it after he returned

▸ B6.6 · Reported Speech — Comic Strip: Charlie and Patty

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	if / whether she thought Santa could afford all that	(b)	everything these days was promotion
(c)	if the truth were known, he was financed by some big chain		

Part B — Headlines

▸ B7.1 · Headlines — Set 1

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	has entered	2	will visit Japan / will be visiting Japan
3	Two persons were killed	4	that were delayed
5	has opened / opened		

▸ B7.2 · Headlines — Set 2

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	has developed a medical robot	2	fell ill
3	ended	4	was crushed
5	five lakh jobs would be created		

▸ B7.3 · Headlines — Set 3

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	swept / have swept	2	has launched / launched
3	destroyed	4	will get / would get
5	received / recorded		

▸ B7.4 · Headlines — Set 4

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	protested / are protesting	2	won / have won
3	was opened	4	would remain / will remain
5	was caught		

▸ B7.5 · Headlines — Set 5

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	has received / received	2	saved / has saved
3	have fallen / fell	4	will hit
5	has been restored / was restored		

Part B — Procedure

▸ B8.1 · Procedure — Washing White Clothes (hint: are)

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	are soaked in a mixture	(b)	are taken out and beaten
(c)	are rinsed in running water	(d)	are squeezed and hung out

▸ B8.2 · Procedure — Making Noodles (hint: is/are)

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	is boiled	(b)	are added
(c)	are added	(d)	is cooked

▸ B8.3 · Procedure — Planting a Sapling (hint: is/are)

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	is dug	(b)	is filled

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(c)	is placed	(d)	is pressed

▸ B8.4 · Procedure — How a Letter Travels (hint: is/are)

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	is written	(b)	is put / is fixed
(c)	are collected	(d)	are sorted

▸ B8.5 · Procedure — Preparing Tea (hint: is)

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	is boiled	(b)	are added
(c)	is poured in	(d)	is allowed / is left

▸ B8.6 · Procedure — Recycling Paper (past hint: was/were)

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	was collected	(b)	was soaked
(c)	ground	(d)	was spread

Part B — Transformation

▸ B9.1 · Transformation — Set 1

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	She is so weak that she cannot walk.	2	He is taller than any other boy in the class.
3	The match was cancelled due to the rain.	4	As he walked fast, he reached the station.
5	If you do not work hard, you will fail.	6	He said that he would help me.
7	She is a good singer.	8	You are requested to open the window. / Let the window be opened.
9	As soon as he arrived, it began to rain.	10	The boy was so tired that he fell asleep at once.

▸ B9.2 · Transformation — Set 2

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	He is rich but he is unhappy.	2	I am sure of his winning. / I am sure of his victory.
3	It is raining, so we cannot play.	4	The thief ran away before the policeman came.
5	He is an honourable man.	6	No sooner did the teacher enter than the students stood up.
7	This book belongs to me.	8	He worked hard to win.
9	She was punished because she was lazy.	10	Mohan is the best boy.

▸ B9.3 · Transformation — Set 3

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	She asked where he lived.	2	She told them not to make a noise.

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
3	A kind person is loved by everyone.	4	I have not seen him for five days.
5	I wish I were rich so that I could travel the world.	6	He is the man whom I saw yesterday.
7	Unfortunately, he failed.	8	The girl who won the contest is beautiful.
9	Although he ran fast, he could not catch the bus.	10	The law must be obeyed.

▸ B9.4 · Transformation — Set 4

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	The winners were praised by the Principal.	2	He is so proud that he cannot apologise.
3	After he had completed the work, he went out.	4	Seema is cleverer than Rita.
5	I have no idea what to do.	6	He is both rich and generous.
7	He asked me if I knew the answer.	8	As the sun had set, we returned home.
9	She is too poor to buy books.	10	We were surprised when he arrived.

▸ B9.5 · Transformation — Set 5

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	We must save water.	2	In spite of his illness, he came to school.
3	Unless you run, you will miss the train.	4	The town was destroyed by the earthquake.
5	If anyone works hard, he succeeds.	6	It was foolishness on his part to trust them.
7	He asked if I was ready.	8	The teacher who taught us last year is kind.
9	Although it was a difficult exam, everyone passed.	10	She cannot help laughing.

Part B — Sentence Completion

▸ B10.1 · Sentence Completion — Modals

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	should	2	May / Can
3	could	4	must / should
5	must		

▸ B10.2 · Sentence Completion — Conditionals

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	it melts	2	I would have told you
3	she would have passed	4	you will miss the train
5	were		

▸ B10.3 · Sentence Completion — Relatives and Connectors

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	which / that	2	whose

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
3	yet / but	4	until
5	Although / Though		

▸ B10.4 · Sentence Completion — Non-finites and Gerunds

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Swimming	2	to become
3	waiting	4	entering
5	injured		

▸ B10.5 · Sentence Completion — Passive and Reported

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	was broken	2	will be posted
3	was	4	lived
5	rises		

▸ B10.6 · Sentence Completion — Prepositions

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	of	2	on
3	over / onto	4	for
5	at		

▸ B10.7 · Sentence Completion — Nominalisation and Avoiding Repetition

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	anger	2	honesty
3	that	4	does
5	one		

▸ B10.8 · Sentence Completion — Mixed Revision

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	being	2	left
3	stay	4	had
5	does		

Part C — Practice Test 1

▸ C1.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) to	2	(b) which

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
3	(a) decorate	4	(b) which
5	(b) has	6	(a) have agreed
7	(a) distribute	8	(a) can imagine

▸ C1.Q2 · Dialogue Completion

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) I am going to the station to receive my uncle.	2	(a) It leaves at six thirty.
3	(a) It takes about four hours.	4	(a) I will stay overnight with my aunt.

▸ C1.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**visit → visited**	(b)	**was → were**
(c)	**biggest → bigger**	(d)	**on → in**

▸ C1.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**in** — The village school was built **in** 1950.	(b)	**over** — Today it has **over** two hundred students.
(c)	**them** — Most of **them** walk to school every day.	(d)	**by** — Some travel **by** bus from nearby hamlets.

▸ C1.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Our teacher asked us to submit the project on Monday.	2	The match was postponed because of heavy rain.
3	Regular exercise keeps the body fit and healthy.	4	She has been learning the piano for five years.

Part C — Practice Test 2

▸ C2.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) the	2	(a) who
3	(a) in	4	(b) have
5	(a) However	6	(a) check
7	(a) keep	8	(a) do

▸ C2.Q2 · Reported Speech

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	why he had not started his homework	(b)	he had been helping his mother in the kitchen
(c)	to finish it before dinner	(d)	he would do it right then / immediately

▸ C2.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**are → is**	(b)	**at → in**
(c)	**kindest → kinder**	(d)	**gets → get**

▸ C2.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**a** — I always carry **a** bottle of water with me.	(b)	**important** — Water is **important** for the body.
(c)	**to** — Many people forget **to** drink water.	(d)	**to** — This can lead **to** headaches and tiredness.

▸ C2.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	The monsoon reaches Rajasthan in early July.	2	Farmers have already sown their seeds.
3	Several schools were closed due to heavy snowfall.	4	The new library will be inaugurated by the Mayor.

Part C — Practice Test 3

▸ C3.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(b) spent	2	(a) took
3	(a) along	4	(a) are grown
5	(b) had	6	(c) were watching
7	(a) who	8	(a) By the time

▸ C3.Q2 · Newspaper Headlines

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	won / have won	2	will address / will be addressing
3	destroyed	4	was held / was arrested

▸ C3.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**have → has**	(b)	**plays → play**
(c)	**ever → every**	(d)	**on → of**

▸ C3.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**with** — Birds build nests **with** twigs and leaves.	(b)	**sit** — They lay eggs and **sit** on them for days.
(c)	**come** — After some time the chicks **come** out.	(d)	**until / till** — The parents feed them **until / till** they can fly.

▸ C3.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	The old man was walking slowly towards the temple.	2	Neither the teacher nor the students were present.
3	I have not seen him since last year.	4	If you work hard, you will succeed.

Part C — Practice Test 4

▸ C4.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) of	2	(b) take
3	(a) who	4	(a) distributed
5	(a) is	6	(b) won
7	(a) for	8	(a) about

▸ C4.Q2 · Procedure Writing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	is taken	(b)	is filled
(c)	are added	(d)	is observed

▸ C4.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**were → was**	(b)	**million → millions**
(c)	**at → to**	(d)	**wonder → wonders**

▸ C4.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**to** — Rani wants **to** become a doctor.	(b)	**for** — She studies **for** four hours every day.
(c)	**of** — Her parents are proud **of** her.	(d)	**has** — She **has** never missed a class.

▸ C4.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Honesty is the best policy.	2	My brother is taller than my father.
3	The thief was caught by the police.	4	They have been living here since 2010.

Part C — Practice Test 5

▸ C5.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(c) the	2	(a) facing
3	(c) have been rising	4	(b) are melting

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
5	(a) are reduced	6	(a) will
7	(a) do	8	(a) suffer

▸ C5.Q2 · Dialogue Completion

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) What seems to be the problem?	2	(a) Have you brought the bill with you?
3	(a) Would you like a refund or a replacement?	4	(a) Certainly. We will replace it by tomorrow.

▸ C5.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**are → is**	(b)	**their → its**
(c)	**whom → who**	(d)	**to → that I should**

▸ C5.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**would** — Had I known the truth, I **would** have acted differently.	(b)	**on** — She insisted **on** paying the bill herself.
(c)	**that** — The news was so shocking **that** nobody spoke.	(d)	**to** — He is too proud **to** ask for help.

▸ C5.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Hardly had the speaker begun when the lights went out.	2	Not only was he late, but he was also rude.
3	It was the first time that I had seen the sea.	4	Were I in your place, I would accept the offer.

Part C — Practice Test 6

▸ C6.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(d) whose	2	(b) than
3	(b) fail	4	(b) manage
5	(a) who	6	(b) employs
7	(b) believes	8	(a) would

▸ C6.Q2 · Reported Speech

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	what had inspired him / her to become a writer	(b)	his / her grandmother's stories had inspired him / her
(c)	if / whether he / she wrote every day	(d)	he / she wrote for three hours every morning

▸ C6.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**rest → to rest**	(b)	**look → am looking**
(c)	**more taller → taller**	(d)	**were → was**

▸ C6.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**whose** — He is the person **whose** car was stolen.	(b)	**until / till** — Please wait **until / till** I return.
(c)	**on** — I congratulate you **on** your success.	(d)	**will** — Unless you hurry, you **will** miss the bus.

▸ C6.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	The more you practise, the better you will play.	2	It is high time we took steps to save water.
3	She asked me whether I had finished my work.	4	Having finished his homework, he went out to play.

Part C — Practice Test 7

▸ C7.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) none	2	(a) who
3	(a) is likely	4	(a) was
5	(b) was	6	(a) use
7	(a) will achieve	8	(b) saves

▸ C7.Q2 · Newspaper Headlines

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	would reach / will reach	2	were injured
3	was inaugurated	4	has lashed / has been lashing

▸ C7.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**have → has**	(b)	**tallest → taller**
(c)	**since → for**	(d)	**to learn → in learning**

▸ C7.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**than** — No sooner did he enter **than** the lights went out.	(b)	**stay** — I would rather **stay** at home than go out.
(c)	**to** — She is the girl **to** whom I gave the book.	(d)	**lying** — Many books were **lying** on the table.

▸ C7.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	No sooner had he reached than the train left.	2	She speaks as if she were the owner.
3	If it had not rained, we would have played the match.	4	The boy who won the race is my cousin.

Part C — Practice Test 8

▸ C8.Q1 · Gap Filling

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	(a) but	2	(a) particular
3	(a) do	4	(a) should
5	(a) will	6	(a) is
7	(a) spend	8	(a) will

▸ C8.Q2 · Sentence Transformation

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	The singer was applauded by the audience.	2	He is too weak to lift the box.
3	If you do not apologise, I will not forgive you.	4	She asked him where he was going.

▸ C8.Q3 · Editing

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**that → whether**	(b)	**is → are**
(c)	**a → an**	(d)	**for → of**

▸ C8.Q4 · Omission

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
(a)	**left** — As soon as the bell rang, the students **left** the class.	(b)	**moves** — The earth **moves** round the sun.
(c)	**from** — He prevented me **from** going out.	(d)	**will** — If you work hard, you **will** pass.

▸ C8.Q5 · Reordering

No.	Answer	No.	Answer
1	Not only did he win, but he also broke the record.	2	The book that I borrowed is very interesting.
3	They are being taken to the museum.	4	By next month I shall have completed the course.

★ KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Compare, then redo wrong items in your own words; re-attempt them after seven days.